

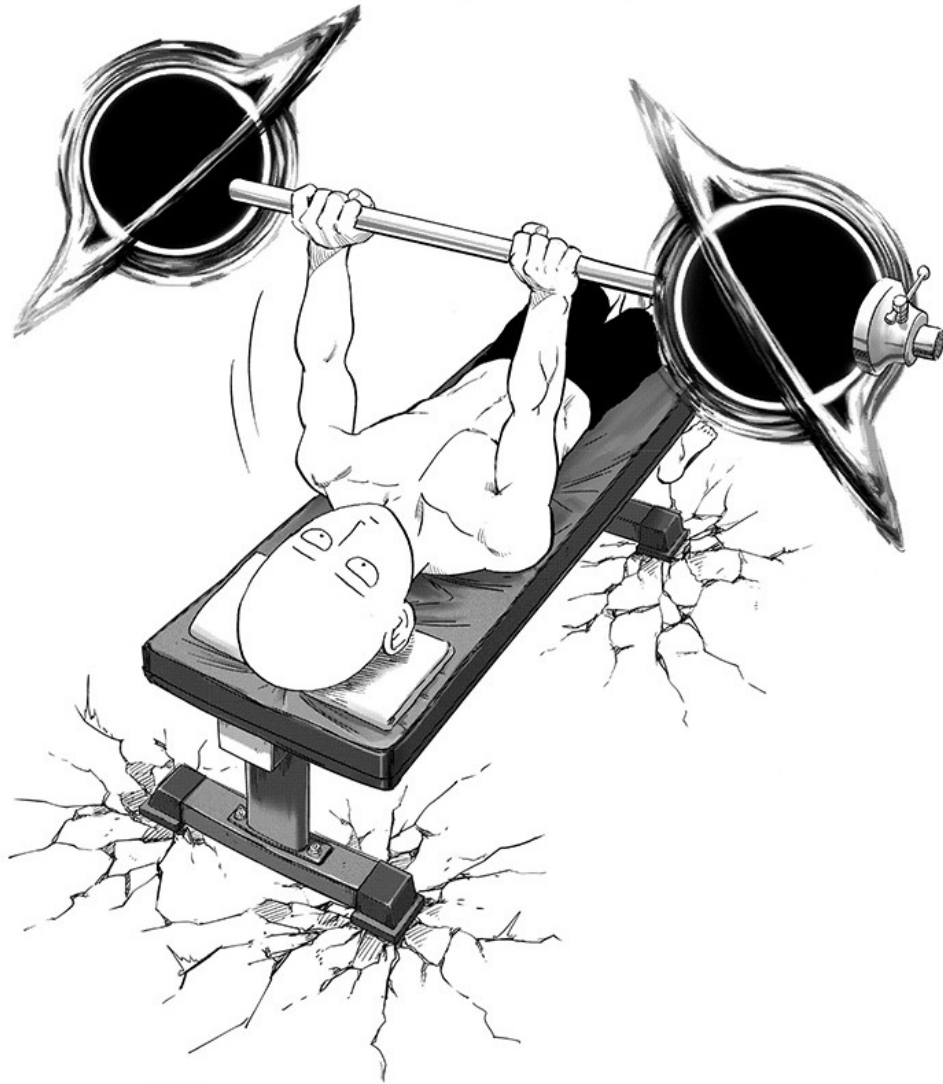
The Seven Wonders of the World

Exercises

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pglpm.github.io/7wonders





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Typeset with L^AT_EX.

No large language models were used in the preparation of this document,
except in exercises that specifically target them.

Cover: adapted from *One Punch Man* Punch 192: *Level Up*.

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Physics, quantities, units

For some of the following exercises you can refer to tables [1.1](#) and [1.2](#) on page [11](#) (reproduced from the textbook).

1.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

1.1

Preferably together with a colleague:

If you have some large-language-model service, ask it which physical laws are universally valid in Newtonian Mechanics and in General Relativity and in Thermodynamics and in Chemistry and in Electromagnetics.

Discuss the answer you get, based on what you have learned so far. (Note: if the output mentions a ‘balance of boost momentum’, that’s actually correct.)

Argue with the LLM and see where the discussion goes.

1.2

Solution p. [12](#)

Take *time* and *velocity* as primitive quantities.

1. Try to define *distance* as a derived quantity
2. Try to define *acceleration* as a derived quantity.

1.3

Solution p. [12](#)

Which of the following quantities are *scalars*, and which are *vectors*?

- Time
- Distance
- Position
- Energy

- Velocity
- Speed
- Momentum
- Entropy
- Angular momentum
- Force
- Temperature
- Magnetic flux
- Electric charge
- Electric current
- Heat
- Power
- Volume
- Pressure



1.4

Solution p. 12

Find the correct units for the following quantities:

- *Volumic energy* or *energy density*, defined as energy divided by volume
- *Energy flux*, defined as energy divided by time.
- *Power*, defined as energy divided by time.
- *Heating*, defined as energy divided by time.
- *Magnetic flux*, which we take as a primitive quantity.
- *Electric potential difference*, defined as magnetic flux divided by time.
- *Force*, defined as momentum divided by time.
- *Momentum flux*, defined as momentum divided by time.
- *Momentum supply*, defined as momentum divided by time.
- *Pressure*, defined as force divided by area.
- *Amount of substance (or of matter)*, which we take as primitive.
- *Molar mass*, defined as mass divided by amount of substance.
- *Specific momentum*, defined as momentum divided by mass.
- *Volumic charge* or *charge density*, defined as charge divided by volume.
- *Entropy*, which we take as primitive, has dimension of energy divided by temperature.
- *Matter density*, defined as amount of substance divided by volume.
- *Matter flux*, defined as amount of substance divided by time.

 1.5

With a friend or colleague:

1. Try to explain to your friend the difference between a *primitive quantity* and a *derived quantity*; then let your friend criticize unclear or incorrect points in your explanation, and comment on the good points. Then invert your roles: your friend tries to explain to you, and you criticize and comment.
2. Similarly as the previous exercise, but explaining the difference between a *scalar quantity* and a *vector quantity*.
3. If you have some large-language-model service, ask it to explain the difference between primitive and derived quantity, and between scalar and vector quantity. Find out weak or unsure points in its answer, given what you've learned so far.

 1.6

Solution p. [13](#)

Find which of the following mathematical expressions and equalities are dimensionally incorrect, and explain why they are incorrect:

- $11 \text{ J} + 4 \text{ kg}$
- $\tan\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)$, where a has dimension length and b has dimension time
- $299\,792\,458 \text{ m/s}$
- $\exp\left(\frac{71 \text{ s}}{3 \text{ s}}\right)$
- $\cos(3.14) \text{ m}$
- $m - v$, where m has dimension of mass and v of velocity
- $10 \text{ N s} - 2 \text{ kg m/s} = 8 \text{ J s/m}$
- $\exp(-8 \text{ J})$
- $(9 \text{ m}, 0.1 \text{ rad}, -0.5 \text{ rad})$
- $8 \text{ J/s} = 12 \text{ N m} - 4 \text{ N m}$
- $e^{-8 \text{ J}}$

- $\frac{15 \text{ J}}{5 \text{ kg/s}^2} = 3 \text{ m}^2$
- $\sqrt{25} \text{ K} = 5$
- $(\text{e}^7)^{\text{s}}$
- $\tan\left(\frac{10 \text{ m}}{5 \text{ m}}\right)$
- $\sqrt{300 \text{ K}}$
- $\sin(t/\text{s})$, where t has dimension of time
- $\frac{3}{\text{s}}$
- $\sin(10 \text{ s})$

Quantity	SI Dimension	Unit
Time	time	<i>second</i> s
Length	length	<i>metre</i> m
Temperature	temperature	<i>kelvin</i> K
Matter	amount of substance	<i>mole</i> mol
Electric charge	electric charge	<i>coulomb</i> C
Magnetic flux	magnetic flux	<i>weber</i> Wb
Energy	energy, mass	<i>joule</i> J, <i>kilogram</i> kg
Momentum	force · time, mass · length/time, energy · time/length	N · s, kg · m/s, J · s/m
Angular momentum	force · length · time, mass · length ² /time, energy · time	N · m · s, kg · m ² /s, J · s
Entropy	energy/temperature	J/K

Table 1.1 Dimensions and units of the main physical quantities used in these notes. Their fluxes have the dimensions divided by time, and therefore units divided by seconds. Quantities in **boldface** are vectors, the others are scalars.

Quantity	Volume content [unit]	Flux [unit]
matter	N [mol]	J [mol/s]
electric charge	Q [C]	$\mathcal{I}$ [C/s or A]
magnetic flux	$\mathcal{B}$ [Wb]	$\mathcal{E}$ [Wb/s or V]
energy	E [J]	Φ [J/s or W]
momentum	$\mathbf{P}$ [N s]	$\mathbf{F}$ [N]
angular momentum	$\mathbf{L}$ [N m s]	$\mathcal{T}$ [N m]
entropy	S [J/K]	Π [J/(K s)]

Table 1.2 Units for volume contents and fluxes of the main seven quantities.

Example solutions

💡 1.2

Exercise p. 7

1. “Distance is the product of a time lapse and a particular velocity”. See section 2.3 about *Radar distance* in our lecture notes.
2. “Acceleration is the ratio between a change in the product of a time lapse and a particular velocity, and the time taken by that change”.

💡 1.3

Exercise p. 7

These quantities are scalars:

- Time
- Distance
- Energy
- Speed
- Entropy
- Temperature
- Magnetic flux
- Electric charge
- Electric current
- Heat
- Power
- Volume

These quantities are vectors:

- Position
- Velocity
- Momentum
- Angular momentum
- Force

For *pressure*, it depends on the context. In some applications it is considered a scalar, but in other applications it is considered a vector – or actually a generalized kind of vector, called *tensor*, which can be represented by a matrix.

💡 1.4

Exercise p. 8

- *Volumic energy*: J/m^3
- *Energy flux*: J/s

- *Power*: J/s
- *Heating*: J/s
- *Magnetic flux*: Wb
- *Electric potential difference*: Wb/s
- *Force*: N
- *Momentum flux*: N
- *Momentum supply*: N
- *Pressure*: N/m²
- *Amount of substance*: mol
- *Molar mass*: kg/mol
- *Specific momentum*: N · s/kg $\equiv$ m/s
- *Volumic charge*: C/m³
- *Entropy*: J/K
- *Matter density*: mol/m³
- *Matter flux*: mol/s

 1.6

Exercise p. 9

- ▷ 11 J + 4 kg
Incorrect: cannot sum quantities of different dimension
- ▷ $\tan\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)$, where a dimension length and b has dimension time
Incorrect: trigonometric function must have a dimensionless argument, but a/b has dimension length/time
- ▷ 299 792 458 m/s
- ▷ $\exp\left(\frac{71 \text{ s}}{3 \text{ s}}\right)$
- ▷ $\cos(3.14) \text{ m}$
- ▷ $m - v$, where m has dimension of mass and v of velocity
Incorrect: cannot subtract quantities of different dimension
- ▷ $10 \text{ N s} - 2 \text{ kg m/s} = 8 \text{ J s/m}$
- ▷ $\exp(-8 \text{ J})$
Incorrect: exponential function must have a dimensionless argument, but this argument has dimension energy
- ▷ (9 m, 0.1 rad, -0.5 rad)

▷ $8 \text{ J/s} = 12 \text{ N m} - 4 \text{ N m}$

Incorrect: $\text{J/s} \neq \text{N m}$ (correct is $\text{J} = \text{N m}$)

▷ $e^{-8} \text{ J}$

▷ $\frac{15 \text{ J}}{5 \text{ kg/s}^2} = 3 \text{ m}^2$

▷ $\sqrt{25} \text{ K} = 5$

Incorrect: both sides of an equation must have the same dimension; here the left side has dimension $\text{length}^{1/2}$, right side is dimensionless

▷ $(e^7)^s$

Incorrect: cannot raise to a dimensional power

▷ $\tan\left(\frac{10 \text{ m}}{5 \text{ m}}\right)$

▷ $\sqrt{300 \text{ K}}$

▷ $\sin(t/s)$, where t has dimension of time

▷ $\frac{3}{s}$

▷ $\sin(10 \text{ s})$

Incorrect: trigonometric function must have a dimensionless argument

Time and space

2.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

2.1

Preferably together with a colleague:

The *Veritasium*¹ channel has many informative and entertaining videos on diverse scientific topics. Most of these videos are accurate and pedagogically very useful. But a couple of them contain some inaccuracies or partially faulty reasoning.

One example of partially inaccurate video is *Why no one has measured the speed of light*². It contains many correct and insightful statements and explanations, but also some faulty reasoning.

Watch the video and

1. Identify and ponder about some explanations that reflect what you learned so far. (For instance, do you recognize *radar distance* between $t=3:10$ and $t=3:20$?)
2. Consider the discussion between $t=4:57$ ³ and $t=5:14$, and the statement “and get a response 20 minutes later”. What kind of time is this statement referring to? is it proper time? if so, whose proper time? or is it coordinate time?
3. Consider the same snip and the statement “we imagine our signal takes 10 minutes to get there”. Draw a spacetime diagram (similar to fig. 2.1 in our main text) illustrating this statement. In the diagram, place the proper times on the worldline of the Earth station and on Mark’s worldline; and mark the points where the signal is sent and where it is received.

How can we imagine that it takes 10 minutes to get there? Which proper time are we speaking about?

4. Consider again the snip and the statement “it’s possible that our message took all 20 minutes to get there”. Draw a spacetime diagram illustrating this statement. What’s the difference from the previous spacetime diagram? Are the two spacetime diagrams actually different?
5. Now consider the discussion between $t=9:47^4$ and $t=10:16$, and the statement “one of the clocks will be ahead of the other”. When we say *ahead*, to which kind of time are we referring? is it proper time? if so, whose proper time? Does it make sense to say that one clock is “ahead” of the other?
6. Draw one or two spacetime diagrams illustrating the discussion in the snip above. Can we make sense of the discussion using the diagrams?
7. Find parts in which the reasoning offered in the video is inconsistent. For instance, find discussions where Derek says “right now”: does “right now” make sense in those discussions?

2.2

Preferably together with a colleague:

A particular coordinate system (t, x, y, z) with spatial Cartesian coordinates is defined as follows:

- The time coordinate t is your proper time.
- The origin of the coordinates is your navel
- The x -axis points in front of you, the y -axis to your left, the z -axis upwards (through the top of your head).
- The unit coordinate is 1 m, measured as usual.

Answer the following questions:

1. What are your position $\mathbf{r}(t)$ and velocity $\mathbf{v}(t)$ in this coordinate system while you sleep? (Let’s say that by “your position” we mean the position of your navel.)
2. What are your position $\mathbf{r}(t)$ and velocity $\mathbf{v}(t)$ while you run or bike or drive to school?
3. What is your acceleration $\mathbf{a}(t)$ in different situations?
4. Determine the z coordinate of the floor in this coordinate system, when you are standing still.

5. Determine the spatial coordinates of the tip of the index finger of your right hand, when it is extended horizontally outwards.

**2.3**

Solution p. 19

1. You're told that the position $\mathbf{r}(t)$ of an object is constant in time t . How much is the velocity $\mathbf{v}(t)$?
2. If the velocity $\mathbf{v}(t_0)$ is zero at a time t_0 , must also the acceleration $\mathbf{a}(t_0)$ be zero at time t_0 ?
3. Is it possible for a coordinate velocity $v_x(t_1)$ to be positive at a time t_1 , and the acceleration $a_x(t_1)$ negative at the same time? If not, explain why not. If yes, show by constructing a concrete example and explain what this situation means physically.

**2.4**

Solution p. 19

We have a coordinate system (t, x) with one spatial dimension only. A small object S has position $x_S(t)$ which changes with the coordinate time t . The time dependence of the position is given by

$$x_S(t) = at + b \quad \text{with} \quad a = -3 \text{ m/s}, \quad b = 7 \text{ m}.$$

1. Verify that the equation above is dimensionally consistent.
2. What is the spatial coordinate of S at times $t = 0 \text{ s}$, $t = -10 \text{ s}$, and $t = 5 \text{ s}$?
3. What is the spatial coordinate of S at time $t = 10$?
4. Calculate the time dependence of the coordinate velocity of S.
5. What is the coordinate velocity of S at time $t = 5 \text{ s}$?
6. What is the *speed* of S at time $t = 5 \text{ s}$?
7. Calculate the time dependence of the coordinate acceleration of S.

**2.5**

Solution p. 19

We have a coordinate system (t, x) with one spatial dimension only. A small object S has position $x_S(t)$ given by

$$x_S(t) = L \sin(\omega t) + b \quad \text{with} \quad L = 2 \text{ m}, \quad \omega = \frac{\pi}{3} \text{ s}^{-1}, \quad b = 7 \text{ m}.$$

1. Verify that the equation above is dimensionally consistent.
2. Calculate the expressions for velocity $\dot{x}_S(t)$ and acceleration $\ddot{x}_S(t)$.
3. Find a time t_0 in which the velocity is 0 m/s and the acceleration is approximately -2.2 m/s^2 .
4. Find a time t_1 in which the velocity is approximately -2.1 m/s and the acceleration is 0 m/s^2 .
5. Plot $x_S(t)$ and $\dot{x}_S(t)$ as functions of time for $t \in [-4, 4] \text{ s}$.

**2.6**

Solution p. 20

We have a coordinate system (t, x, y, z) , where the three spatial coordinates have each dimension length. A small object S has position $\mathbf{r}_S(t)$ given by

$$\mathbf{r}_S(t) = \begin{bmatrix} at + b \\ L \sin(\omega t) + b \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{with } L = 2 \text{ m}, \omega = \frac{\pi}{3} \text{ s}^{-1}, a = -3 \text{ m/s}, b = 7 \text{ m/s}.$$

1. Verify that the equation above is dimensionally consistent.
2. Calculate the expressions for velocity $\mathbf{v}_S(t)$ and acceleration $\mathbf{a}_S(t)$.
3. Plot the three components of the velocity as functions of time for $t \in [-4, 4] \text{ s}$.

**2.7**

Solution p. 21

We have a coordinate system (t, z) with one spatial dimension only. The coordinate velocity $v_z(t)$ of a small pulse of light travelling in a particular material is given by

$$v_z(t) = c \exp(-t/\tau) \quad \text{with } c = 299\,792\,458 \text{ m/s}, \tau = 0.08 \text{ s},$$

and the pulse is located at $z = -2 \text{ m}$ at $t = 1 \text{ s}$.

1. Find the expression for the position $z(t)$ of the pulse as a function of coordinate time.
2. Find the location of the pulse at time $t = 1.01 \text{ s}$.

Example solutions

💡 2.3

Exercise p. 17

1. The derivative of a constant is zero, so the velocity is $\boldsymbol{v}(t) = 0 \text{ m/s}$. We must not forget the correct units!
2. No, we can have zero velocity and non-zero acceleration at a given time. See exercise 2.5 as an example.
3. No, we can have positive velocity and negative acceleration at a given time. See exercise 2.5 as an example. It means that, at that time, the movement is in the positive- x direction (positive x -velocity), and the x -velocity is decreasing – that is, it will be positive but smaller a very short time later.

💡 2.4

Exercise p. 17

1. It is, provided that t has dimension time and x has dimension length. In this case, since a has dimension length/time, then $a t$ has dimension length, which is added to b which also has dimension length; the left and right side have then both dimension length.
2. $x_S(0 \text{ s}) = 7 \text{ m}$, $x_S(-10 \text{ s}) = 37 \text{ m}$, $x_S(5 \text{ s}) = -8 \text{ m}$.
3. The question doesn't make sense, because " $t = 10$ " is dimensionless; it should have dimension length instead.
4. Denoting with $\dot{x}_S$ the coordinate velocity of S, then $\dot{x}_S(t) = a$, which is constant in time.
5. $\dot{x}_S(t) = -3 \text{ m/s}$ at any time.
6. The speed is $|\dot{x}_S(t)| = 3 \text{ m/s}$ at any time.
7. Denoting with $\ddot{x}_S$ the coordinate acceleration of S, then $\ddot{x}_S(t) = 0 \text{ m/s}^2$, which is zero at all times.

💡 2.5

Exercise p. 17

1. The expression is dimensionally correct, provided t has dimension time and x has dimension length. The argument of the sine function is dimensionless, and the two terms on the right have dimension length.
2. From the rules for the derivative,

$$\dot{x}_S(t) = \omega L \cos(\omega t) , \quad \ddot{x}_S(t) = -\omega^2 L \sin(\omega t) .$$

3. The time t_0 must satisfy the system of equations

$$\omega L \cos(\omega t) = 0 \text{ m/s} \quad - \omega^2 L \sin(\omega t) \approx -2.2 \text{ m/s}^2 .$$

The cosine is zero when its argument is $\pi/2, 3\pi/2$, and so on. Let's try taking $\omega t_0 = \pi/2$, which means $t_0 = \pi/(2\omega)$. We find indeed

$$\dot{x}_S(t_0) = \omega L \cos(\omega t_0) = 0 \text{ m/s} \quad \ddot{x}_S(t_0) = -\omega^2 L \sin(\omega t_0) \approx -2.19 \text{ m/s}^2 .$$

4. The time t_1 must satisfy the system of equations

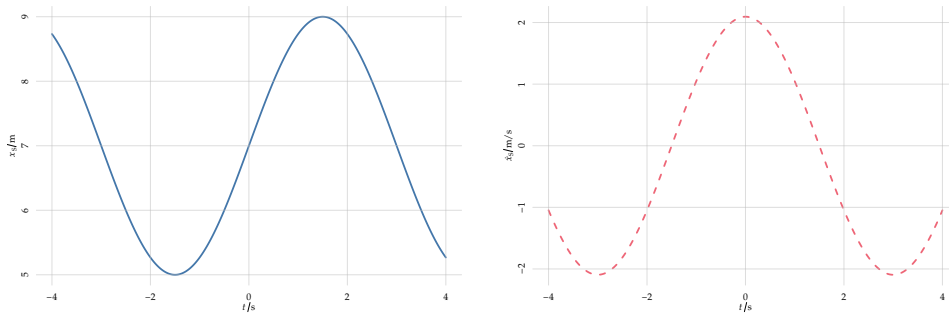
$$\omega L \cos(\omega t) = -2.1 \text{ m/s} \quad - \omega^2 L \sin(\omega t) \approx 0 \text{ m/s}^2 .$$

The sine is zero when its argument is $0, \pi$, and so on. Let's try taking $\omega t_1 = 0$, which means $t_1 = 0 \text{ s}$. We find

$$\omega L \cos(\omega t_1) \approx 2.09 \text{ m/s} \quad - \omega^2 L \sin(\omega t_1) = 0 \text{ m/s}^2 ,$$

which is not what we want. Trying next $\omega t_1 = \pi$, which means $t_1 = \pi/\omega$, leads to the desired result.

5. We can plot x_S and $\dot{x}_S$ in two separate graphs:



Or we could plot them on the same graph – but only if we indicate separately the vertical axis for x_S and the one for $\dot{x}_S$ (for instance one on the left and one on the right), because these quantities have different dimensions.

2.6

Exercise p. 18

1. No, the expression is not dimensionally correct, because the z component of $\mathbf{r}_S$ is "0", which is a dimensionless number, whereas z has dimension length. The z component should be "0 m".
2. See exercises 2.4 and 2.5 😊

 2.7

Exercise p. 18

1. Let's call the specific position $z_0 := -2 \text{ m}$ at $t_0 = 1 \text{ s}$. The expression for $z(t)$ is found integrating $v_z(t)$ between t_0 and t , and adding the position at t_0 :

$$z(t) = z_0 + \int_{t_0}^t c \exp(-t/\tau) dt$$

$$= z_0 - c\tau \exp(-t/\tau) \Big|_{t_0}^t$$

$$= z_0 - c\tau [\exp(-t/\tau) - \exp(-t_0/\tau)]$$

$$\text{with } c = 299\,792\,458 \text{ m/s}, \tau = 0.08 \text{ s}, z_0 = -2 \text{ m}, t_0 = 1 \text{ s}.$$

2. Substituting in the expression above, $z(1.01 \text{ s}) = 8.50 \text{ m}$.

URLs for chapter 2

1. <https://www.youtube.com/c/veritasium/videos>
2. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pTn6Ewhb27k>
3. <https://youtu.be/pTn6Ewhb27k?t=297>
4. <https://youtu.be/pTn6Ewhb27k?t=588>

Main physical quantities

3.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

3.1

Solution p. 26

We have seen that six of the seven main physical quantities have two important properties:

- We can speak about their *content*, *flux*, and *supply*.
 - They are *extensive*: for instance if a 3D region consists of two non-overlapping 3D subregions, then the content in the region is the sum of the content in the subregions. Similarly for flux and surfaces (2D regions).
1. Can you think of some physical quantity that has the property of extensivity, but for which it doesn't make sense to speak of "content" or of "flux" or of "supply"?
 2. Vice versa, can you think of some physical quantity for which we can speak of content, flux, supply, but which doesn't have the property of extensivity?

3.2

Solution p. 26

Do a little research, and find out whether there are any physics disciplines in which *mass* is usually measured in units of *energy*.

3.3

With a colleague or a large language model:

Take turns to explain to each other what is the difference between *matter* and *mass*. Try to find weak points in each other's explanations.

3.4

1. Imagine that someone tells you this:

An important difference between *matter* and *electric charge* is that electric charge can be both positive and negative, whereas matter can only be positive.

How would you reply? Can you give counterexamples to this statement?

2. The same person tells you:

In nature we observe both positive and negative electric charge equally easily. But we mostly observe ‘positive’ matter, and very rarely ‘negative’ matter (antimatter).

Do some research and find out whether this statement is true.

3.5

Someone tells you:

Mass and *energy* are two different things. I can experimentally prove it to you: Take a battery for example, and weigh it to measure its mass. Now use the battery for some device. As you use it, the battery loses energy; in fact eventually it can’t power the device anymore. But if you weigh it again, you’ll find that it has the same mass as before. Therefore mass and energy must be two different things.

How would you reply to this person?

3.6

Solution p. [26](#)

Let’s say you use a coordinate system (x, y, z) . In a given 3D region of space you measure a net amount (content) of momentum $\mathbf{P} = [2, -3, 0]$ N s. Which of the following statements are true? which false? Explain why.

1. There must be some non-zero electric charge in the 3D region.
2. The net amount of momentum has zero z -component.
3. There must be some matter (or antimatter) in the 3D region.
4. The 3D region must be enough small.

5. Some kind of motion, with respect to your coordinate system, must be occurring in the 3D region.
6. Any scientist measuring the net momentum in the 3D region would agree that its value is $[2, -3, 0]$ N s.
7. Whatever it is that contributes to the net momentum, it must be uniformly spread out through the whole 3D region.

Example solutions

💡 3.1

Exercise p. 23

[Before reading this answer, keep in mind that the word volume has two different meanings: sometimes we use it in the sense of “3D region of space”; sometimes in the sense of the size of a 3D region of space (measured in cubic metres for instance).]

1. One example is the *volume* of a 3D region. It is extensive, because the volume of two non-overlapping 3D regions together is the sum of their volumes. But it doesn't make much sense to speak of the “flux” of volume through a surface. Similarly for *area*.
2. The writer of this solution doesn't know any example of such a physical quantity. It is possible to define mathematical objects that behave this strange way, but no physical quantity seems to be represented by such objects.

💡 3.2

Exercise p. 23

One example is **particle physics**¹, where the rest mass of subatomic particles is measured in *electronvolts*, denoted ‘eV’, which is a unit for energy equal to $1.602\,176\,634 \times 10^{-19}$ J. Other examples are special relativity and general relativity.

💡 3.6

Exercise p. 24

1. *False*. There can be momentum in a region even if the net electric charge is zero.
2. *True*. z is the third coordinate, and the third momentum component is 0 N s.
3. *False*. Electromagnetic fields have momentum, so in the region there could be only an electromagnetic field, such as a beam of light, but no matter.
4. *False*. We can speak of the net amount of momentum in arbitrarily large regions.
5. *True*. Momentum is associated with the motion of matter or of electromagnetic fields.

6. *False.* The amount of momentum depends on the coordinate system we choose; so scientists that use coordinates different from yours will measure a different net momentum – it could even be completely zero.
7. *False.* The matter or electromagnetic field that possess the momentum might be concentrated in one or several small regions within the 3D region, for example.

URLs for chapter 3

1. <https://cms.cern/content/glossary#E>

Content, flux, supply

4.0

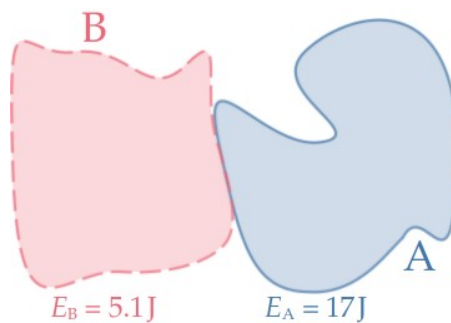
(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

4.1

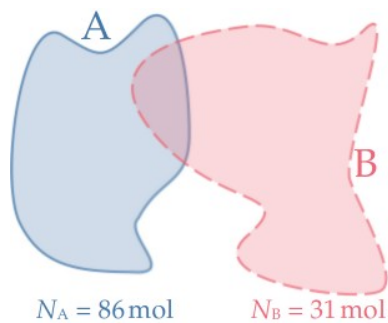
Solution p. 38

In the following figures, **region A** is indicated in blue and a solid contour, and **region B** is indicated in red and a dashed contour (they are 2D simplified representations of 3D regions). For each figure determine, if possible, the net volume content of the corresponding quantities in the region comprising A and B. If not possible, explain why.

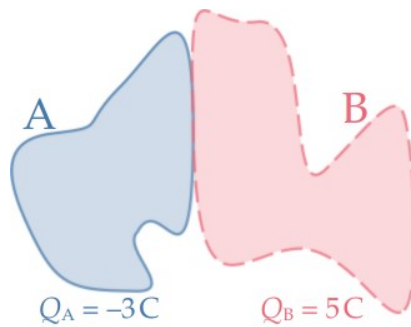
1. Energy-mass:



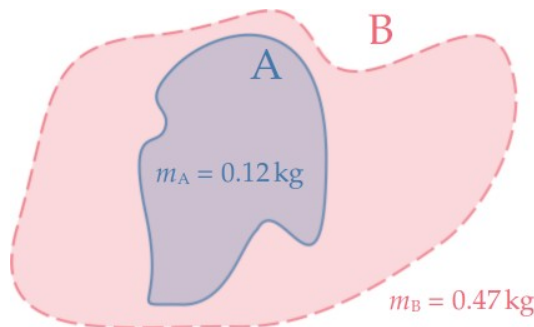
2. Matter:



3. Electric charge:



4. Energy-mass:

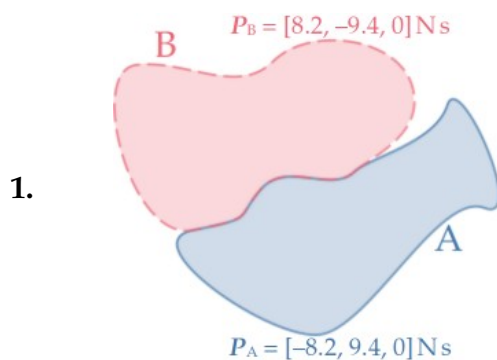


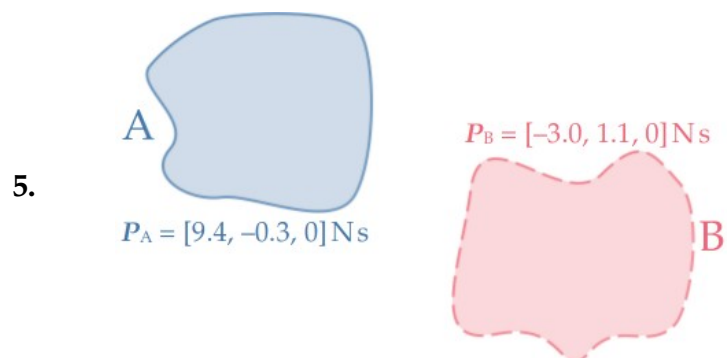
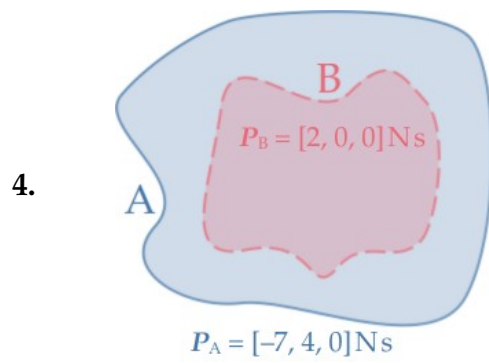
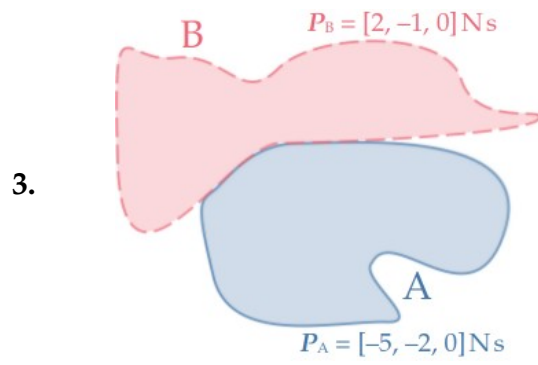
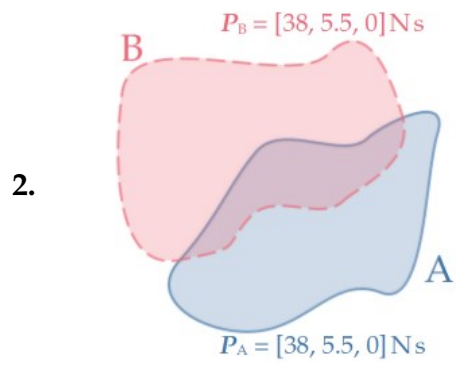
4.2

Solution p. 38

In the following figures, **region A** is indicated in blue and a solid contour, and **region B** is indicated in red and a dashed contour (they are 2D simplified representations of 3D regions). Use a coordinate system (x, y, z) where x is horizontal to the right, y is vertical upwards on the page, and z comes out of the page towards you. For each figure:

- draw the vectors representing the momentum contents of A and B;
- determine, if possible, the net volume content of momentum in the region comprising A and B; if not possible, explain why.





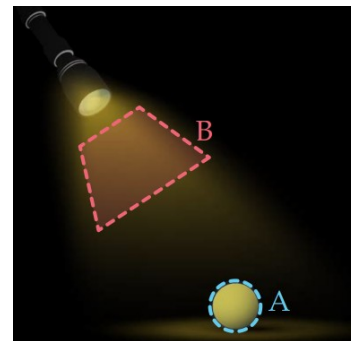
4.3

Solution p. 38

In the side figure, consider **volume A**, which contains the ball, and **volume B**, occupied by the light beam. Imagine there's no air (although in reality if there were no air we wouldn't be able to see the light beam).

In a given coordinate system, the momentum content of volume A is $\mathbf{P}_A = [1, 0, 0] \text{ N s}$, and that of volume B is $\mathbf{P}_B = [2, -2, 1] \times 10^{-16} \text{ N s}$.

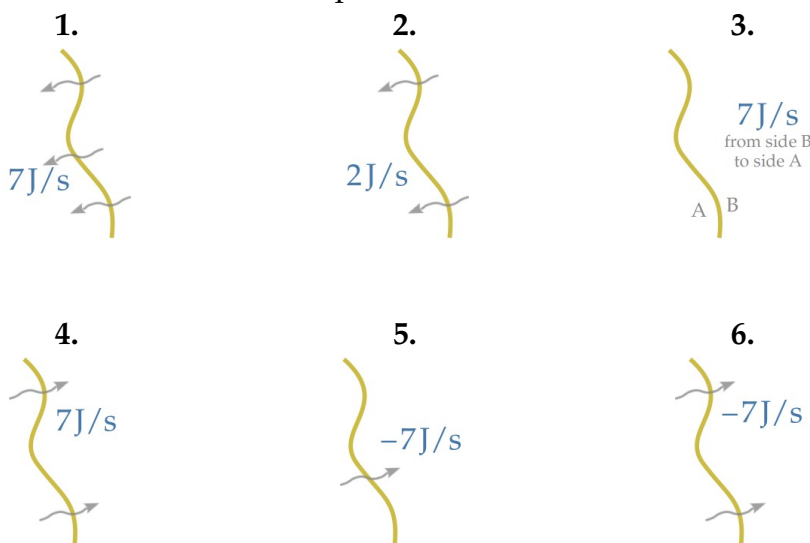
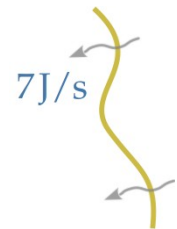
Does it really make sense to speak of the momentum in volume B (remember there's no air there)? If it does make sense, how much is the net momentum content of volumes A and B considered together?



4.4

Solution p. 39

Take a look at the energy flux through a surface represented in the side figure. Which of the representations below is completely equivalent to the one on the side? Which does represent a different flux instead?



4.5

Solution p. 39

An ordinary battery is attached to wires and is powering some device. This means that there is a flow of electromagnetic energy from the battery to the device. Imagine a control surface around the battery, as illustrated in the side figure. Can you guess across which parts of the control surface is the flux of energy? Is it across the whole surface? or only across the parts where the wire is? Do a little research to find out.



4.6

Solution p. 39

A cuboid region is delimited by a closed control surface that can be divided into six parts; call them 'up', 'down', 'front', 'back', 'left', 'right'. They are all have an inward crossing direction, except for 'back' which has an outward crossing direction.

Here are the fluxes of various quantities through the six surfaces in the given crossing directions. Calculate the total net **influxes**.

$$1. \quad J_u = 23.9 \text{ mol/s} \quad J_d = -8.1 \text{ mol/s} \quad J_f = 0.9 \text{ mol/s} \\ J_b = -30.5 \text{ mol/s} \quad J_l = 2.3 \text{ mol/s} \quad J_r = 37.6 \text{ mol/s}$$

$$2. \quad \Phi_u = -24.6 \text{ J/s} \quad \Phi_d = 2.4 \text{ J/s} \quad \Phi_f = 1.3 \text{ J/s} \\ \Phi_b = 10.8 \text{ J/s} \quad \Phi_l = 15.4 \text{ J/s} \quad \Phi_r = -2.1 \text{ J/s}$$

$$3. \quad I_u = -9.7 \text{ C/s} \quad I_d = 27.4 \text{ C/s} \quad I_f = -6.3 \text{ C/s} \\ I_b = 16.4 \text{ C/s} \quad I_l = -25.1 \text{ C/s} \quad I_r = -20.0 \text{ C/s}$$

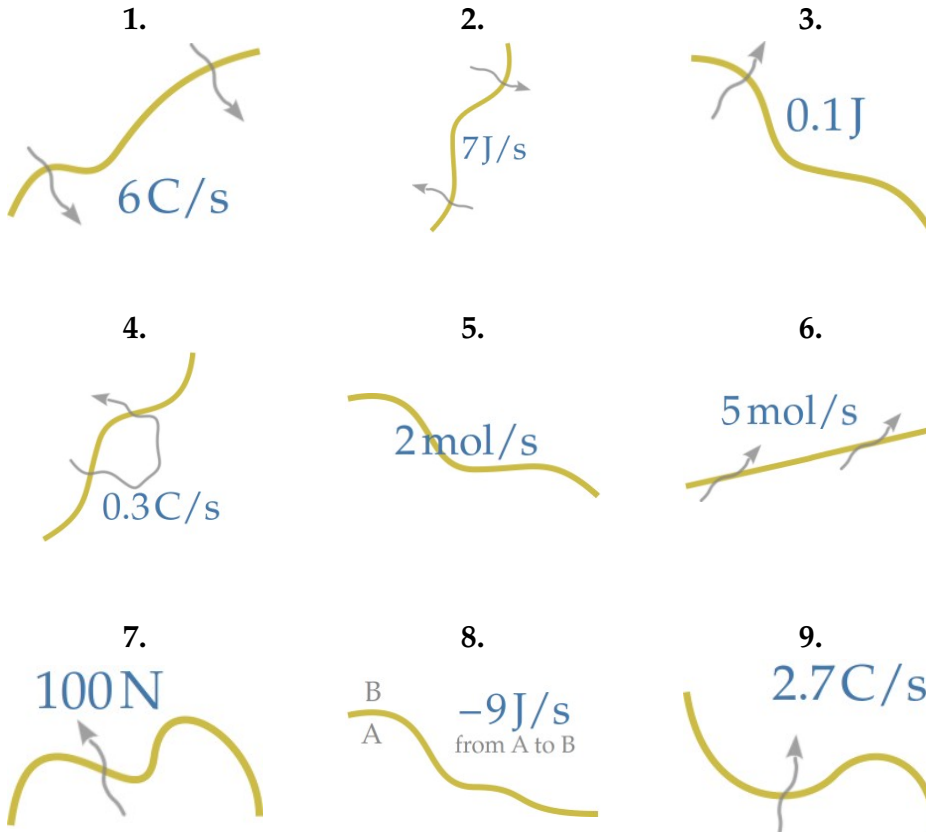
$$4. \quad \Pi_u = 31.7 \text{ J/(K s)} \quad \Pi_d = 17.9 \text{ J/(K s)} \quad \Pi_f = 7.2 \text{ J/(K s)} \\ \Pi_b = -20.4 \text{ J/(K s)} \quad \Pi_l = -16.5 \text{ J/(K s)} \quad \Pi_r = -4.8 \text{ J/(K s)}$$

$$5. \quad \mathbf{F}_u = [25.2, -42.7, 4.1] \text{ N} \quad \mathbf{F}_d = [-46.3, -5.9, -33.3] \text{ N} \\ \mathbf{F}_f = [10.2, -16.2, -36.7] \text{ N} \quad \mathbf{F}_b = [-9.8, 19.5, -60.0] \text{ N} \\ \mathbf{F}_l = [29.5, 18.3, 58.4] \text{ N} \quad \mathbf{F}_r = [16.0, 1.2, -3.2] \text{ N}$$

4.7

Solution p. 40

Which of the following graphical representations of fluxes do make sense? Which don't? Explain why.



4.8

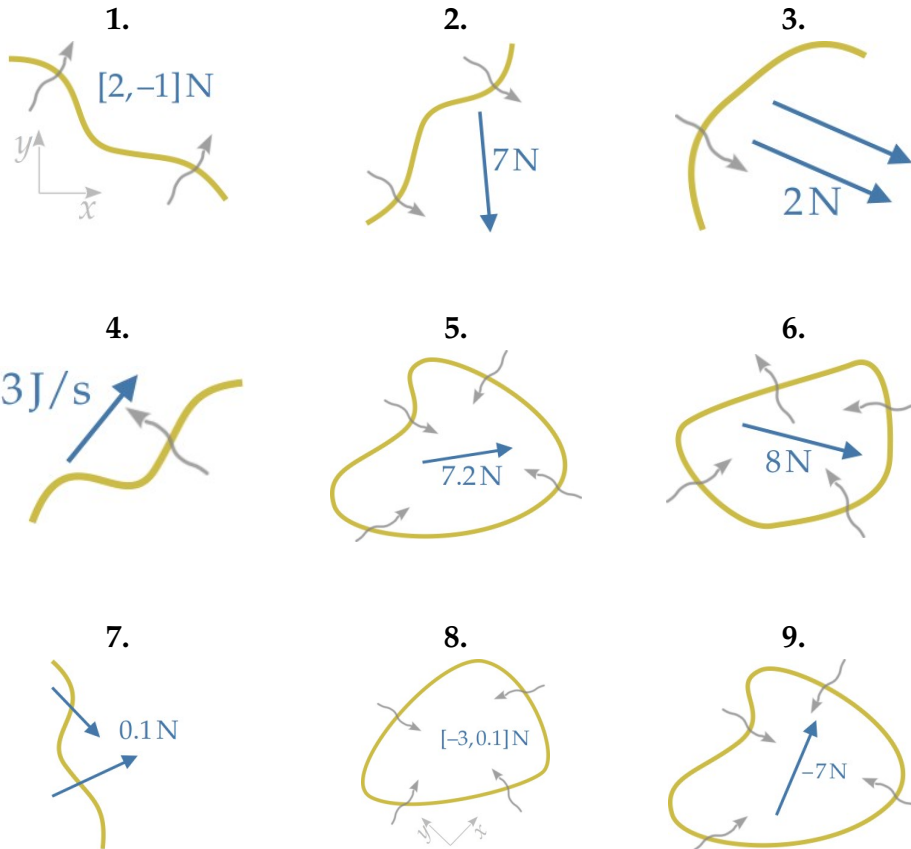
Solution p. 40

1. A control volume contains $[2, -3, 1]\text{Ns}$ of momentum. Momentum is a quantity related to movement. Does this mean that the control volume is moving?
2. Suppose that through a control surface, in a given crossing direction, there is a non-zero flux of momentum. Does this mean that the control surface must be in motion?
3. If through a control surface there's a non-zero flux of some quantity, does it mean that the fluxes of all other quantities must be zero?
4. Can there be a flux of temperature through a control surface?

4.9

Solution p. 41

Which of the following graphical representations of fluxes do make sense? Which don't? Explain why.

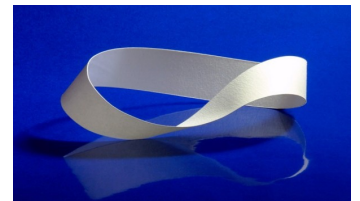


4.10

Solution p. 42

The **Möbius band**¹ is a surface that, in a certain sense, has only *one* side. It is quite easy to make with a strip of paper and some tape.

Do you manage to choose a definite crossing direction on this surface? Do you think it could be chosen as a control surface?



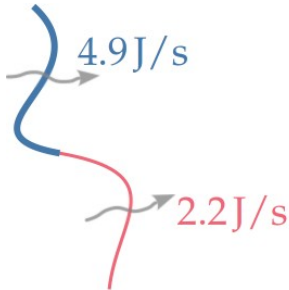
4.11

Solution p. 43

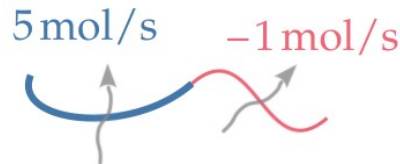
For each figure, calculate and draw, or describe precisely, the net total flux through the composite control surface. (The different parts are differen-

tiated by different colours and thicknesses.) Don't forget to specify the crossing direction when you speak about a flux.

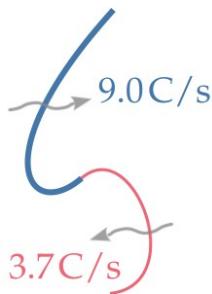
1.



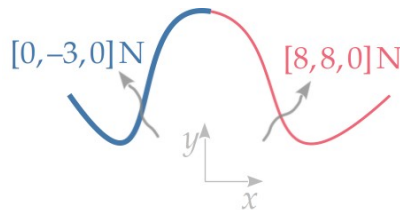
2.



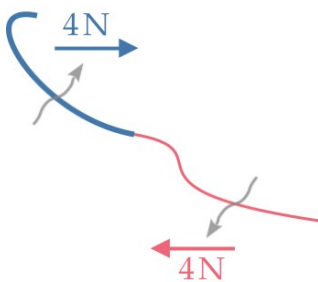
3.



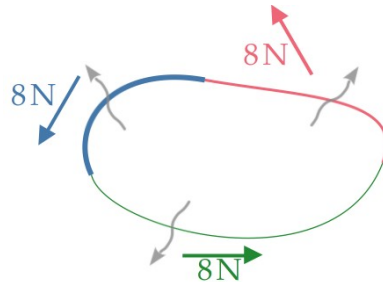
4.



5.



6.



4.12

Solution p. 43

1. Through a particular closed control surface there's a continuous influx of electric charge $I(t)$ with the following time dependence:

$$I(t) = A \sin(\omega t) \quad \text{with} \quad A = 30 \text{ C/s}, \quad \omega = 376.991 \, 184 \text{ s}^{-1}.$$

How much is the time-integrated influx of charge between times $t_0 = 10 \text{ s}$ and $t_1 = 40 \text{ s}$?

2. Imagine a closed control surface around the planet Mercury. The energy $\Phi(t)$ influx through this control surface is approximately given by

$$\Phi(t) = W + u \cos(\sigma t)$$

with $W = 2 \times 10^{17} \text{ J/s}$, $u = 8 \times 10^{16} \text{ J/s}$, $\sigma = 8 \times 10^{-7} \text{ s}^{-1}$.

Mercury's year lasts around 88 Earth-days. How much is the time-integrated influx of energy over a year on Mercury?

3. A football has a mass-energy $m = 0.4 \text{ kg}$. The football has a continuous supply of momentum $\mathbf{G}(t)$ from the Earth's gravitational field. This supply is constant in time and given by

$$\mathbf{G}(t) = m\mathbf{g} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

where $\mathbf{g} = 9.8 \text{ N/kg}$, and we are using a coordinate system (t, x, y, z) where z is vertical with respect to the ground and points upwards.

How much is the time-integrated influx of momentum in the football between times $t_0 = 0 \text{ s}$ and $t_1 = 3600 \text{ s}$?

Example solutions

💡 4.1

Exercise p. 29

1. Net energy-mass content is $E_A + E_B = 22.1$ J.
2. Unknown: A and B are overlapping, so we cannot simply add their contents. The result depends on the net matter content in the overlap region, which is unknown.
3. Net electric-charge content is $Q_A + Q_B = 2$ C.
4. A and B are overlapping, so we cannot simply add their mass-energy contents. But in this case A is a subregion of B, so the full region occupied by both is B itself. The net mass-energy content in this region is therefore $m_B = 0.47$ kg. We can also deduce that the net mass-energy content in the region between A and B is $m_B - m_A = 0.35$ kg.

💡 4.2

Exercise p. 30

1. Net momentum content is $\mathbf{P}_A + \mathbf{P}_B = [0, 0, 0]$ N s.
2. Unknown: A and B are overlapping, so we cannot simply add their momentum contents. The result depends on the net momentum content in the overlap region, which is unknown.
3. Net momentum content is $\mathbf{P}_A + \mathbf{P}_B = [-3, -3, 0]$ N s.
4. A and B are overlapping, so we cannot simply add their momentum contents. But in this case B is a subregion of A, so the full region occupied by both is A itself. The net momentum content in this region is therefore $\mathbf{P}_A = [-7, 4, 0]$ N s. We can also deduce that the net momentum content in the region between B and A is $\mathbf{P}_A - \mathbf{P}_B = [-9, 4, 0]$ N s.
5. Net momentum content is $\mathbf{P}_A + \mathbf{P}_B = [6.4, 0.8, 0]$ N s. The region consisting of A and B together is a spatially disconnected region, but we can speak of volume content even for such kind of regions.

💡 4.3

Exercise p. 32

Yes, it does make sense. First of all, we can *always* speak of the momentum content in *any* 3D region; it isn't important whether there's matter or electromagnetic fields or not in that region. If it's completely empty, its momentum content is simply zero. Second, in volume B in the figure there's an electromagnetic field, which does have momentum just like matter.

The net momentum content in the volumes A and B considered together is $\mathbf{P}_A + \mathbf{P}_B \approx [1, -2 \times 10^{-16}, 1 \times 10^{-16}] \text{ N s}$.

💡 4.4

Exercise p. 32

1.

Same 👍

Same crossing direction, same flux magnitude. Wiggly arrows only indicate the crossing direction, it doesn't matter how many there are.

2.

Different 🗑️

This flux has a different magnitude.

3.

Same 👍

Same crossing direction, same flux magnitude. Crossing direction is indicated verbally.

4.

Different 🗑️

This flux has same magnitude but opposite direction.

5.

Same 👍

Same flux, by the principle of symmetry of flux.

6.

Same 👍

Same flux, by the principle of symmetry of flux.

💡 4.5

Exercise p. 32

The flux of electromagnetic energy occurs – that is, it is non-zero – across *every part of the control surface*, not just across the parts close to the wire.

In general the flow of electromagnetic energy occurs especially around wires, which act as sort of guides; but it extends to all space.

Two good videos for learning more about this are Veritasium's *The big misconception about electricity*² and *How electricity actually works*³. More detailed examples, calculations, and figures can be found for example in Jackson 1996 (see especially fig. 4), Davis & Kaplan 2011, Harbola 2010, Boyer 2019.



💡 4.6

Exercise p. 33

To calculate the efflux across the whole surface we use the principle of extensivity. The fluxes across the 'back' surface get a minus sign, because that surface had an inward crossing direction.

$$1. J_{\text{tot}} = J_u + J_d + J_f - J_b + J_l + J_r = 87.1 \text{ mol/s}$$

2. $\Phi_{\text{tot}} = \Phi_u + \Phi_d + \Phi_f - \Phi_b + \Phi_l + \Phi_r = -18.4 \text{ J/s}$
3. $\mathcal{I}_{\text{tot}} = \mathcal{I}_u + \mathcal{I}_d + \mathcal{I}_f - \mathcal{I}_b + \mathcal{I}_l + \mathcal{I}_r = -50.1 \text{ C/s}$
4. $\Pi_{\text{tot}} = \Pi_u + \Pi_d + \Pi_f - \Pi_b + \Pi_l + \Pi_r = -50.1 \text{ C/s}$
5. $\mathbf{F}_{\text{tot}} = \mathbf{F}_u + \mathbf{F}_d + \mathbf{F}_f - \mathbf{F}_b + \mathbf{F}_l + \mathbf{F}_r = [44.4, -64.8, 49.3] \text{ C/s}$

💡 4.7

Exercise p. 34

- | | | |
|---|---|--|
| <p>1.
Makes sense 👍</p> | <p>2.
No 🙅
Crossing direction is unclear.</p> | <p>3.
No 🙅
'J' is not the unit of a flux.</p> |
| <p>4.
No 🙅
Crossing direction is unclear.</p> | <p>5.
No 🙅
Crossing direction is missing.</p> | <p>6.
Makes sense 👍
The arrows for the crossing direction are very tilted, but crossing direction is still clear.</p> |
| <p>7.
No 🙅
'N' is the unit of a vector flux, but there's no vector or vector components here.</p> | <p>8.
Makes sense 👍
Alternative way of indicating the crossing direction, but perfectly clear.</p> | <p>9.
Makes sense 👍</p> |

💡 4.8

Exercise p. 34

1. No. If a control volume contains momentum, then something like matter or electromagnetic field is moving within the volume; but the volume itself may be static. This is because a control volume is just an imaginary delimitation of a region of space, not a physical object; we decide how it moves. In some situations we may decide that it should move together with the matter or electromagnetic field it contains, but in other situations we may keep it static.
2. No, for analogous reasons as in the answer above.

3. No: *in principle* the fluxes of the seven quantities are independent and can all be non-zero; or some can be zero and others non-zero.
4. No: we can speak of the temperature at a point at a given time, but we cannot speak of volume content or flux or supply of temperature. Temperature is not an extensive quantity.

💡 4.9

Exercise p. 35

1.

Makes sense 👍

This vector flux is expressed in components, and the coordinates are shown: we can reconstruct the vector if needed.

2.

Makes sense 👍

3.

No 👎

There should be only one vector indicating the flux. Unclear if this flux should have magnitude 4 N.

4.

No 👎

'J/s' is the unit of a **scalar** flux, but there's a vector here. Either the unit is wrong or the vector is there by mistake.

5.

Makes sense 👍

This is a total influx.

6.

No 👎

The wiggly arrows that indicate the crossing direction are not mutually consistent.

7.

No 👎

Unclear if one of the two arrows indicates a crossing direction.

8.

Makes sense 👍

Total influx again. The flux is expressed in components, and the coordinates are shown.

9.

No 👎

The magnitude of a vector cannot be negative.

💡 4.10

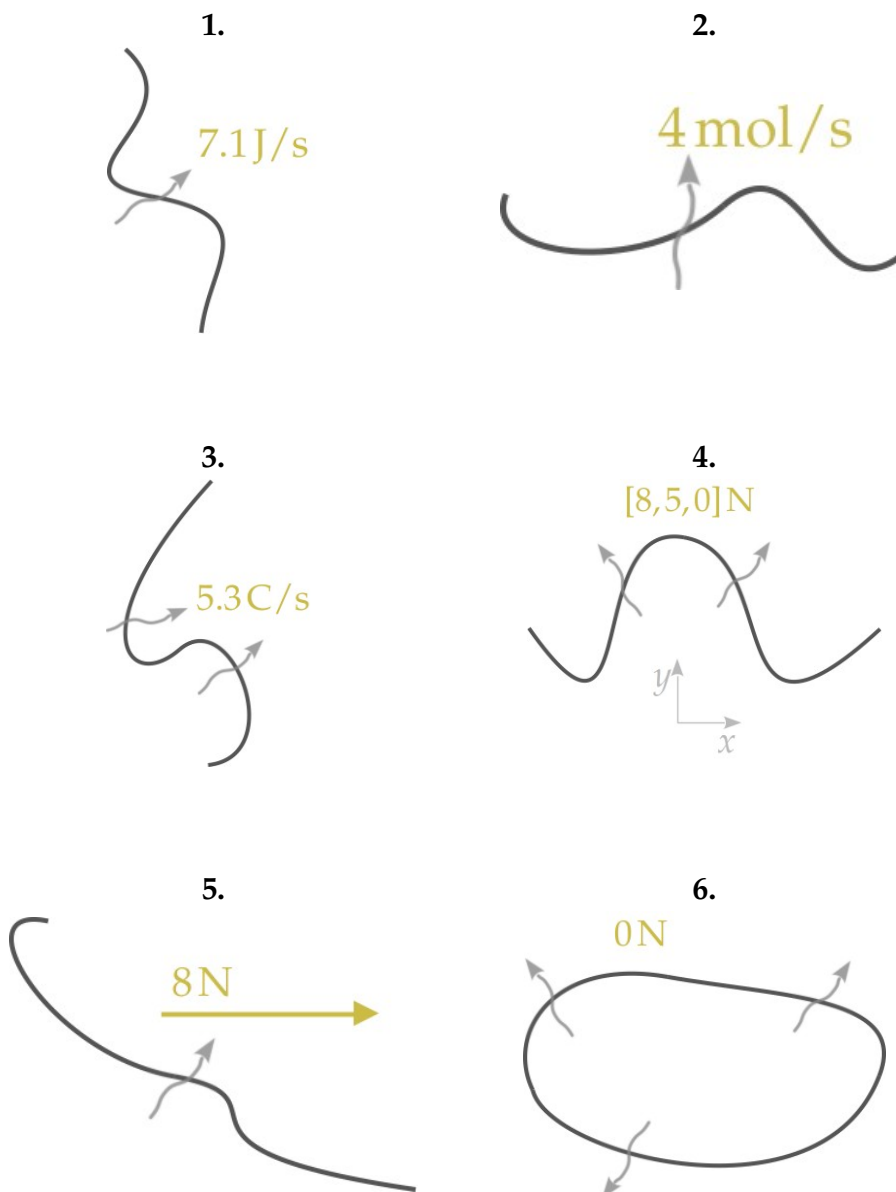
Exercise p. 35

You have noticed that if you try to choose consistently a crossing direction on the whole band, you end up where you started but with an *opposite* crossing direction. For this reason the Möbius band cannot be used as a control surface: it cannot be given an overall crossing direction. The lack of crossing direction is related to another peculiarity: it is impossible to extend this surface in such a way as to enclose a three-dimensional region of space.

If we clip a part of the Möbius band, that part can be used as a control surface. Or if we clip the band so that it gets an extra border, then it becomes the same as a twisted rectangle, and so it can be used as a control surface.

💡 4.11

Exercise p. 35



💡 4.12

Exercise p. 36

1. The time-integrated flux of charge is found with a time integral. Note that the result has a dimension of electric charge: this is the net amount of charge that flowed through the control surface, in the given crossing

direction, between the two times:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{I}(t) dt &= \int_{t_0}^{t_1} A \sin(\omega t) dt = -\frac{A}{\omega} \cos(\omega t) \Big|_{t_0}^{t_1} \\ &\approx -796 \text{ C} \cdot (1 - 1) = 0 \text{ C} .\end{aligned}$$

So even if the flux of charge most of the time is non-zero, reaching a maximum of $\pm 30 \text{ C/s}$, the *net* amount of charge crossing the surface in the given direction during the 30 s is zero. This is because the flux is sometimes positive, sometimes negative.

2. 88 Earth-days are approximately equal to $88 \cdot 24 \cdot 60 \cdot 60 \text{ s} \approx 7\,600\,000 \text{ s}$.
So we time-integrate between $t_0 = 0 \text{ s}$ and $t_1 = 7\,600\,000 \text{ s}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt &= \int_{t_0}^{t_1} [W + u \cos(\sigma t)] dt = Wt \Big|_{t_0}^{t_1} + \frac{u}{\sigma} \sin(\sigma t) \Big|_{t_0}^{t_1} \\ &\approx 1.5 \times 10^{24} \text{ J} + 1 \times 10^{23} \text{ J} \cdot (-0.2 - 0) \\ &\approx 1.5 \times 10^{24} \text{ J} .\end{aligned}$$

3. Recall that time-integrating a vector simply means time-integrating each component. In this case the supply is constant, so integration is easy:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G}(t) dt &= \int_{t_0}^{t_1} m \mathbf{g} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} dt \\ &= m \mathbf{g} \begin{bmatrix} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 0 dt \\ \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 0 dt \\ -\int_{t_0}^{t_1} 1 dt \end{bmatrix} = m \mathbf{g} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ s} \\ 0 \text{ s} \\ -t \end{bmatrix} \Big|_{t_0}^{t_1} = m \mathbf{g} \left(\begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ s} \\ 0 \text{ s} \\ -t_1 \end{bmatrix} - \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ s} \\ 0 \text{ s} \\ -t_0 \end{bmatrix} \right) \\ &\approx 3.9 \text{ N} \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -3600 \end{bmatrix} \text{ s} \approx \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -1.4 \times 10^4 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} .\end{aligned}$$

This net amount of momentum is vertical, pointing downward. But note that we don't know whether the football contains this much momentum after 3600 s, because we don't know how much the flux of momentum into the football was. It's possible that the flux of momentum completely balanced this supply of momentum.

URLs for chapter 4

1. <https://mathworld.wolfram.com/MoebiusStrip.html>
2. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bHIhgxav9LY>
3. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oI_X2cMHNe0

Physical laws

5.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

5.1

Solution p. [51](#)

For each question:

-  Identify and describe the closed control surface and control volume used.
-  Identify which among volume content, flux, supply, are given, and how much they are; identify which are unknown.
-  Find the requested quantity, if possible, by using a balance or conservation law as specified in the question, showing all mathematical steps. If not possible, explain why.

1. At a time of 0 s, a tank contains 10 mol of water, plus other substances. The tank is sealed. In a time lapse of 20 s an amount of 3 mol of water is produced in the tank by chemical reaction. Assume that the amount of water satisfies a balance law. How much water is in the tank at the end of this time lapse?
2. In 30 min a battery has emitted 4300 J of electromagnetic energy. At the end of this time there is no energy in the battery (with respect to a given zero of energy). Assume that energy satisfies a conservation law in this example. How much energy was in the battery at the beginning of the 30 min?
3. A small block of **thorium-231**¹ contains 141.0 mol of neutrons. The thorium undergoes **beta decay**². After 9.2×10^4 s, the number of neutrons in the block is 140.5 mol. No neutrons were emitted. Assume that neutrons satisfy a balance law. How much was the time-integrated supply of neutron during that time lapse? (Be careful about the signs.)
4. A bowling ball, at a given time and in a given coordinate system, has momentum [11.6, 0, 0.6] N s. Three seconds later the ball is completely

at rest, with momentum $[0, 0, 0]$ N s. How much was the time-integrated influx of momentum during the three seconds?

5. A small laser beam, of given width and length, contains a net angular momentum $[0, 2.1 \times 10^{-36}, 0]$ N m s, in a given coordinate system. The same region of space, 0.1 s later, does not contain any electromagnetic field anymore, and therefore contains zero angular momentum. Assume that angular momentum satisfies a conservation law. How much was the time-integrated efflux of angular momentum through the control surface that contained the beam?

5.2

With a colleague or a large language model:

1. Explain to a colleague the difference between a balance law and a conservation law. Let your colleague criticize unclear or incorrect points in your explanation, and comment on the good points. Then exchange roles.
2. If you have a large-language-model service, ask it what's the definition of a balance law, and then what's the difference between a balance law and a conservation law. Compare its answer with what you learned so far. Argue with it and see where the discussion goes.

Keep in mind that there exist many slightly different definitions of 'balance law' and 'conservation law'. Large language models are trained on texts containing many different definitions – including erroneous ones!

5.3

Feel free to discuss this with a colleague:

Imagine you're supervising a research team. Your team is exploring and developing the new, ground-breaking kind of material *super-energium*, studying its characteristics about energy and temperature.

Super-energium is supposed to be somewhat similar to the better known *energium*, which is therefore used as a comparison in your team's investigations. The energy content E and flux Φ of a block of *energium* satisfy the

law of conservation of energy; in differential form

$$\frac{dE(t)}{dt} = \Phi(t). \quad (5.1)$$

For this material, the energy is connected with the temperature T of the block by the constitutive relation

$$E(t) = aT(t)^4 \quad (5.2)$$

where a is a constant.

Your team performs experiments on blocks of *super-energium*, and finds that the equations above don't match the experimental results. The equations that describe *super-energium* must therefore be different. The engineers in your team propose and test different modifications of the physical laws, and finally find two different modifications that work:

- (A) One group of engineers show that if you keep the original constitutive relation (5.2), but modify the conservation law for energy (5.1) as follows:

$$\frac{d \ln E(t)}{dt} = \frac{2}{b} \Phi(t) \quad (5.3)$$

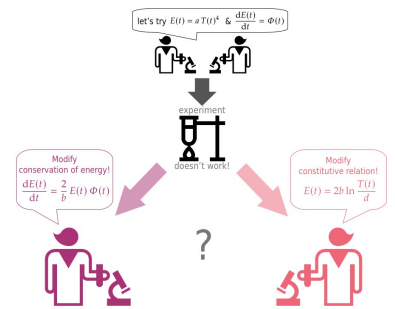
with a new constant b , then you can perfectly describe and predict all present experimental results.

- (B) Another group of engineers show that if you keep the original conservation law for energy (5.1), but modify the constitutive relation (5.2) as follows:

$$E(t) = 2b \ln \frac{T(t)}{d} \quad (5.4)$$

with new constants b, d , then you can also perfectly describe and predict all present experimental results.

You must decide whether to continue experiments and development using the modifications proposed by engineers (A), or those proposed by engineers (B) (you can't pursue both). **Which do you choose, and why?**



5.4

Solution p. 54

Consider a small control volume completely occupied by a particular kind of gas, which we shall call *ideal gas*. Focus also on a small part of the closed control surface associated with this control volume.

Two constitutive relations are known to be valid for such a control volume:

- The *ideal-gas law*

$$F = \frac{A}{V} RNT$$

says that the magnitude of the surface force (momentum influx) on the small area is proportional to the amount of gas N in the control volume, the temperature T of the gas, the constant R , the surface's area A ; and inversely proportional to the volume V .

- The energy equation for an ideal gas

$$E = U_0 + CNT$$

says that the total energy-mass in the control volume containing the gas is proportional to the amount of gas N there, the gas's temperature T , and two constants C and U_0 .

Find a constitutive relation that directly connects the volume content of energy-mass and the magnitude of the magnitude of flux of momentum, without involving any auxiliary quantities; constants and geometric quantities such as areas and volumes are allowed.



5.5

Solution p. 54

Find the physical dimensions and units of the constants a, b, d in Exercise 5.3 and R, U_0, C in Exercise 5.4.

Example solutions

5.1

Exercise p. 47

1. We consider an imaginary closed control surface corresponding to the inner surface of the tank.

The problem gives:

- Initial time $t_0 = 0$ s, final time $t_1 = 20$ s.
- Volume content of water $N(t_0) = 10$ mol at time t_0 .
- Time-integrated supply of water in control volume $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt = 3$ mol.
- Time-integrated influx of water is 0 mol ("the tank is sealed").

Unknown:

- Volume content of water $N(t_1)$ at time t_1 .

If water obeys a balance law, the quantities above are related by

$$N(t_1) = N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt$$

of which three are known. We can find the unknown:

$$\begin{aligned} N(t_1) &= N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt \\ &= 10 \text{ mol} + 0 \text{ mol} + 3 \text{ mol} = 13 \text{ mol} . \end{aligned}$$

2. We consider an imaginary closed control surface perfectly wrapping the battery.

The problem gives:

- Initial time t_0 , final time $t_1 = t_0 + 1800$ s.
- Time-integrated **influx** of energy $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt = -4300$ J; minus sign because the text specifies the efflux.
- Volume content of energy $E(t_1) = 0$ mol at time t_1 .

Unknown:

- Volume content of energy $E(t_0)$ at time t_0 .

If energy obeys a conservation law, the quantities above are related by

$$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$$

of which two are known. We can find the unknown by simple algebra:

$$\begin{aligned} E(t_0) &= E(t_1) - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt \\ &= 0 \text{ J} + 4300 \text{ J} = 4300 \text{ J} . \end{aligned}$$

3. We consider an imaginary closed control surface perfectly wrapping the block of material.

The problem gives:

- Initial time t_0 , final time $t_1 = t_0 + 9.2 \times 10^4 \text{ s}$.
- Volume content of neutrons $N(t_0) = 141.0 \text{ mol}$ at time t_0 .
- Volume content of neutrons $N(t_1) = 140.5 \text{ mol}$ at time t_1 .
- Time-integrated **in**flux of neutrons $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt = 0 \text{ mol}$ (“no neutrons were emitted”).

Unknown:

- Time-integrated supply of neutrons $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt$.

If the amount of neutrons obeys a balance law, the quantities above are related by

$$N(t_1) = N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt$$

of which three are known. We can find the unknown by algebra:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt &= N(t_1) - N(t_0) - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt \\ &= 141.0 \text{ mol} - 140.5 \text{ mol} - 0 \text{ mol} = -0.5 \text{ mol} . \end{aligned}$$

The negative sign for the supply makes sense, because the number of neutrons has decreased.

4. We consider an imaginary closed control surface perfectly wrapping the bowling ball (note that this control volume and surface are not static).

The problem gives:

- Initial time t_0 , final time $t_1 = t_0 + 3 \text{ s}$.

- Volume content of momentum $\mathbf{P}(t_0) = [11.6, 0, 0.6] \text{ N s}$ at time t_0 .
- Volume content of momentum $\mathbf{P}(t_1) = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N s}$ at time t_1 .

Unknown:

- Time-integrated influx of momentum $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt$.

Momentum obeys a balance law, so the quantities above are related by

$$\mathbf{P}(t_1) = \mathbf{P}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G}(t) dt .$$

Only two of these four quantities are given in the problem, so we can't find the influx of momentum.

One could, intelligently, think of maybe using the constitutive relation for the supply of momentum: $\mathbf{G} = m g [0, 0, -1]$. But unfortunately the mass m of the bowling ball is not given in the problem.

5. We consider an imaginary and static closed control surface enclosing the region where the laser beam (the electromagnetic field) was initially.

The problem gives:

- Initial time t_0 , final time $t_1 = t_0 + 0.1 \text{ s}$.
- Angular-momentum content $\mathbf{L}(t_0) = [0, 2.1 \times 10^{-36}, 0] \text{ N m s}$ at time t_0 .
- Angular-momentum content $\mathbf{L}(t_1) = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N m s}$ at time t_1 .
- Angular-momentum supply $\mathcal{T} = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N m}$ always, because it says to assume that angular-momentum satisfies a *conservation* law. We can therefore omit the supply.

Unknown:

- Time-integrated **efflux** of angular momentum $-\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{M}(t) dt$; the minus sign is because $\mathbf{M}$ denotes the **influx** when we write the balance or conservation law.

Assuming angular momentum to obey a conservation law, the quantities above are related by

$$\mathbf{L}(t_1) = \mathbf{L}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{M}(t) dt$$

of which two are known. We can find the **efflux** by algebra:

$$\begin{aligned} -\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{M}(t) dt &= \mathbf{L}(t_0) - \mathbf{L}(t_1) \\ &= [0, 2.1 \times 10^{-36}, 0] \text{ N m s} - [0, 0, 0] \text{ N m s} = [0, 2.1 \times 10^{-36}, 0] \text{ N m s} . \end{aligned}$$

It makes sense that the efflux is positive, because all angular momentum has left the control volume.

💡 5.4

Exercise p. 49

We want to find a relation that gets rid of the auxiliary quantity T , the temperature. This can be done with several equivalent algebraic manipulations; here's one. Solve the ideal-gas law for the temperature:

$$T = \frac{V}{A} \frac{F}{RN}$$

then substitute this expression into the energy equation:

$$E = U_0 + CN \left(\frac{V}{A} \frac{F}{RN} \right) \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \boxed{E = U_0 + \frac{V}{A} \frac{C}{R} F}.$$

This is the desired constitutive relation. It says that the energy content E is directly proportional to the magnitude of the momentum influx F , with some proportionality constants that also involve the size of the control volume and the area of the control surface.

💡 5.5

Exercise p. 50

Solving equation (5.2) for a , and omitting the time dependence, we find

$$a = E/T^4$$

which means that a has physical dimension energy/temperature⁴ or equivalently mass · length²/(time² · temperature⁴). Possible units are therefore 'J/K⁴'.

An analogous procedure shows:

- b : physical dimension energy, unit 'J'.
- d : physical dimension temperature, unit 'K'.
- R : physical dimension momentum · length/(substance · temperature), units 'Nm/(mol K)'.
- U_0 : physical dimension energy, unit 'J'.
- C : physical dimension energy/(substance · temperature), unit 'J/(mol K)'.

URLs for chapter 5

1. <https://pubchem.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/compound/Thorium-231>
2. <http://hyperphysics.phy-astr.gsu.edu/hbase/Nuclear/beta.html>

Inference, prediction, simulation

6.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

For Exercises 6.1–6.4, find the requested quantity if possible, by using any combination of:

- data given in the question,
- balance or conservation law (specified in the question), in integral or differential expression,
- principle of extensivity,
- principle of symmetry of flux,
- calculus.

In your solution, explain which control surfaces and volumes you're using, and show all mathematical and logical steps. If it isn't possible to find the requested quantity, explain why.

6.1

Solution p. 61

Water is produced in a tank at a rate (supply) of 2.0 mol/s , constant in time. The tank has a hole, from which water is leaking out at a rate of 0.1 mol/s , constant in time. Water satisfies a balance law. If initially there's no water in the tank, how much water is there after 10 s ?

6.2

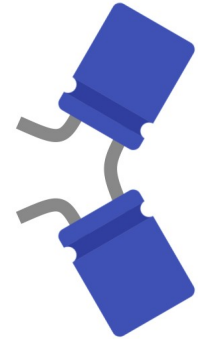
Solution p. 61

Two electronic components that can store electric charge, called *capacitors*, are connected by one wire; each is also connected to some other components by another wire; see side figure. Let's call them the 'top' and 'bottom' capacitor.

The top capacitor is *receiving* from other components an electric current (that is, a flux of electric charge), of 5 C/s. Its electric-charge content is increasing at a rate of 2 C/s.

The bottom capacitor is *delivering* an electric current of 1 C/s to other components.

Electric charge satisfies a conservation law. **How fast is the electric-charge content in the bottom capacitor increasing or decreasing?**



Capacitors: blue, wires: grey. Wires on the left connect to other components, not shown.

6.3

Solution p. 64

A car is travelling on the road. Take a coordinate system (t, x, y, z) with horizontal x and y , upward z , and with respect to which the road is at rest.

At time 0 s, the driver starts to break. While slowing down, the car receives from the road a contact force given by

$$\mathbf{F}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} -1800 \exp\left(-\frac{t}{20\text{s}}\right) \\ 0 \\ 17\,640 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N},$$

and is subjected to the gravitational body force, constant in time,

$$\mathbf{G}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -17\,640 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N}.$$

At time 30 s, the car has a momentum $\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s}$.

Momentum obeys a balance law. **How much was the car's momentum at time 0 s, when the driver started breaking?** In the solution of this question, translate the description in terms of force into a description in terms of momentum flux and supply.

6.4

Solution p. 66

You are overseeing a nuclear-fission reactor. The reactor has a supply of *free neutrons* equal to 5.00×10^{19} particles/s, constant in time. Free neutrons obey a balance law.

We're measuring amounts in 'particles' rather than 'moles'.

Up to now the amount of free neutrons inside the reactor has been constant, at 1.67×10^{19} particles. This is because the reactor has an efflux of free neutrons, into control rods, equal to 5.00×10^{19} particles/s, constant in time.

Suddenly – let's call this time 0 s – you receive a warning on the red communication channel. The warning says that the efflux of neutrons now appears to be decreasing linearly, according to the formula

$$5.00 \times 10^{19} \text{ particles/s} - t \cdot 1.40 \times 10^{12} \text{ particles/s}^2.$$

This is dangerous: if the amount of free neutrons in the reactor reaches 4.00×10^{19} particles, the reactor will explode.

You send a team to check and fix the problem. The team asks you how much time they have, at most, to fix it. **How much time do they have to fix the problem, before the reactor explodes?** (Neglect the interaction time with the team, that is, start counting from 0 s.)

6.5

Feel free to do this with colleagues:

Start from script for the imaginary oscillating reaction discussed in §§6.2 and 6.5 of the main text (Octave: `oscillatingreaction.m`¹, Python: `oscillatingreaction.py`²), and modify it to simulate different constitutive relations, or change the chemical system a little. Describe what happens, and try to explain why that happens from the mathematical form of the constitutive relations. Keep in mind that in some situations the simulation may become numerically unstable and even crash. Also check what are the correct dimensions of the constants that appear in your physical laws.

Here are some possibilities:

- $\mathcal{R}_b(t) = \lambda_u N_a(t)$, $\mathcal{R}_a(t) = -\lambda_v N_b(t)$
with different positive values for λ_u and λ_v .
- $\mathcal{R}_b(t) = \lambda N_a(t) N_b(t)$, $\mathcal{R}_a(t) = -\lambda N_a(t) N_b(t)$.
- $\mathcal{R}_b(t) = \lambda \sin[N_a(t) N_b(t)/\text{mol}^2]$, $\mathcal{R}_a(t) = -\lambda \sin[N_a(t) N_b(t)/\text{mol}^2]$.
- Introduce a third substance.

6.6

Solution p. 67

Feel free to do this with colleagues:

Start from script for the imaginary oscillating reaction discussed in §6.5 of the main text (Octave: `oscillatingreaction.m`³, Python: `oscillatingreaction.py`⁴). Modify it to use the following constitutive relations instead:

$$\mathcal{R}_a(t) = -2 V C_1 \cdot \left(\frac{N_a(t)}{V} \right)^2 + 2 V C_2 \cdot \frac{N_b(t)}{V}$$

$$\mathcal{R}_b(t) = V C_1 \left(\frac{N_a(t)}{V} \right)^2 - V C_2 \frac{N_b(t)}{V}$$

with $V = 0.001 \text{ m}^3$, $C_1 = 4.2 \times 10^5 \text{ m}^3/(\text{mol s})$, $C_2 = 1.6 \times 10^7 \text{ s}^{-1}$.

Simulate it with the following initial conditions, boundary conditions, and time step:

- $t_0 = 0 \text{ s}$, $N_a(t_0) = 0 \text{ mol}$, $N_b(t_0) = 0.04 \text{ mol}$.
- $J_a = J_b = 0 \text{ mol/s}$.
- $t_1 = 2 \times 10^{-7} \text{ s}$, $\Delta t = 1 \times 10^{-10} \text{ s}$.

1. Check whether the units of the constants C_1 and C_2 are consistent.
2. Before running the script, what kind of behaviour do you expect to observe? Do you think it will oscillate?
3. After running the script: does it seem to oscillate? Can you try to explain why it does or doesn't?

6.7

Solution p. 67

Write scripts to solve Exercises 6.1–6.4 numerically.

Example solutions

💡 6.1

Exercise p. 57

Let's choose a closed control surface corresponding to the tank's inner wall (if it had no hole). The question gives:

- Initial time t_0 , final time $t_1 = t_0 + 10$ s.
- Volume content of water $N(t_0) = 0$ mol at time t_0 .
- Supply of water in control volume $\mathcal{R}(t) = 2.0$ mol, constant in time.
- Influx of water $J(t) = -0.1$ mol ("water is leaking out"), constant in time.

Water obeys a balance law. The fluxes and supplies reported in the question are constant in time, and so they could be easily used in the differential expression of the balance law. But the problem also involves a specific lapse of time; this suggests to use the integral expression of the balance law instead:

$$N(t_1) = N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt .$$

We can use it to find $N(t_1)$ if we have the other three terms. $N(t_0)$ is known, and the time-integrated flux and supply can be found by integration:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt &= - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 0.1 \text{ mol/s} dt = -0.1 \text{ mol/s} \cdot (t_1 - t_0) \\ &= -0.1 \text{ mol/s} \cdot 10 \text{ s} = -1 \text{ mol} , \\ \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt &= \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 2.0 \text{ mol/s} dt = 2.0 \text{ mol/s} \cdot (t_1 - t_0) \\ &= 2.0 \text{ mol/s} \cdot 10 \text{ s} = 20 \text{ mol} . \end{aligned}$$

Using the balance law we finally find the amount of water after 10 s:

$$\begin{aligned} N(t_1) &= N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt \\ &= 0 \text{ mol} - 1 \text{ mol} + 20 \text{ mol} = 19 \text{ mol} . \end{aligned}$$

💡 6.2

Exercise p. 58

First of all, the problem asks about quantities at a given instant of time, and mentions rates of change of volume contents. Therefore the differential form of conservation law for electric charge seems most convenient here:

$$\frac{d\dot{Q}(t)}{dt} = \mathcal{I}(t) .$$

For the choice of control volumes and surfaces, this problem can be approached in two different ways, which obviously lead to identical physical results:

- (1) Choose two control volumes, one for each capacitor. The closed surfaces of these control volumes have one part in common.
- (2) Choose one control volume only, containing both capacitors.

Let's pursue both approaches in order to compare them.

(1) The closed control surface of the top control volume can be divided into three parts: one called *A* through which there's an electric current to or from other components; one called *S* through which there's an electric current to or from the other capacitor; and one without name through which there's no current.

Analogously for the bottom control volume: *B* is the part of surface with current to or from other components; *S* is the part with current to or from the other capacitor; the remaining, current-free part has no name.

For the top control volume, the problem gives these data:

- Rate of change of electric-charge content: $\frac{d\dot{Q}_t}{dt} = 2 \text{ C/s}$.
- Influx of electric charge through partial surface *A*: $I_A = 5 \text{ C/s}$.

The influx of electric charge I_S through *S* is not given. The influx through the rest of the surface is zero, and we shall simply omit it.

To apply the conservation law we need the total influx into this control volume; let's call it I_t . By **extensivity** it is

$$I_t = I_A + I_S .$$

The balance law of electric current for this control volume is therefore

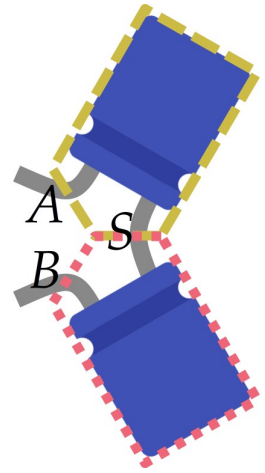
$$\frac{d\dot{Q}_t}{dt} = I_A + I_S ,$$

where all quantities except I_S are known.

For the bottom control volume, the problem gives:

- Influx of electric charge through partial surface *B*: $I_B = -1 \text{ C/s}$; minus sign because "it's delivering".

The influx through *S* is unknown, as well as the rate of change of electric-charge content, which is what we want to know.



To apply the conservation law we need the total influx into this control volume; let's call it $\mathcal{I}_b$. By **extensivity** it is

$$\mathcal{I}_b = \mathcal{I}_B - \mathcal{I}_S$$

and the minus sign for $\mathcal{I}_S$ comes from the **principle of symmetry of flux**. The balance law of electric current for this control volume is therefore

$$\frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} = \mathcal{I}_B - \mathcal{I}_S ,$$

where only $\mathcal{I}_A$ is known.

We now take together the balances for the two control volumes:

$$\begin{cases} \frac{d\dot{Q}_t}{dt} = \mathcal{I}_A + \mathcal{I}_S \\ \frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} = \mathcal{I}_B - \mathcal{I}_S \end{cases} \Rightarrow \begin{cases} 2 \text{ C/s} = 5 \text{ C/s} + \mathcal{I}_S \\ \frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} = -1 \text{ C/s} - \mathcal{I}_S \end{cases} \quad (6.1)$$

This is a system of two equations, with two unknowns: $\mathcal{I}_S$ and $d\dot{Q}_b/dt$. We can solve it with several methods, like substitution. The result is

$$\mathcal{I} = -3 \text{ C/s} , \quad \boxed{\frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} = 2 \text{ C/s}} .$$

Besides the required answer, we also found that positive current is flowing from the top to the bottom capacitor.

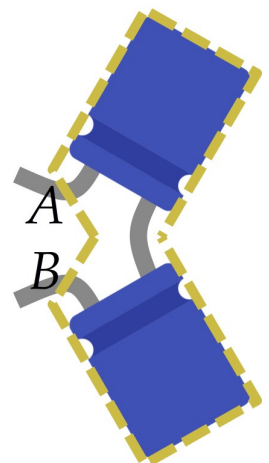
(2) We have one closed control surface, which can be divided into three parts: one called A through which there's an electric current to or from other components; one called S through which there's an electric current to or from the other capacitor; and one without name through which there's no current.

The partial surface S from the previous approach is not considered here. It's within the control volume, so it doesn't matter.

Let's call $\dot{Q}$ the total content of electric charge in this control volume, and $\mathcal{I}$ the total influx of electric charge through its control surface. They obey the conservation law

$$\frac{d\dot{Q}}{dt} = \mathcal{I} .$$

In order to find the total content and the total influx we must apply the principle of **extensivity** to both.



The total content $\dot{Q}$ is given by

$$\dot{Q} = \dot{Q}_t + \dot{Q}_b$$

where $\dot{Q}_t$ and $\dot{Q}_b$ are the contents in the top and bottom partial volumes.
The total influx is given by

$$\mathcal{I} = \mathcal{I}_A + \mathcal{I}_B ,$$

neglecting the zero influx through the remaining surface.

Our conservation law therefore becomes

$$\frac{d\dot{Q}_t}{dt} + \frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} = \mathcal{I}_A + \mathcal{I}_B . \quad (6.2)$$

In this equation we know all quantities except $d\dot{Q}_b/dt$, which is easily found:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\dot{Q}_b}{dt} &= -\frac{d\dot{Q}_t}{dt} + \mathcal{I}_A + \mathcal{I}_B \\ &= -2 \text{ C/s} + 5 \text{ C/s} - 1 \text{ C/s} = 2 \text{ C/s} . \end{aligned}$$

The approaches (1) and (2) obviously lead to the same physical answer. They are an example of our freedom in choosing control surfaces and volumes. If you compare formula (6.1) obtained with the first approach, and formula (6.2) obtained with the second, you notice that the second is obtained from the first, by elimination of $\mathcal{I}_S$ from the system of equations.

Therefore the choice of a single control volume performed this mathematical elimination for us, so to speak.

💡 6.3

Exercise p. 58

Let's choose a closed control surface wrapping the car. The question gives:

- Initial time $t_0 = 0 \text{ s}$, final time $t_1 = 30 \text{ s}$.
- Volume content of momentum $\mathbf{P}(t_1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s}$ at time t_1 .
- Influx of momentum

$$\mathbf{F}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} -1800 \exp\left(\frac{t}{20 \text{ s}}\right) \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N}$$

("car receives from the road a contact force").

- Supply of momentum

$$\mathbf{G}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -17\,640 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N}$$

(“gravitational body force”), constant in time.

Momentum obeys a balance law. The question specifies a lapse of time, so the integral expression of the balance seems most convenient:

$$\mathbf{P}(t_1) = \mathbf{P}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G}(t) dt .$$

We can use it to find $\mathbf{P}(t_0)$ if we have the other three terms. $\mathbf{P}(t_1)$ is known. The time-integrated flux and supply of momentum can be found by integration:

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt = \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \begin{bmatrix} -1800 \exp(-\frac{t}{20\text{s}}) \\ 0 \\ 17\,640 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N } dt .$$

The time-integral of a vector is simply a vector of the integrals of the components. Let’s calculate the integral of the x -component:

$$\begin{aligned} - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 1800 \exp\left(-\frac{t}{20\text{s}}\right) \text{ N } dt &= +1800 \cdot 20 \text{ N s} \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{t}{20\text{s}}\right) \Big|_{0\text{s}}^{30\text{s}} \\ &= 1800 \cdot 20 \text{ N s} \cdot \left[\exp\left(-\frac{30\text{s}}{20\text{s}}\right) - \exp\left(-\frac{0\text{s}}{20\text{s}}\right) \right] \\ &\approx 36\,000 \text{ N s} \cdot (0.223 - 1) \\ &\approx -28\,000 \text{ N s} . \end{aligned}$$

From calculus,

$$\begin{aligned} \int \exp(-t/a) dt &= \\ &= -a \exp(-t/a) + \text{const.} \end{aligned}$$

The y -component is zero, so its definite integral is zero too. For the z -component we do an analogous but much simpler integration:

$$- \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 17\,640 \text{ N } dt = 17\,640 \text{ N} \cdot (30\text{s} - 0\text{s}) = 529\,200 \text{ N s} .$$

Putting all three integrals together we have

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt = \begin{bmatrix} -28\,000 \\ 0 \\ 529\,200 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} .$$

The time-integrated supply is found in an analogous way; we have already calculated the relevant integral:

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G}(t) dt = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -529\,200 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s .}$$

We can finally find the initial momentum content:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P}(t_0) &= \mathbf{P}(t_1) - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G}(t) dt \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} - \begin{bmatrix} -28\,000 \\ 0 \\ 529\,200 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} - \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -529\,200 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} \\ &\approx \begin{bmatrix} 28\,000 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s .} \end{aligned}$$

6.4

Exercise p. 59

We choose a control volume corresponding to the space occupied by the fissile material. This volume is a little like a piece of Emmental cheese: it has an outer surface, corresponding to the boundary of the reactor, and a lot of cylindrical boundary surfaces within: they correspond to the space occupied by the control rods, which don't count as control volume because they don't have fissile material. The total control surface of this control volume consists in the outer surface and the inner surfaces, together. Despite this complex shape of control volume and surface, the reasoning for the balance law works as usual.

Let's abbreviate the unit 'particles' to 'pt'.

The question gives:

- Initial time $t_0 = 0$ s, final time t_1 *unknown*.
- Volume content of free neutrons $N(t_0) = 1.67 \times 10^{19}$ pt at time t_0 .
- Supply of free neutrons in control volume $\mathcal{R}(t) = 5.00 \times 10^{19}$ pt/s, constant in time.
- Influx of free neutrons

$$J(t) = -(r - at)$$

$$\text{with } r = 5.00 \times 10^{19} \text{ pt/s}, \quad a = 1.40 \times 10^{12} \text{ pt/s}^2,$$

with a minus sign because the question gives the efflux; it's convenient to introduce the constants r and a rather than writing the explicit numbers all the time.

- Volume content of free neutrons $N(t_0) = 4 \times 10^{19}$ pt at time t_1 (which we *don't* want to reach).

Free neutrons obey a balance law. The question asks about a lapse of time, so the integral expression seems most convenient. The quantities above are therefore related by

$$N(t_1) = N(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} J(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R}(t) dt .$$

The unknown is the integration end-time t_1 ; all the other quantities and functions are known.

Let's substitute the explicit time-dependence of influx and supply in the balance law, and then integrate:

$$\begin{aligned} N(t_1) &= N(t_0) - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} (r - at) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{R} dt \\ \Rightarrow N(t_1) &= N(t_0) - \left(rt - \frac{1}{2}at^2 \right) \Big|_{t_0}^{t_1} + \mathcal{R}(t_1 - t_0) \\ \Rightarrow N(t_1) &= N(t_0) - \left(rt_1 - \frac{1}{2}at_1^2 \right) + \left(rt_0 - \frac{1}{2}at_0^2 \right) + \mathcal{R}(t_1 - t_0) \end{aligned}$$

in this last expression, t_0 , $N(t_0)$, $N(t_1)$, $\mathcal{R}$, r , a are known values. We can therefore solve for t_1 ; note that we have a second-degree equation:

$$\frac{1}{2}at_1^2 + (\mathcal{R} - r)rt_1 + \left(N(t_0) - N(t_1) + rt_0 - \frac{1}{2}at_0^2 - \mathcal{R}t_0 \right) = 0 \text{ pt}$$

Now we can substitute all values. Many things simplify because $t_0 = 0$ s, and $r = \mathcal{R}$:

$$\begin{aligned} (0.70 \times 10^{12} \text{ pt/s}^2) t_1^2 + (0 \text{ pt/s}) t_1 - (2.33 \times 10^{19} \text{ pt}) &\approx 0 \text{ pt} \\ \Rightarrow t_1 &\approx 5769 \text{ s} \end{aligned}$$

where we have discarded the negative-time solution.

The team has around 96 min to fix the problem!



6.6

Exercise p. 60

See §§7.10–7.11 in the main text.



6.7

Exercise p. 60

✂ An example script will be added soon.

URLs for chapter 6

1. <https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/oscillatingreaction.m>
2. <https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/oscillatingreaction.py>
3. <https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/oscillatingreaction.m>
4. <https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/oscillatingreaction.py>

Balance & conservation of matter

7.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

7.1

Solution p. 71

1. A piece of material of unknown composition (but looking ordinary otherwise) has mass-energy 3.6 kg. Approximately how many moles of baryons does it contain? (Neglect leptons, that is, electrons.)
2. Can you tell how many moles of oxygen molecules and hydrogen molecules does it contain?
3. Another piece of the same kind of material contains 280 mol of baryons. Approximately how much is its mass-energy, in kilograms?
4. A volume 0.001 m^3 (that is, one litre) of a neutron star may contain 4×10^{17} mol of neutrons (which are baryons). Approximately how much is the mass-energy of such a one-litre volume?

7.2

Solution p. 71

When we study or simulate a physical phenomenon, it's often important to categorize 'matter' into different kinds, and to keep track of each kind. This categorization, though, depends on the specify system and also on the goals of the study. Consider these categorizations:

- (A) into different *baryons* and different *leptons*;
- (B) into protons, neutrons, electrons, and their antiparticles;
- (C) into different **isotopes**¹ of the chemical elements;
- (D) into the different kinds of atoms (hydrogen, helium, lithium, and so on up the periodic table);
- (E) into the different **elements and compounds**² (for instance oxygen as a collection of molecules, water, carbon dioxide, and so on);

(F) into solid, liquid, gas;

(G) into different materials (taking this word in a very general sense);

(H) no categorization needed.

For each of the situations below, try to decide which of the categorizations above – possibly more than one – would be most appropriate:

1. Launching a rocket in space.
2. A high-energy experiment at [CERN](#)³.
3. [Fractional distillation](#)⁴ of crude oil.
4. Cooking, preparing a dish.
5. Preparing a machine for [positron-emission tomography \(PET\)](#)⁵.
6. Building a house.
7. A tennis ball colliding with a tennis racket.
8. [Carbon dating](#)⁶.
9. Taking care of a [nuclear fission reactor](#)⁷, that is, keeping track of the fissile material, of the waste produced, and so on.

Example solutions

7.1

Exercise p. 69

1. One mole of baryons has a mass-energy of approximately 0.001 kg; that is, the mass-energy per mole is 0.001 kg/mol. Therefore this piece of matter has approximately

$$\frac{3.6 \text{ kg}}{0.001 \text{ kg/mol}} = 3600 \text{ mol}$$

of baryons.

2. No. First, we don't know how many of the baryons are neutrons or protons. Second, even if we had the number of protons, we wouldn't know how they are grouped into atoms. For instance, 8 protons and 8 neutrons they could be in the form of 4 molecules of helium (2 protons and 2 neutrons each), or in the form of one molecule of oxygen (8 protons and 8 neutrons).
3. Doing the inverse operation of the first question, this other piece of matter has mass-energy of approximately

$$280 \text{ mol} \times 0.001 \text{ kg/mol} = 0.28 \text{ kg} .$$

4. With the same procedure as in the previous answer, a litre of this neutron star would have mass-energy approximately

$$4 \times 10^{17} \text{ mol} \times 0.001 \text{ kg/mol} = 4 \times 10^{14} \text{ kg} .$$

7.2

Exercise p. 69

1. We need to keep track of the fuel, and possibly also of the compounds that participate into fuel combustion. So categorization (E) – at the very least – seems appropriate.
2. Surely categorization (A)!
3. The distillates are all different compounds and mixtures, so categorization (E) is probably relevant. It may also be necessary to keep track of changes between liquid, gas, solid phases; therefore categorization (F) may be relevant as well.
4. In cooking we need to keep track of the amounts of various ingredients, which we may consider as different “materials”; so categorization (G). It may also be necessary, say, to keep track of amounts of boiling and evaporated water or similar; so categorization (F) may also be relevant.

5. PET uses radioactive elements, therefore categorization (C) is important. It also involves the production of positrons (anti-electrons), so categorization (B) may also be important. Beyond the PET machine itself, also categorization (E) may be important, because one must prepare particular kinds of glucose and keep track of them. **Important:** photons and 'gamma particles' are strictly speaking not matter, but particular manifestations of electromagnetic fields.
6. Categorization (G) surely applies here: we must keep track of amounts of various kinds of metals, wood, cement, and many other materials. Possibly also categorizations (F) and (E) may be relevant in some situations.
7. In describing this phenomenon we need to consider several control volumes, for instance one for the tennis ball and one for the racket. But we don't need to differentiate among different kinds of matter. So (H), no categorization needed here.
8. Carbon dating is based on radioactivity, the process by which some isotope converts into some other isotope. Therefore categorization (C) is relevant.
9. In a fission reactor the fissile material and the waste consist of different isotopes of several elements, like uranium; so categorization (C) is important. It's also important to keep track of the amount of neutrons produced during fission; so categorization (F) may be relevant as well.

URLs for chapter 7

1. <http://hyperphysics.phy-astr.gsu.edu/hbase/nuclear/nucnot.html#c2>
2. <https://www.chem.purdue.edu/gchelp/atoms/elements.html>
3. <https://home.cern/science/experiments>
4. https://energyeducation.ca/encyclopedia/Fractional_distillation
5. <https://www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/treatment-tests-and-therapies/positron-emission-tomography-pet>
6. <http://www.hyperphysics.phy-astr.gsu.edu/hbase/Nuclear/cardat.html>
7. <https://www.iaea.org/newscenter/news/what-is-nuclear-energy-the-science-of-nuclear-power>

Conservation of magnetic flux

 8.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

Example solutions

Conservation of electric charge



9.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

Example solutions

Balance of momentum

10.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

10.1

Solution p. 94

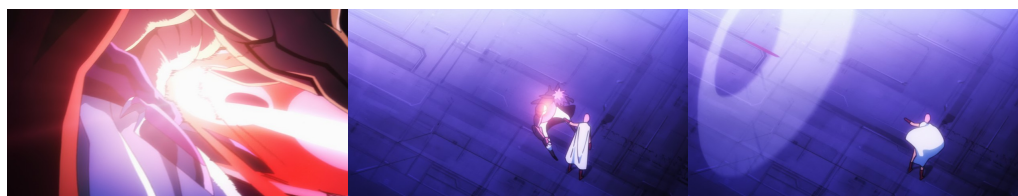
Towards the end of season 1 of *One Punch Man*¹, Saitama² has a fight with Boros³, the “Dominator of the Universe”.

For fun, let’s roughly estimate the force of a punch by Saitama by analysing a punch scene.

Here are three video frames with their number. The left frame is the first frame where Saitama’s punch is in contact with Boros’s stomach. The central frame is the first where we see Saitama’s punch no longer in contact with Boros. The right frame shows Boros thrown away by the punch; note the shock wave.



Saitama and Boros



frame 30732

frame 30736

frame 30740

Estimate the force of Saitama’s punch by means of the *balance of momentum* in its approximate form and of *Newton’s constitutive formula for the momentum of matter*. Use the following information and hints:

- Boros looks like a heavy human wrestler, and is said to be the strongest being in the universe. In this scene he also wears a suit of armour.
- Boros is standing still right before Saitama punches him.
- The shock wave indicates that Boros’s speed, after being punched, is at least as high as the **speed of sound in air**⁴, around 340 m/s.
- In the video, each frame lasts 0.042 s.

- We can consider this problem to be one-dimensional, and gravity is negligible since the motion is horizontal.

In everyday situations we often quantify force in ‘kilograms’, or better ‘kilograms-force’, that is, in terms of the mass that would have that force as its weight. This is done by dividing the force by $g \approx 9.8 \text{ N/kg}$.

Express your estimate of the force of Saitama’s punch in kilogram-force unit.

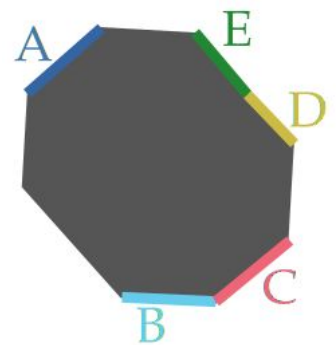
10.2

Solution p. 95

Consider the control volume (simplified in 2D) in the margin figure. You know the following at a given coordinate time t , and in some coordinates (x, y, z) :

- The momentum content in the volume is changing at a time rate of $[4, -1, 3] \text{ N}$.
- The momentum influx at surface A is $[3, 2, -7] \text{ N}$
- The momentum influx at surface B is $[-5, 0, 0] \text{ N}$
- The momentum efflux at surface C is $[4, 4, 4] \text{ N}$
- The momentum influx at surface D is $[0, 0, 1] \text{ N}$
- The momentum influx at the other surfaces is $\mathbf{0} \text{ N}$.
- Gravity is negligible

Find the momentum influx at surface E at time t .

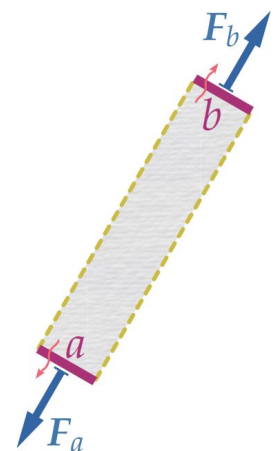


10.3

Solution p. 96

The margin figure shows a piece of material with momentum **effluxes** $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ across the surfaces a and b . These momentum effluxes are depicted as *compressive* surface forces exerted by the material.

1. Draw an analogous figure depicting the **influxes** across the surfaces a and b , that is, the forces experienced by the material.
2. Draw an analogous figure but in which $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ are depicted as *tensile* surface forces instead.



10.4

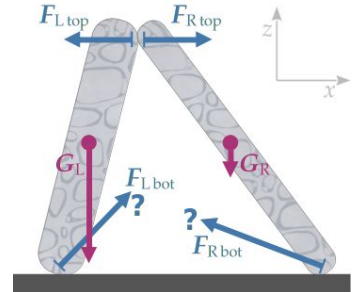
Solution p. 96

Two blocks of granite rest on the ground leaning against each other as shown in the margin figure. Each block touches the ground and the other block. There are momentum fluxes (contact forces) at the three contact surfaces, depicted in the figure by blue arrows. The block on the left, denoted 'L', has mass 27 000 kg; the one on the right, denoted 'R', mass 9000 kg. Air can be neglected.

Answer the following questions:

1. Which physical principle relates the surface forces $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}}$? Write it as a mathematical equation between the two.
2. The two blocks have also volume forces (momentum supplies) $\mathbf{G}_L$ and $\mathbf{G}_R$. Which constitutive relation can you use to find these? Write down both forces numerically, as vectors with x - and z -components, according to the coordinates shown in the figure.
3. You are now given the following additional information:
 - The z -component of the force $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$ is 0 N; that is, this force is purely horizontal.
 - The x -component of the force $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$ is $-33\,075$ N.

Find the z -component of the force $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$, explaining which physical laws (balance laws, constitutive relations, symmetry of flux, extensivity; compare your answers to the previous two questions) and which text information you need to use in order to find it. Can you manage to find the component using only one control volume?



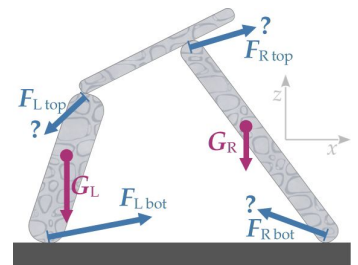
The directions and magnitudes of the surface forces $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$ are not known, so their drawing is purely hypothetical.

10.5

Solution p. 99

Three blocks of granite are statically arranged as shown in the margin figure. The blocks on the left and right touch the ground, and both sustain a third, central block, suspended from the ground. There are momentum fluxes (contact forces) at the four contact surfaces, depicted in the figure by blue arrows; the forces on the central block are not displayed. The block on the left, denoted 'L', has mass 13 000 kg; the one on the right, denoted 'R', mass 9000 kg; the central one, denoted 'C', mass 2000 kg. Air can be neglected. We know one of the forces:

$$\mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}} = [29\,400, 151\,900] \text{ N}.$$



The directions and magnitudes of the surface forces $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$, $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}}$, $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$ are not known, so their drawing is purely hypothetical.

1. Try to find $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}}$ by considering each block as a separate control volume and applying the balance of momentum to each, together with any other necessary physical laws or principles.

Do you manage to find also $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Ltop}}$?

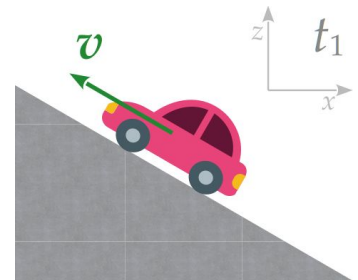
2. Try to find $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}}$ by considering the three blocks as a single object, that is, as *one* control volume, and applying the balance of momentum to this single object. Which other constitutive relation and physical principles do you need to use?

Do you manage to find also $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Ltop}}$?

10.6

Solution p. 101

At a particular time t_1 a car is moving uphill with an instantaneous velocity $\mathbf{v}(t_1) = [-11.4, 6.6] \text{ m/s}$ in the coordinate system (x, z) , as illustrated in the margin figure. Note that this is the car's velocity at that specific time instant: we don't know the velocity at any earlier or later time instant. The car (including driver and everything inside) has mass 1400 kg. Assume that air is negligible.



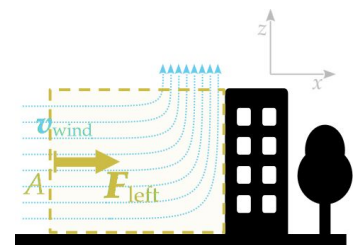
1. Given the above information, can you calculate how much is the surface force (momentum flux) from the road to the car at time t_1 ?
2. You're given the additional information that the car has, at time t_1 , an instantaneous acceleration of magnitude 0.95 m/s^2 , in the same direction as the velocity. Also in this case we don't know the acceleration at any earlier or later time instant. Can you calculate how much is the surface force from the road to the car at time t_1 ?

10.7

Solution p. 103

A strong wind is hitting a building from one side, as illustrated in the margin figure; the wind is represented by the **light-blue dotted arrows**. The wind's air is deflected upwards, by the building and the ground, as it approaches the building's side. The area of the building's side is 450 m^2 .

We are interested in calculating the *extra* surface force that the wind exerts on the building's side, beyond to the usual force from atmospheric pressure. Owing to the wind, the total force is stronger than that from usual atmospheric pressure.



View from the front of the building

At some distance from the building's side (left in the figure), the wind has a purely horizontal velocity $\mathbf{v}_{\text{wind}}$ of 30 m/s. The deflected wind has a purely vertical velocity.

There is a constitutive relation for the surface force F when matter is flowing through the surface with perpendicular velocity v , and the surface is not moving:

$$F = A \rho v^2 + \mathcal{F}$$

where:

A is the area of the surface;

ρ is the mass density of the matter flowing through the surface;

$\mathcal{F}$ (called pressure vector or stress vector) is the force that there would be on the surface if matter weren't flowing through it.

The force F has the same direction as the velocity.

Find the force that the wind exerts on the building's side; proceed as follows:

- (a) Consider the imaginary control volume represented by the **yellow dashed rectangle** in the figure (this control volume has a depth which isn't visible because the figure shows it from the front).
- (b) Apply the balance of momentum to this control volume, focusing on the x -component only.
- (c) Consider which surface forces must be added together. The only forces with a horizontal component are those on the vertical surfaces shown in the figure.
- (d) For the force across the vertical surface on the left, use the constitutive relation above. In this case:
 - ' F ' is F_{left} .
 - ' v ' is v_{wind} .
 - $\rho = 1.2 \text{ kg/m}^3$ is the mass density of air.
 - $\mathcal{F} = A p_{\text{air}}$, where $p_{\text{air}} \approx 1.0 \times 10^5 \text{ N/m}^2$ is the atmospheric pressure.
- (e) Assume that the total momentum within the control volume is constant in time; that is, the wind is steady.

10.8

Solution p. 104

In a coordinate system (x, z) , at time $t_0 = 0$ s, a football of mass-energy 0.42 kg has instantaneous velocity $[0, 0]$ m/s. The ball is hit at that time, and experiences a horizontal surface force (momentum influx) until time $t_1 = 0.3$ s. The force changes with time as follows

$$\mathbf{F}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} (190 \text{ N/s}) \cdot t \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix}.$$

During the same time interval, the ball experiences the usual vertical gravitational force (momentum supply).

1. Verify that the dimensions and units in the expression of the surface force are correct.
2. What is the football's momentum at time t_1 ? Do you have to use any constitutive relations to find it?
3. What is the football's velocity at time t_1 ? Which constitutive relations must you use to find it?

10.9

Solution p. 105

In a coordinate system (t, x) , at a particular time two tennis balls are at some distance from each other, and moving towards each other with opposite velocities of magnitude 25 m/s. Each ball has mass 0.060 kg. There is no gravity, no electromagnetic fields, no air.



1. Consider a control volume consisting of both tennis balls. Which physical laws and physical principles do you need to use in order to calculate the total momentum content in this volume? Do not reason intuitively or heuristically: try to be methodical and exhaustive.

After some time the tennis balls have collided and are moving away from each other, in directions opposite to those they came from.

2. How much is the total momentum content in the control volume, after the collision? Explain which balance laws and other information you use to find the result.
3. Using only the balance of momentum, is it possible to find the magnitude of the velocity of each ball after the collision? using only

10.10

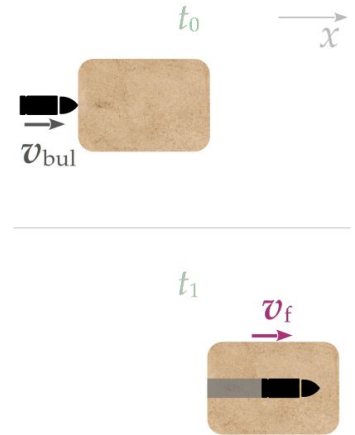
Solution p. 107

At a time instant t_0 a bullet is in contact with a wooden block, as illustrated in the top margin figure. The bullet has mass 0.0080 kg and horizontal velocity $v_{\text{bul}} = 370 \text{ m/s}$ to the right. The wooden block has mass 0.2 kg and is at rest.

At a later time instant t_1 the bullet has entered the wooden block and got stuck in it, as illustrated in the bottom margin figure. Now bullet and block are moving together with the same common horizontal velocity v_f .

Find their common final velocity v_f .

There are no surface forces (flux of momentum) exerted on bullet & block, and gravity can be neglected. Use just one coordinate x .



10.11

Solution p. 111

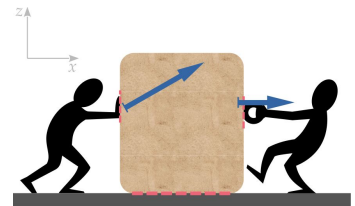
At some time instant a tennis ball is at a height of 10 m above ground, with a downward velocity of 1.0 m/s . At a later instant of time the ball is at a height of 8.0 m above ground. The tennis ball's mass is 0.060 kg , its motion is purely vertical, there are no obstacles in its course, and air can be neglected.

How much is the velocity of the ball at the later instant of time, when it is 8.0 m above ground?

10.12

Solution p. 114

Two people are handling a crate of mass-energy 110 kg , as illustrated in the margin figure. The person on the left exerts a diagonal surface force $[350, 200] \text{ N}$; the one on the right, a horizontal surface force $[250, 0] \text{ N}$. The static-friction factor between the floor and the crate is 0.62 , whereas the kinetic-friction factor is 0.45 . The gravitational acceleration is $g = 9.8 \text{ N/kg}$. Assume that Amontons's laws of friction apply.



1. If the crate is at rest, do the two people manage to set it into motion?
2. If the crate is moving, at some time t , with an instantaneous velocity of 0.05 m/s in the positive- x direction, how much is its horizontal acceleration?

10.13

Solution p. 118

A robot-arm gripper must vertically lift a block of metal having mass-energy 6.0 kg. The block must stay firmly between the gripper's fingers while they move vertically. The static-friction factor of the contact between block and fingers is 0.86.

Assume that Amontons's laws of friction apply, and that the two fingers always apply forces of equal magnitude. The problem can be treated as spatially two-dimensional with coordinates (t, x, z) as in the margin figure.



1. The metal block is lifted with a constant upward velocity of 0.10 m/s. What is the minimum magnitude of the normal, horizontal force that each gripper finger must exert in order to achieve this?
2. The metal block is then lifted with a constant upward acceleration of 5.0 m/s^2 . What is the minimum magnitude of the normal, horizontal force that each gripper finger must exert in order to achieve this?

10.14

Solution p. 120

Preferably together with one or more colleagues:

For this exercise, download the script for the simulation of a falling tennis ball (Octave: `tennisball_rP.m`⁵, Python: `tennisball_rP.py`⁶), and make first sure it runs correctly.

Now explore more extreme physical situations.

1. Let's imagine the ball to be in a uniform but very extended gravitational field, so that it can keep on falling for a long time. Set the gravitational acceleration constant to 9.8 N/kg , the simulation end-time to $t_1 = 1 \times 10^8 \text{ s}$ (that's a little longer than six years), and the time step to $\Delta t = 1 \times 10^6 \text{ s}$.

Run the script and make sure to save the output plots of the ball's vertical momentum $P_z(t)$ and vertical position $z(t)$ against time t . The resulting heights are unrealistic, but don't mind about that.

- How does the vertical momentum P_z change with time? Would you say its time dependence is *linear* or *parabolic*?
- What about the vertical position z ? linear or parabolic?

2. Now use a more precise constitutive relation between momentum and velocity. Keep the same parameters as in the previous question, but instead of Newton's $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{P}/m$, implement the more precise relativistic formula

$$\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{P} / \sqrt{m^2 + |\mathbf{P}|^2 / c^2}$$

at the appropriate place of the script. You must also declare the speed of light $c = 299\,792\,458$ m/s among the constants.

Run the script and make again sure to save the output plots of $P_z(t)$ and $z(t)$ against time t .

- How does the vertical momentum P_z change with time? Would you say its time dependence is *linear* or *parabolic*? Do you notice a difference in shape from the previous question? If you don't, try to explain mathematically why there is no difference.
- What about the vertical position z ? linear or parabolic? Different from the previous question?
- If we accelerate an object, its speed cannot become larger than light's, so at most it levels up at that value. Do you manage to see this behaviour from the plots? Explain how.

In Octave and Python the norm $|\dots|$ is implemented as `norm(...)` and the square root as `sqrt(...)`.

Raising to a square, $(\dots)^2$, is implemented in Octave as `...^2` and in Python as `...**2`.

10.15

Solution p. 122

Preferably together with one or more colleagues:

For this exercise, use again the script for the simulation of a falling tennis ball (Octave: `tennisball_rP.m`⁷, Python: `tennisball_rP.py`⁸).

Suppose that you want to describe the physical behaviour of not one, but *two* tennis balls:

1. How many control volumes would you use?
2. How many balances of momentum? Why?
3. Modify the tennis-ball script so that it simulates two tennis balls instead of one.
 - Suppose that the tennis balls “don't see” each other, so you don't need to worry about momentum fluxes between them.
 - Allow for the possibility that the two tennis balls have different masses.

- Try to modify the plots so that the vertical positions of the two balls are plotted against time, in the same plot.

Which modifications do you need to make to the script? Try them out and see if they work.

10.16

Solution p. 122

This is a continuation of Exercise 10.15:

Let's add the possibility that the two tennis balls may collide, in which case there is a momentum flux (contact force) between them. We must find a constitutive relation for this momentum flux.

Call $\mathbf{r}_a$ and $\mathbf{r}_b$ the positions of the two tennis balls, and $\mathbf{F}_a$ the influx of momentum into tennis ball a from b . Let's use the following constitutive relation:

$$\mathbf{F}_a = \begin{cases} [0, 0, 0] \text{ N} & \text{if } |\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b| > d \\ \frac{k}{|\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b|^2} (\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b) & \text{if } |\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b| \leq d \end{cases}$$

where k is a positive constant, and d is the diameter of one tennis ball, or equivalently the distance between their centres when they touch.

1. What is the physical dimension of the constant k ?
2. When the tennis balls touch, what are the *direction* and the *orientation* of the momentum influx $\mathbf{F}_a$?
3. How does the *magnitude* of the momentum influx $\mathbf{F}_a$ depend on the distance between the tennis balls? Does it increase or decrease when the distance decreases? What is its value when $\mathbf{r}_a = \mathbf{r}_b$, that is, the centres of the tennis balls coincide?
4. Call $\mathbf{F}_b$ the influx of momentum into tennis ball b . How is it related to $\mathbf{F}_a$? Which principle do you use to find this relation?
5. Can the fluxes $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ be considered as *boundary conditions* in this physical problem?

10.17

Solution p. 123

This is a continuation of Exercise 10.16.

Start from the script for the simulation of two independent tennis balls, and implement the constitutive relation from the previous exercise, by means of an if-else construct. In particular:

1. Where in the time-iteration while-loop should the constitutive relation for $\mathbf{F}_a$ appear? why?
2. In order to calculate $\mathbf{F}_b$, use the principle of symmetry of flux. Where in the while-loop should this calculation appear? Why?
3. Prepare the script with the following constants, initial conditions, and time-iteration parameters:

$$m_a = 0.06 \text{ kg} \quad m_b = 0.06 \text{ kg} \quad k = 10 \text{ N m} \quad d = 0.07 \text{ m}$$

$$\mathbf{r}_a = [0, 0, 10] \text{ m} \quad \mathbf{r}_b = [0, 0, 5] \text{ m}$$

$$\mathbf{P}_a = [0, 0, -0.5] \text{ N s} \quad \mathbf{P}_b = [0, 0, 0.5] \text{ N s}$$

$$t_1 = 2 \text{ s} \quad \Delta t = 0.00001 \text{ s}$$

Analysing these values, what do expect to happen? will the tennis ball bounce against each other? how many times?

4. Now we want to replace tennis ball a with a floor. Can this be done in a simple way?

In this simulation, the shape of the tennis ball is not important; in fact, nothing in the script says that this should be a tennis ball: what counts is the object's mass m_a , position $\mathbf{r}_a$, momentum $\mathbf{P}_a$, and the force of gravity $\mathbf{G}_a$ on it. Let us therefore think of it as the floor. What should be its mass, position, momentum? A floor is essentially Earth's surface: its mass is large, and the force of gravity on it can be neglected (it is the source of gravity).

Therefore think now of object a as the floor instead. Prepare the script with the following constants, initial conditions, boundary conditions, and time-iteration parameters:

$$m_a = 0.06 \text{ kg} \quad m_b = 10\,000 \text{ kg} \quad k = 10 \text{ N m} \quad d = 0.07 \text{ m}$$

$$\mathbf{G}_a = -m_a g [0, 0, 1] \quad \mathbf{G}_b = [0, 0, 0]$$

$$\mathbf{r}_a = [0, 0, 5] \text{ m} \quad \mathbf{r}_b = [0, 0, 0] \text{ m}$$

$$\mathbf{P}_a = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N s} \quad \mathbf{P}_b = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N s}$$

$$t_1 = 2 \text{ s} \quad \Delta t = 0.000002 \text{ s}$$

Analysing these values, what do you expect to happen? will the tennis ball bounce on the floor? how many times?

10.18

With a Large Language Model:

If you have access to a large-language-model service, try feeding it one of our simulation scripts, and ask it to analyse what the different parts do.

- Does it correctly explain the purpose of the different blocks in the script?
- Does it recognize the difference between constitutive relations and balance laws, and their different roles in the time iteration?

It's possible that the large language model might offer you to “optimize” the script. Keep in mind that we're writing the scripts in order to understand the physics, rather than to be numerically efficient.

10.19

Solution p. 124

For this exercise, start from the script for the simulation of two objects connected by a spring obeying Hooke's law (Octave: `hooke_spring.m`⁹, Python: `hooke_spring.py`¹⁰).

1. Within the time-iteration loop, find the line containing

$$l = \text{norm}(ra - rb)$$

From a physical point of view, what does this line do? Is it a constitutive relation? Or a balance law? Or a line that performs some operation that's useful for other lines?

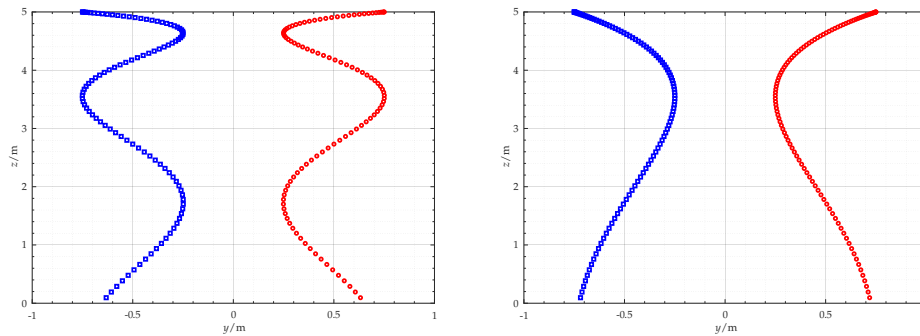
Can you completely remove this line by making small changes in other lines of the while-loop?

2. Within the time-iteration loop, find the line containing

$$Fb = -Fa$$

It seems to say that something is 'minus' something else. Does this line express the principle of symmetry of flux?

3. The script can be modified to represent two tennis balls, each with mass 0.06 kg, initially at rest at (y, z) positions $[-0.75, 5]$ m and $[0.75, 5]$ m, and zero velocity, and connected by a spring having natural length of 1 m. Let's choose two different values of the spring's elastic constant k . The two plots below show the tennis balls' trajectories as they fall down; each plot correspond to a different value of the elastic constant:



Which plot corresponds to the simulation with the largest elastic constant, and which with the lowest? Why?

10.20

Solution p. 124

Start from the script for the simulation of a flying tennis ball (Octave: `tennisball_rP.m`¹¹, Python: `tennisball_rP.py`¹²).

1. Which are the *state variables* in this simulation? Why?
2. Modify the script so that the time iteration uses the state variables $(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v})$. Which blocks of lines in the script do you need to remove or add?
3. Is it possible to use $(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{G})$ as state variables? If it's possible, modify the script accordingly. If it's impossible, explain why.

10.21

Solution p. 124

Start from the script for the simulation of two objects connected by a spring obeying Hooke's law (Octave: `hooke_spring.m`¹³, Python: `hooke_spring.py`¹⁴).

1. Which are the *state variables* in this simulation? Why?
2. Modify the script so that the time iteration uses the state variables $(\mathbf{r}_a, \mathbf{r}_b, \mathbf{P}_a, \mathbf{P}_b)$. Which blocks of lines in the script do you need to remove or add?
3. Modify the script so that the time iteration uses the state variables $(\mathbf{r}_a, \mathbf{r}_b, \mathbf{P}_a, \mathbf{P}_b)$. Which blocks of lines in the script do you need to remove or add?
4. Is it possible to use $(\mathbf{F}_a, \mathbf{F}_b, \mathbf{v}_a, \mathbf{v}_b)$ as state variables? If it's possible, modify the script accordingly. If it's impossible, explain why.

10.22

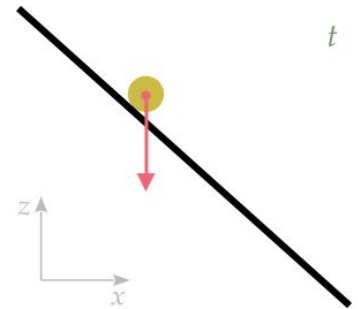
Solution p. 124

The following prompt was given to a Large Language Model (ChatGPT 5.1):

Use a coordinate system (x, z) fixed with the ground, with z upwards. The gravitational acceleration is 9.8 N/kg . We have the following information below about a given time instant t :

A small solid object of constant mass 1 kg is in contact with an inclined plane at this time instant. The plane forms an angle of $\pi/4$ rad with the ground, inclined from bottom-right to top-left. There cannot be friction between the object and the inclined plane.

Given the information and assumptions above, is it possible to calculate the acceleration of the object (both components) at this time instant?



The LLM's output is displayed in table 10.1 on the next page.

Determine whether the LLM's output and "analysis" are correct. Keep in mind, as always, that *there isn't any logical reasoning underneath the output*: it's just built from word correlations computed from a huge corpus of text. Detect any sentences and conclusions that are false or meaningless for the present task.

Table 10.1 Large Language Model output

Yes, it is possible to determine the acceleration components at that instant, under the usual assumption that the only forces are gravity and the normal reaction of the plane (no friction, no air resistance).

1. Forces and constraint

- Mass: $m = 1 \text{ kg}$
- Gravitational acceleration (downwards): $\mathbf{g} = [0, -g]$ with $g = 9.8 \text{ m/s}^2$
- Plane: inclined at angle $\theta = \pi/4$ above the horizontal, rising from right to left.
- No friction: only gravity and a normal force $\mathbf{F}_n$ from the plane.

Because the object is constrained to remain in contact with the plane and there is no friction, its acceleration is entirely along the plane (tangent direction). The normal component of the acceleration is zero.

2. Direction along the plane

Let the plane's **up-slope** unit vector be

$$\mathbf{s}_{\text{up}} = [\text{horizontal}, \text{vertical}] = [-\cos \theta, \sin \theta] ,$$

since it goes up to the left.

The **down-slope** direction is the opposite:

$$\mathbf{s}_{\text{down}} = -\mathbf{s}_{\text{up}} = [\cos \theta, -\sin \theta] .$$

On a frictionless incline, the component of gravity along the plane is

$$\mathbf{a} = g \sin \theta \mathbf{s}_{\text{down}} ,$$

because $m = 1 \text{ kg}$ so $\mathbf{a} = \mathbf{F}/m$ and the tangential component of weight is $m g \sin \theta$ along the plane.

3. Components in (x, z) coordinates

Using

$$\mathbf{s}_{\text{down}} = [\cos \theta, -\sin \theta]$$

we have

$$\mathbf{a} = g \sin \theta [\cos \theta, -\sin \theta] = [g \sin \theta \cos \theta, -g (\sin \theta)^2] .$$

For $\theta = \pi/4$:

$$\sin \theta = \cos \theta = \sqrt{2}/2 , \quad \sin \theta \cos \theta = 1/2 , \quad (\sin \theta)^2 = 1/2 .$$

Thus

$$a_x = g/2 , \quad a_z = -g/2 .$$

With $g = 9.8 \text{ m/s}^2$:

$$a_x = +4.9 \text{ m/s}^2 \quad (\text{to the right}), \quad a_z = -4.9 \text{ m/s}^2 \quad (\text{downwards}).$$

So the acceleration vector at that instant is

$$\mathbf{a} = [4.9, -4.9] \text{ m/s}^2 .$$

Example solutions



10.1

Exercise p. 79

The approximate form of the momentum balance, neglecting gravity, is

$$\mathbf{P}(t_0 + \Delta t) \approx \mathbf{P}(t_0) + \mathbf{F}(t_0) \Delta t .$$

In this case $\mathbf{P}$ is the momentum content of Boros's control volume, and $\mathbf{F}$ the contact force exerted on it by Saitama's punch while making contact with Boros. The time t_0 is the time at which contact is made, and Δt is the duration of the contact. All vectors are horizontal and parallel.

Newton's constitutive formula for momentum says that Boros's momentum is

$$\mathbf{P} = m\mathbf{v}$$

where m and $\mathbf{v}$ are Boros's mass and velocity.

Combining the two equations and solving for $\mathbf{F}$ we find

$$\mathbf{F} \approx m \frac{\mathbf{v}(t_0 + \Delta t) - \mathbf{v}(t_0)}{\Delta t} .$$

So we can estimate the force of Saitama's punch if we can estimate the four quantities m , $\mathbf{v}(t_0)$, $\mathbf{v}(t_0 + \Delta t)$, Δt .

- Boros's mass is probably the quantity most difficult to estimate. Considering that a human heavy wrestler can have a mass of more than 100 kg, and that Boros is also wearing an armour, let's estimate his mass at $m \approx 200$ kg. Note that if we halve or double this amount, then the estimate of the force $\mathbf{F}$ will be halved or doubled as well.
- Boros's initial velocity is zero, because he is initially standing still: $\mathbf{v}(t_0) = 0$ m/s.
- Boros's final velocity is larger than the speed of sound; it might be much larger: $\mathbf{v}(t_0 + \Delta t) \gtrsim 340$ m/s.
- From the frame numbers we see that the duration Δt of the contact between Saitama's punch and Boros lasts less than 4 frames. Each frame lasts 0.042 s, so $\Delta t \lesssim 4 \text{ frames} \cdot 0.042 \text{ s/frame} \approx 0.17$ s.

Substituting these estimates we find

$$\mathbf{F} \approx m \frac{\mathbf{v}(t_0 + \Delta t) - \mathbf{v}(t_0)}{\Delta t} \gtrsim 200 \text{ kg} \cdot \frac{340 \text{ m/s}}{0.17 \text{ s}} \approx 400\,000 \text{ N} .$$

If we double or halve our estimate of Boros's mass, the force could be 800 000 N or 200 000 N.

In terms of equivalent weight, this force is

$$400\,000\text{ N}/g = 400\,000\text{ N}/(9.8\text{ N/kg}) \approx 40\,000\text{ kg}$$

or 40 tonnes.

So Saitama exerted a force equivalent to a weight of 40 tonnes, concentrated in less than half a second.

10.2

Exercise p. 80

We can apply the differential form of the balance of momentum:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = \mathbf{F} + \mathbf{G}$$

at the given time.

The total *influx* $\mathbf{F}$ is given, by the principle of extensivity, by the sum of the individual fluxes, given in the problem. We must only be careful to respect the crossing directions of the fluxes; in particular the flux through surface C is given as an *efflux*, so we must change its sign, by the principle of symmetry of flux:

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_A + \mathbf{F}_B - \underbrace{\mathbf{F}_C}_{\text{efflux}} + \mathbf{F}_D + \mathbf{F}_E .$$

The time derivative of momentum is given:

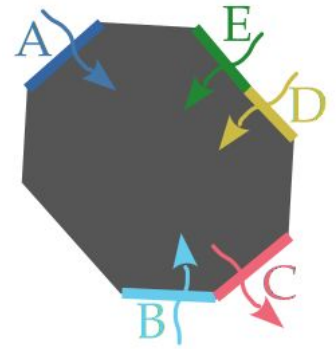
$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = [4, -1, 3]\text{ N} ,$$

as well as the momentum supply from gravity:

$$\mathbf{G} = [0, 0, 0]\text{ N} .$$

Substituting everything in the balance of momentum we find

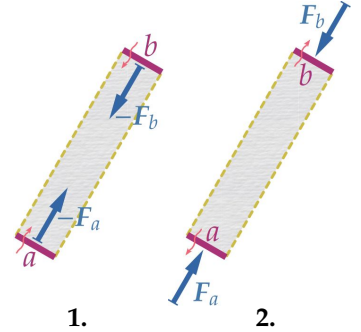
$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} &= \mathbf{F} + \mathbf{G} \\ \Rightarrow \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} &= \mathbf{F}_A + \mathbf{F}_B - \mathbf{F}_C + \mathbf{F}_D + \mathbf{F}_E + \mathbf{G} \\ \Rightarrow [4, -1, 3]\text{ N} &= [3, 2, -7]\text{ N} + [-5, 0, 0]\text{ N} - [4, 4, 4]\text{ N} + [0, 0, 1]\text{ N} + \mathbf{F}_E + [0, 0, 0]\text{ N} \\ \Rightarrow \mathbf{F}_E &= [10, 1, 13]\text{ N} . \end{aligned}$$



10.3

Exercise p. 80

1. See margin figure on the left. To depict the **influxes** we have changed the crossing directions represented by the **light-red wiggly arrows**. The influxes point in a direction opposite to the effluxes, by the principle of flux symmetry. Note that these are still *compressive* forces.
2. See margin figure on the right. We are depicting **effluxes**, but now these are *tensile*: they give to what's outside a momentum that points towards the surface.



10.4

Exercise p. 81

1. The momentum fluxes, or surface forces, $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}}$ are related by the principle of **symmetry of flux**, which in this case is the same as Newton's 3rd law. These forces occur *on the same surface*: $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$ represents a flux of momentum from the block on the right to that on the left; $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}}$ represents the same flux but in the opposite crossing direction, from the block on the left to that on the right. So they are equal in magnitude but opposite in direction:

$$\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}} = -\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}} .$$

2. Being on the Earth's surface, we can use the constitutive relation for the gravitational force:

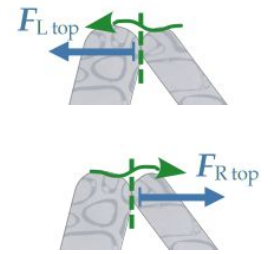
$$\mathbf{G} = -m\mathbf{g} [0, 1] , \quad g \approx 9.8 \text{ N/kg},$$

where m is the mass in the control volume. In this case we therefore find

$$\mathbf{G}_L = -m_L \mathbf{g} [0, 1] \approx [0, -26\,000] \text{ N} ,$$

$$\mathbf{G}_R = -m_R \mathbf{g} [0, 1] \approx [0, -88\,000] \text{ N} .$$

3. It looks like we have enough information if we focus on the *right block* only, considered as one control volume. The physical principles we need are:
 - The **balance of momentum**; this is obvious because the problem is about determining forces, that is, momentum fluxes.
 - The principle of **extensivity**; it says that the force occurring on the block's whole surface is the sum of the forces on individual parts of the surface. We need it because the balance of momentum requires the total force, but the problem is giving us separate forces.



- The principle of **symmetry of flux**, which is also called Newton's 3rd law in the case of forces; it was discussed in the first answer above. We need it because the balance of momentum requires the surface forces *to* the block, but one of the forces given in the problem, $\mathbf{F}_{L\text{ top}}$, is a force *from* the block.
- Finally we need the constitutive relation for the gravity force, since this force also appears in the balance of momentum.

The information given in the text is the following:

- The situation is static, so the momentum is constant in time (and zero).
- The mass of the right block; this can be used directly in the formula for the gravity force.
- $F_{L\text{ top}, z} = 0 \text{ N}$.
- $F_{R\text{ bot}, x} = -33\,075 \text{ N}$.
- No forces on the surfaces in contact with air; so we can simply disregard these.

If we call $\mathbf{P}_R$ the momentum of the right block, and $\mathbf{F}_R$ the *total* surface force on it, we can write all the laws and information above as follows:

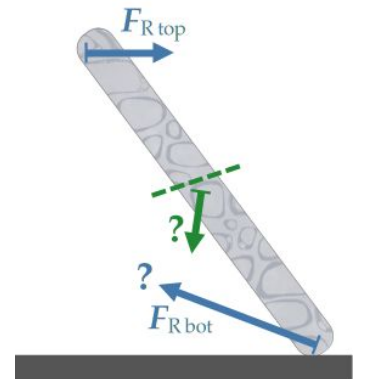
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_R}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_R + \mathbf{G}_R$	momentum balance
$\mathbf{F}_R = \mathbf{F}_{R\text{ top}} + \mathbf{F}_{R\text{ bot}}$	extensivity
$\mathbf{F}_{R\text{ top}} = -\mathbf{F}_{L\text{ top}}$	symmetry of flux, Newton's 3rd law
$\mathbf{G}_R = -m_R g \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \approx \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -88\,000 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N}$	constit. rel. for gravity force
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_R}{dt} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N}$	static situation
$\mathbf{F}_{L\text{ top}} = \begin{bmatrix} F_{L\text{ top}, x} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix}$	info
$\mathbf{F}_{R\text{ bot}} = \begin{bmatrix} -33\,075 \text{ N} \\ F_{R\text{ bot}, z} \end{bmatrix}$	info

This system can be solved by substitution for example, as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \frac{d\mathbf{P}_R}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_R + \mathbf{G}_R \\
 \Rightarrow & \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{F}_R + \mathbf{G}_R && \text{static situation} \\
 \Rightarrow & \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}} + \mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}} + \mathbf{G}_R && \text{extensivity} \\
 \Rightarrow & \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} = -\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}} + \mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}} + \mathbf{G}_R && \text{symmetry of flux} \\
 \Rightarrow & \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} = - \begin{bmatrix} F_{L\text{top},x} \\ 0 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} -33\,075 \text{ N} \\ F_{R\text{bot},z} \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ -88\,000 \text{ N} \end{bmatrix} && \text{info} \\
 \Rightarrow & F_{L\text{top},x} = -33\,075 \text{ N} \\
 & F_{R\text{bot},z} = 88\,000 \text{ N}
 \end{aligned}$$

We could also have considered other alternative ways of solving the problem; for example:

- With each block as a control volume: two control volumes in total. In this approach we should consider two balances of momentum, one for each block, and also the forces $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$ and $\mathbf{G}_R$. This approach would also lead to the solution of the problem. We would be using more equations than necessary, so it would be inefficient – but still physically correct.
- Imagining to divide the right granite block into two (or more!) parts, say an upper part and a lower part; see margin figure. This block would then be as *two* control volumes. In this approach we should consider a balance of momentum for the upper part and one for the lower part. We should also need to consider the forces (displayed in **green** in the margin figure) at the surface dividing the upper and lower parts, and the gravitational forces (not displayed in the margin figure) on the upper and lower parts. We would arrive at the solution of the problem, again using more equations than necessary.
- With both blocks together, considered as a single object; that is, as *one* control volume. In this approach we should consider just one balance of momentum, for both blocks together, and also the force $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$ and the total gravitational force on the two blocks. The force between the two blocks, at the top, would not be considered, because it would be



Imaginary division of the right granite block into two parts, along the **dashed green line**. The original left block has been omitted.

a force internal to our object. This approach would not lead to the solution of the problem. We would arrive at the equation

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}} = -\mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} - \mathbf{G}_{\text{L}} - \mathbf{G}_{\text{R}}$$

which cannot be solved for $F_{\text{Rbot},z}$, because $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}}$ is completely unknown.

💡 10.5

Exercise p. 81

1. Let's denote the momentum, total surface force, and gravitational force for the left block with $\mathbf{P}_{\text{L}}, \mathbf{F}_{\text{L}}, \mathbf{G}_{\text{L}}$; those for the central block with $\mathbf{P}_{\text{C}}, \mathbf{F}_{\text{C}}, \mathbf{G}_{\text{C}}$; those for the right block with $\mathbf{P}_{\text{R}}, \mathbf{F}_{\text{R}}, \mathbf{G}_{\text{R}}$. We have one balance of momentum per block. The texts says that the arrangement is static, therefore the changes in the three momenta are zero.

The total surface forces on each block are calculated by adding the forces on the separate surfaces, because of the principle of extensivity:

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{L}} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{Ltop}}, \quad \mathbf{F}_{\text{C}} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{Cleft}} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{Cright}}, \quad \mathbf{F}_{\text{R}} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{Rtop}}.$$

The forces between the left and central blocks, and those between the central and right blocks, are related by the principle of symmetry of flux (Newton's 3rd law in this case):

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{Cleft}} = -\mathbf{F}_{\text{Ltop}}, \quad \mathbf{F}_{\text{Cright}} = -\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rtop}}.$$

For the gravitational force of each blocks we can use the constitutive relations

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{G}_{\text{L}} &= -m_{\text{L}} g [0, 1] \approx [0, -130\,000] \text{ N}, \\ \mathbf{G}_{\text{C}} &= -m_{\text{C}} g [0, 1] \approx [0, -20\,000] \text{ N}, \\ \mathbf{G}_{\text{R}} &= -m_{\text{R}} g [0, 1] \approx [0, -88\,000] \text{ N}. \end{aligned}$$

Collecting together all the equations above we obtain the following system:

$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_L}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_L + \mathbf{G}_L$	momentum balance block L
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_C}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_C + \mathbf{G}_C$	momentum balance block C
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_R}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_R + \mathbf{G}_R$	momentum balance block R
$\mathbf{F}_L = \mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}} + \mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}}$	extensivity block L
$\mathbf{F}_C = \mathbf{F}_{C\text{left}} + \mathbf{F}_{C\text{right}}$	extensivity block C
$\mathbf{F}_R = \mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}} + \mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$	extensivity block R
$\mathbf{F}_{C\text{left}} = -\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}}$	symmetry of flux
$\mathbf{F}_{C\text{right}} = -\mathbf{F}_{L\text{top}}$	symmetry of flux
$\mathbf{G}_L = -m_L g [0, 1]$	gravity force block L
$\mathbf{G}_C = -m_C g [0, 1]$	gravity force block C
$\mathbf{G}_R = -m_R g [0, 1]$	gravity force block R
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_L}{dt} = [0, 0] \text{ N}$	static situation block L
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_C}{dt} = [0, 0] \text{ N}$	static situation block C
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_R}{dt} = [0, 0] \text{ N}$	static situation block R
$\mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}} = [29\,400, 151\,900] \text{ N}$	information

Solving the system above by substitution, we notice that all the forces between the blocks mathematically disappear from the final result:

$$\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}} = -\mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}} - \mathbf{G}_L - \mathbf{G}_C - \mathbf{G}_R \approx [-29\,400, 83\,000] \text{ N}.$$

But from the same system it is also possible to find all other surface forces. In particular

$$\mathbf{F}_{R\text{top}} = \mathbf{F}_{L\text{bot}} + \mathbf{G}_L + \mathbf{G}_C \approx [29\,400, 4900] \text{ N}.$$

2. In the previous solution, the forces between the granite rocks mathematically disappear from the final result for $\mathbf{F}_{R\text{bot}}$. This may indicate that this force can be found considering the three blocks as a single object, a single control volume.

Denote by $\mathbf{P}$, $\mathbf{F}$, $\mathbf{G}$ the total momentum, surface force, and gravitational force for this control volume. These three satisfy the balance of momentum, and we know that the time derivative of momentum is zero because of the static situation.

The principle of extensivity applies to the surface forces, but in this case we have a sum of only two:

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}}$$

because all the other surface forces occur on surfaces *within* the control volume, thus they don't count. There is no need to consider any symmetry of flux (Newton's 3rd law) either.

The total gravitational force is obtained by either adding the gravitational forces for the three subvolumes, or by considering the total mass:

$$\mathbf{G} = -(m_{\text{L}} + m_{\text{C}} + m_{\text{R}}) g [0, 1] \approx [0, -240\,000] \text{ N}.$$

In this approach we obtain this system:

$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = \mathbf{F} + \mathbf{G}$	momentum balance, all blocks together
$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}}$	extensivity
$\mathbf{G} = -(m_{\text{L}} + m_{\text{C}} + m_{\text{R}}) g [0, 1]$	gravity force, all blocks together
$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = [0, 0] \text{ N}$	static situation
$\mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} = [29\,400, 151\,900] \text{ N}$	information

from which we find the same solution as before, but much faster:

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rbot}} = -\mathbf{F}_{\text{Lbot}} - \mathbf{G} \approx [-29\,400, 83\,000] \text{ N}.$$

In this approach, however, we cannot find $\mathbf{F}_{\text{Rtop}}$ or any of the other forces between the blocks.

💡 10.6

Exercise p. 82

1. No, we don't have enough information to find the surface force $\mathbf{F}(t_1)$ from road to car at that time instant. One way to calculate such force would be to apply the balance of momentum to the car at that time:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}(t_1)}{dt} = \mathbf{F}(t_1) + \mathbf{G}(t_1),$$

where $\mathbf{P}$ is the car's momentum and $\mathbf{G}$ the gravitational force on the car. In order to find $\mathbf{F}$ we'd need to know both $d\mathbf{P}(t_1)/dt$ and $\mathbf{G}(t_1)$. We

can calculate the latter from the information given, but $d\mathbf{P}(t_1)/dt$ is unknown.

Applying Newton's constitutive relation between momentum and velocity we can find that the car's momentum at t_1 is

$$\mathbf{P}(t_1) = m \mathbf{v}(t_1) \approx [-160\,000, 9200] \text{ N s}$$

but this doesn't tell us anything about the *change* in momentum at that time: the momentum could be constant, or it could be larger or smaller a little later.

2. Yes, now we do have enough information to calculate $\mathbf{F}(t_1)$. We are given the magnitude of the acceleration at time t_1 , and are told that it has the same direction of the velocity. We can find the acceleration components by multiplying the magnitude by a unit vector formed from the velocity:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\mathbf{v}(t_1)}{dt} &= 0.95 \text{ m/s}^2 \cdot \frac{\mathbf{v}(t_1)}{|\mathbf{v}(t_1)|} \\ &\approx 0.95 \text{ m/s}^2 \cdot \frac{[-11.4, 6.6]}{\sqrt{11.4^2 + 6.6^2}} = 0.95 \text{ m/s}^2 \cdot \frac{[-11.4, 6.6]}{13.17} \\ &= [-0.8223, 0.4761] \text{ m/s}^2 . \end{aligned}$$

Since the car's mass is constant, we can then find the time derivative of the car's momentum, at time t_1 , by using Newton's relation between momentum and velocity:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\mathbf{P}(t_1)}{dt} &= \frac{dm\mathbf{v}(t_1)}{dt} = m \frac{d\mathbf{v}(t_1)}{dt} \\ &= 1400 \text{ kg} \cdot [-0.8223, 0.4761] \text{ m/s}^2 = [-1151, 666.5] \text{ N} . \end{aligned}$$

Note that it doesn't matter that we don't know the acceleration before or after time t_1 : all we need is the acceleration at that time instant only.

From the car's mass we can also find the gravitational force, using the appropriate constitutive relation:

$$\mathbf{G} = -mg [0, 1] = -[0, 13\,720] \text{ N} .$$

Finally, using the balance of momentum at time t_1 we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{F}(t_1) &= \frac{d\mathbf{P}(t_1)}{dt} - \mathbf{G}(t_1) \\ &= [-1151, 666.5] \text{ N} + [0, 13\,720] \text{ N} \approx [-1200, 14\,000] \text{ N} . \end{aligned}$$

This is the force exerted from the road to the car at time t_1 . It could of course be different at an earlier or later time.

10.7

Exercise p. 82

Let's proceed as indicated in the text.

- (a) Denote with $\mathbf{P}$ the total momentum contained in the imaginary control volume; with $\mathbf{F}_{\text{tot}}$ the *total* surface force exerted on all its sides; and with $\mathbf{G}$ the total volume force from gravity.
- (b) The balance of momentum applies:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{tot}} + \mathbf{G} .$$

We focus on the x -component only:

$$\frac{dP_x}{dt} = F_{\text{tot},x} + G_x .$$

- (c) The control volume has six sides in total: four shown in the figure (as dashed lines), plus one facing us, plus one behind. The text says that only two sides have forces with x -components: the vertical left side, with force F_{left} ; and the vertical right side, which is the building's side, with the force from the building to the air; see margin figure here. Let's call this force $F_{\text{build} \rightsquigarrow \text{air}}$.

Therefore

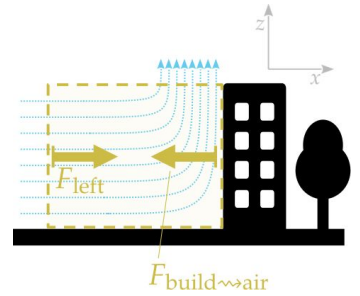
$$F_{\text{tot},x} = F_{\text{left}} + F_{\text{build} \rightsquigarrow \text{air}} .$$

- (d) The constitutive relation applied to the force F_{left} gives

$$\begin{aligned} F_{\text{left}} &= A \rho (v_{\text{wind}})^2 + A p_{\text{air}} \\ &= 450 \text{ m}^2 \cdot 1.2 \text{ kg/m}^3 \cdot (30 \text{ m/s})^2 + 450 \text{ m}^2 \cdot 1.0 \times 10^5 \text{ N/m}^2 \\ &\approx 486\,000 \text{ N} + 45\,000\,000 \text{ N} . \end{aligned}$$

- (e) We assume $dP_x/dt = 0 \text{ N}$ because the wind is steady, as indicated in the text. We also know that G_x because the gravitational force is vertical. So we obtain

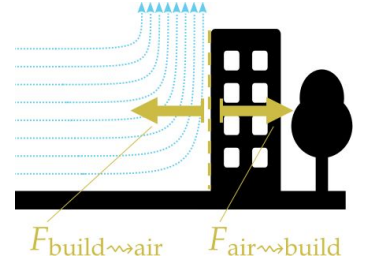
$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dP_x}{dt} &= F_{\text{tot},x} + G_x \\ \Rightarrow 0 \text{ N} &= F_{\text{left}} + F_{\text{build} \rightsquigarrow \text{air}} + 0 \text{ N} \\ \Rightarrow F_{\text{build} \rightsquigarrow \text{air}} &= -F_{\text{left}} \approx -486\,000 \text{ N} - 45\,000\,000 \text{ N} . \end{aligned}$$



The force we want to find is the one from the wind's air to the building, that is, $F_{\text{air} \rightsquigarrow \text{build}}$. By the principle of symmetry of flux (Newton's 3rd law in this case) we finally find

$$F_{\text{air} \rightsquigarrow \text{build}} = -F_{\text{build} \rightsquigarrow \text{air}} \approx 486\,000\text{ N} + 45\,000\,000\text{ N}.$$

The second term is the usual atmospheric pressure. It's the first term, approximately 490 000 N, which may be worrying: is the building's structure able to withstand such an extra force from one side?



10.8

Exercise p. 84

1. The dimensions and units are indeed correct: the quantity 190 N/s has dimension force/time, and is multiplied by t , which has dimension time, so we're left with dimension force.
2. To find the momentum at t_1 we must use the integral expression of the balance of momentum:

$$\mathbf{P}(t_1) = \mathbf{P}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G} dt.$$

From the problem it seems that we can obtain all three terms on the right side.

For the initial momentum we can use Newton's relation between momentum and velocity:

$$\mathbf{P}(t_0) = m \mathbf{v}(t_0) = 0.42\text{ kg} \cdot [0, 0]\text{ m/s} = [0, 0]\text{ N s}.$$

For the time-integrated momentum influx, we calculate the integral; let's denote $a := 190\text{ N/s}$:

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt = \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \begin{bmatrix} a t \\ 0\text{ N} \end{bmatrix} dt \equiv \begin{bmatrix} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} a t dt \\ \int_{t_0}^{t_1} (0\text{ N}) dt \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} a t_1^2 - \frac{1}{2} a t_0^2 \\ 0\text{ N s} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 8.55 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s}.$$

The time-integrated momentum supply is also obtained by integration:

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G} dt = - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} m g \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} dt \equiv -m g \begin{bmatrix} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 0 dt \\ \int_{t_0}^{t_1} 1 dt \end{bmatrix} = -m g \begin{bmatrix} 0\text{ s} \\ t_1 - t_0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -1.235 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s}.$$

Substituting the three terms in the balance of momentum above, we finally find

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{P}(t_1) &= \mathbf{P}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{F}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{G} dt \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} + \begin{bmatrix} 8.55 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -1.235 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} \approx \begin{bmatrix} 8.6 \\ -1.2 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} .\end{aligned}$$

To find this result we had to use Newton's constitutive relation between momentum and velocity, needed to find the initial momentum; and the constitutive relation for the gravitational force.

3. We use again Newton's relation to find the final velocity from the final momentum:

$$\mathbf{v}(t_1) = \mathbf{P}(t_1)/m = \begin{bmatrix} 8.55 \\ -1.235 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N s} / 0.42 \text{ kg} \approx \begin{bmatrix} 20 \\ -2.9 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m/s} .$$

💡 10.9

Exercise p. 84

1. Given the information and the particular physical conditions, for instance the speeds involved are much lower than the speed of light, it seems that **Newton's constitutive relation for the momentum of matter**, ' $\mathbf{P} = m\mathbf{v}$ ', can be used here. But there is a hitch: this constitutive relation can be used only for a control volume within which matter has the same velocity $\mathbf{v}$ everywhere. So we cannot apply the formula directly to our control volume, because some of the matter in it has a velocity, and some another. In fact, which velocity should we use in the formula, $v = +25 \text{ m/s}$ or $v = -25 \text{ m/s}$?

In order to use Newton's relation for momentum we can use the **principle of extensivity**: the momentum in a control volume is equal to the sum of the momenta in any sub-volumes in which we decide to divide the original volume. In this case we can divide our control volume into two parts, in each of which the velocity of matter is uniform: the two sub-volumes consisting of each tennis ball separately. For each sub-volume we have the mass-energy content and the velocity.

Let's denote the two sub-volumes with L and R. We apply Newton's relation to each, and then the principle of extensivity to find the total

momentum P :

$$P_L = m_L v_L = 1.5 \text{ N s} \quad \text{Newton's relation, sub-volume L}$$

$$P_R = m_R v_R = 1.5 \text{ N s} \quad \text{Newton's relation, sub-volume R}$$

$$P = P_L + P_R = 3.0 \text{ N s} \quad \text{extensivity principle}$$

2. In order to find the total momentum at a later time t_1 we can apply the integral expression of the balance of momentum:

$$P(t_1) = P(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G(t) dt ,$$

where F is the total surface force (momentum flux) on the boundary of the control volume, and G the total volume force (momentum supply).

The text says that the two tennis balls are in vacuum, so there seems to be nothing which can give a momentum flux F to the two balls as a whole. The text also says that there is no gravity, so the momentum supply G is zero as well. Therefore we find

$$P(t_1) = P(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} (0 \text{ N}) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} (0 \text{ N}) dt = 3.0 \text{ N s} .$$

3. No, using only the balance of momentum we cannot find the magnitude of each individual tennis ball. The balance only gives us the *total* momentum.

Newton's relation and the principle of extensivity are of no help either: applying them we know that

$$m_L v_L(t_1) + m_R v_R(t_1) = P(t_1) = 3.0 \text{ N s} ,$$

but this is one equation with two unknowns – or more! In fact, the tennis balls could have exchanged some mass, so we could now even have different masses $m_L(t_1)$ and $m_R(t_1)$.

What about finding the individual momenta of the tennis balls, by considering them as two control volumes, applying the balance of momentum to each? It's a good thought; but in order to find the final

momenta we'd need to know the surface force between the balls during the collision:

$$\begin{aligned} P_L(t_1) &= P_L(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{R \rightsquigarrow L}(t) dt \\ P_R(t_1) &= P_R(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{L \rightsquigarrow R}(t) dt \\ F_{R \rightsquigarrow L}(t) &= -F_{L \rightsquigarrow R}(t) \end{aligned}$$

but we have no information about the time dependence of these surface forces.

💡 10.10

Exercise p. 85

To solve this problem we must decide how many control volumes to use for analysing the situation. Let's see the solution with two possible choices:

- one control volume: bullet & block considered together as a single (deformable) object;
- two control volumes: one corresponding to the bullet, and one to the block.

Both choices lead to the solution, but the first is much more straightforward.

One control volume: bullet & block as a single object. We consider the bullet and the block together, as a single, deformable and possibly disconnected object; that's our control volume. Before time t_0 this control volume is made of two disconnected pieces; at time t_0 the two pieces get into contact with each other and start to merge; after time t_0 the control volume consists in one piece only.

Since we have one control volume, we only need one instance of the balance of momentum. The problem mentions two distinct time instants, therefore the integral expression of the balance law seems most convenient.

Denote by P the momentum of this control volume, by F the total surface force (momentum influx) on it, and by G the total volume force on it. All these quantities are meant as x -components. The integral expression of the balance of momentum is therefore

$$P(t_1) = P(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G(t) dt .$$

Which constitutive relations can we use? Newton's relation between momentum and velocity seems an appropriate choice. We must consider the momentum at time t_0 and that at time t_1 :

- $P(t_0)$: At the initial time t_0 we cannot use Newton's relation directly, because the matter in the control volume doesn't have a unique velocity at this time: the bullet is moving, but the block is at rest. But we can solve this issue thanks to the principle of extensivity: considering the bullet and the block as two sub-volumes, we can find the total momentum by summing their momenta. And these momenta can be found with Newton's relation because the matter velocity is the same in each sub-volume. So we have

$$\begin{aligned} P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{bul}} v_{\text{bul}} = 2.96 \text{ N s} , \\ P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{blo}} \cdot 0 \text{ m/s} = 0 \text{ N s} , \\ P(t_0) &= P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) = 2.96 \text{ N s} . \end{aligned}$$

- $P(t_1)$: At the final time t_1 all matter – bullet & block – in the control volume is moving with the same velocity v_f , so we can directly apply Newton's constitutive relation for momentum. Note that we must still use extensivity for the mass:

$$P(t_1) = m v_f = (m_{\text{bul}} + m_{\text{blo}}) v_f = (0.208 \text{ kg}) \cdot v_f$$

where m is the sum of the mass m_{bul} of bullet and the mass m_{blo} of the block.

It seems that we don't need any other constitutive relations.

Let's examine the other information provided by the text.

Between times t_0 and t_1 the bullet and block are exerting surface forces on each other. But considered together, there are no external surface forces exerted on their single control volume:

$$F(t) \equiv 0 \text{ N} \quad \text{between } t_0 \text{ and } t_1 \quad \implies \quad \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F(t) dt = 0 \text{ N s} .$$

Similarly, there is no gravitational volume force:

$$G(t) \equiv 0 \text{ N} \quad \text{between } t_0 \text{ and } t_1 \quad \implies \quad \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G(t) dt = 0 \text{ N s} .$$

Putting together physical laws and information:

$$\begin{aligned}
 P(t_1) &= P(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G(t) dt && \text{momentum balance} \\
 P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{bul}} v_{\text{bul}} = 2.96 \text{ N s} && \text{Newton's constit. relation} \\
 P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{blo}} \cdot 0 \text{ m/s} = 0 \text{ N s} , && \text{Newton's constit. relation} \\
 P(t_0) &= P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) && \text{extensivity, initial momentum} \\
 P(t_1) &= (m_{\text{bul}} + m_{\text{blo}}) v_f = (0.208 \text{ kg}) \cdot v_f && \text{final momentum} \\
 \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F(t) dt &= 0 \text{ N s} && \text{info} \\
 \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G(t) dt &= 0 \text{ N s} && \text{info}
 \end{aligned}$$

This is a system of equations which can be solved, say by substitution, for the unknown v_f . We find

$$(0.208 \text{ kg}) \cdot v_f = 2.96 \text{ N s} + 0 \text{ N s} + 0 \text{ N s} \quad \implies \quad v_f \approx 14 \text{ m/s} .$$

Two control volumes In this approach we consider the bullet as one control volume, and the block as another. Note that after time t_0 the control volume of the block has a hole, in which the control volume of the bullet resides.

The analysis is similar to the previous one, but since we have two control volumes we need to consider the balance of momentum for each one. Let's use the suffixes 'bul' and 'blo':

$$\begin{aligned}
 P_{\text{bul}}(t_1) &= P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{bul}}(t) dt , \\
 P_{\text{blo}}(t_1) &= P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{blo}}(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{blo}}(t) dt .
 \end{aligned}$$

We now have four different momentum contents: for two different control volumes and two different times. For each we can use Newton's relation between momentum and velocity:

$$\begin{aligned}
 P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{bul}} v_{\text{bul}} = 2.96 \text{ N s} , \\
 P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) &= m_{\text{blo}} \cdot 0 \text{ m/s} = 0 \text{ N s} , \\
 P_{\text{bul}}(t_1) &= m_{\text{bul}} v_f , \\
 P_{\text{blo}}(t_1) &= m_{\text{blo}} v_f .
 \end{aligned}$$

The text says that there's no gravity, therefore

$$G_{\text{bul}}(t) \equiv 0 \text{ N} \quad \text{between } t_0 \text{ and } t_1 \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt = 0 \text{ N s} ,$$

$$G_{\text{blo}}(t) \equiv 0 \text{ N} \quad \text{between } t_0 \text{ and } t_1 \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt = 0 \text{ N s} .$$

Finally, since we have two control volumes, there's the possibility that there is a flux of momentum (surface force) between them, so we have to consider the principle of symmetry of flux. This is the case indeed: the bullet exerts a strong force on the block, which produces a hole. So there's a flux of momentum from the bullet to the block. This means that an opposite flux of momentum also occurs from the block to the bullet. So we have

$$F_{\text{blo}}(t) = -F_{\text{bul}}(t) \quad \text{between } t_0 \text{ and } t_1 \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt = - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt .$$

We can finally put together all equations above into this system:

$P_{\text{bul}}(t_1) = P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt$	momentum balance bullet
$P_{\text{blo}}(t_1) = P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt$	momentum balance block
$P_{\text{bul}}(t_0) = 2.96 \text{ N s}$	Newton's constit. relation
$P_{\text{blo}}(t_0) = 0 \text{ N s}$	Newton's constit. relation
$P_{\text{bul}}(t_1) = m_{\text{bul}} v_f$	Newton's constit. relation
$P_{\text{blo}}(t_1) = m_{\text{blo}} v_f$	Newton's constit. relation
$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt = - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt$	flux symmetry
$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{bul}}(t) \, dt = 0 \text{ N s}$	info
$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_{\text{blo}}(t) \, dt = 0 \text{ N s}$	info

and the velocity v_f can be found. For example, with several substitutions and rearrangements the first two equations become

$$\int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) dt = m_{\text{bul}} v_f - 2.96 \text{ N s}$$

$$m_{\text{blo}} v_f = - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_{\text{bul}}(t) dt$$

and finally substituting the first in the second we arrive at $v_f \approx 14 \text{ m/s}$, as before.

You notice that this approach was a little more roundabout than the previous one. We had the added difficulty of not knowing the forces $F_{\text{bul}}(t)$ and $F_{\text{blo}}(t)$, whose time dependence must be quite complicated. But the principle of symmetry of flux saved us, effectively eliminating the need to compute them explicitly. The previous approach bypassed this difficulty, because in that approach these were forces *internal* to the control volume, and therefore they did not enter into its balance of momentum.

10.11

Exercise p. 85

The solution of this problem turns out to require the solution of a system of **first-order ordinary differential equations**¹⁵: it isn't enough to solve a system of linear or maybe quadratic equations. For this reason the problem could alternatively be approached with a simulation script.

First let's see why an ordinary system of equations isn't enough; then we discuss the proper solution.

An inconclusive approach

Imagine to intuitively proceed as we did in other problems involving two different time instants.

We consider a control volume consisting of the tennis ball. The balance of momentum applies to this control volume. Since the problem involves two different time instants, the integral expression of the balance seems more convenient. We consider a coordinate system fixed with the ground with only one vertical coordinate z .

We can also use Newton's constitutive relation for momentum; it has to be used for the initial and for the final times. The constitutive relation for the gravitational force (momentum supply) also applies. From the problem we can deduce that there are no surface forces acting on the tennis ball.

Our system of equations is therefore, with $g = 9.8 \text{ N/kg}$:

$P_z(t_1) = P_z(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_z(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_z(t) dt$	momentum balance
$P_z(t_1) = m v_z(t_1)$	Newton's constit. relation for momentum
$P_z(t_0) = m v_z(t_0)$	Newton's constit. relation for momentum
$G_z(t) \equiv -m g$	constit. relation for gravitational force
$v_z(t_0) = -1.0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$z(t_0) = 10 \text{ m}$	info
$z(t_1) = 8.0 \text{ m}$	info
$F_z(t) = 0 \text{ N}$	info
$m = 0.060 \text{ kg}$	info

This is not quite a system of linear equations, because the quantity $G_z(t)$ is really a function of time, related by integration to the quantity $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_z(t) dt$. The same is true of $F_z(t)$. It is easy, however, to perform the integrations, because $G_z(t)$ is constant in time and $F_z(t)$ is constant and zero.

Doing the integrations and substituting we arrive at

$$\begin{aligned}P_z(t_1) &= P_z(t_0) - m g (t_1 - t_0) \\P_z(t_1) &= m v_z(t_1) \\P_z(t_0) &= m v_z(t_0) \\v_z(t_0) &= -1.0 \text{ m/s} \\z(t_0) &= 10 \text{ m} \\z(t_1) &= 8.0 \text{ m} \\m &= 0.060 \text{ kg}\end{aligned}$$

where the unknown of interest to us is $v_z(t_1)$, the ball's velocity at the later time instant.

Substituting into the first equation all remaining ones, and simplifying a common mass term m , we arrive at this equation:

$$v_z(t_1) = v_z(t_0) - g (t_1 - t_0)$$

but we cannot really use it to find $v_z(t_1)$, because the two time instants t_0 and t_1 , or at least their difference, are unknown.

Looking back at the initial system of equations it seems that there's no way to find these times. So either the problem is unsolvable, or we're missing some equation.

In fact there is an equation that relates position and velocity: the kinematic equation

$$z(t_1) = z(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} v_z(t) dt$$

which relates the initial and final positions and times, and the velocity. But to use this equation *we need to know the velocity $v_z(t)$ at all times between t_0 and t_1* . This knowledge is required in order to perform the integration.

Let's therefore abandon this road and think more generally.

Approach via differential equations

The fact that we need to know the velocity at all times between the two instants means that we really need to time-integrate the system. That is, we must try to find the time dependence of $z(t)$, $v_z(t)$, $P_z(t)$, expressed by the system of differential equations

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dP_z(t)}{dt} &= F_z(t) + G_z(t) \\ \frac{dz(t)}{dt} &= v_z(t) \\ P_z(t) &= m v_z(t) \\ F_z(t) &= 0 \text{ N} \\ G_z(t) &= -m g\end{aligned}$$

which may or may not have an analytical solution (in this case you probably already know that it does).

One way to proceed is by substituting Newton's relation into the first equation, and to take the time derivative of the second equation; we also substitute F_z and G_z . We arrive at the two differential equations

$$m \frac{dv_z(t)}{dt} = -m g, \quad \frac{d^2 z(t)}{dt^2} = \frac{dv_z(t)}{dt}.$$

The mass m in the first disappears, and we can substitute the resulting expression for dv_z/dt in the second:

$$\frac{d^2 z(t)}{dt^2} = -g.$$

This differential equation asks: what's the function that, derived twice, gives a constant? We know it must be a function like this:

$$z(t) = A + B t + C t^2$$

where A, B, C are constants. In fact deriving it once we get

$$\frac{dz(t)}{dt} \equiv v_z(t) = B + 2C t ,$$

which is the velocity $v_z(t)$; and deriving once more we arrive at the constant $2C$, which must be equal to $-g$:

$$\frac{d^2z(t)}{dt^2} = 2C = -g \quad \implies \quad C = -\frac{1}{2}g .$$

We have thus solved the system of differential equations! In order to find as many of the constants A, B, C as possible, as well as the final velocity $v_z(t_1)$, we use the information given in the problem, substituting the relevant values of the time t :

$$\begin{aligned} z(t_0) : \quad & A + B t_0 - \frac{1}{2}g t_0^2 = 10 \text{ m} \\ z(t_1) : \quad & A + B t_1 - \frac{1}{2}g t_1^2 = 8.0 \text{ m} \\ v_z(t_0) : \quad & B - g t_0 = -1.0 \text{ m/s} \\ & B - g t_1 = v_z(t_1) \end{aligned}$$

In order to find $v_z(t_1)$ we need to solve the first three equations for B and t_1 , then substitute in the last. The equation you obtain for t_1 is quadratic, and you must choose the root for which $t_1 > t_0$. The final result is

$$v_z(t_1) = -\sqrt{v_z(t_0)^2 - 2g[z(t_1) - z(t_0)]} \approx -6.3 \text{ m/s} .$$

In exercise 11.3 we'll see a way to solve this problem by means of the balance of energy: it will allow us to avoid facing differential equations.

10.12

Exercise p. 85

First let's find the unit normal to the contact surface between floor and crate, since it isn't given by the problem and it's necessary for defining what we mean by 'normal' and 'tangential' components. Given the geometry of the problem, the unit normal is

$$\mathbf{e}_n = [0, 1] .$$

1.

Let's proceed by steps:

Step 1. We reckon all forces that appear in the problem; we assume air to be negligible as usual:

- The force from the person on the left; call it $\mathbf{F}_a = [350, 200]$ N.
- The force from the person on the right; call it $\mathbf{F}_b = [250, 0]$ N.
- The gravitational force, given by the usual constitutive relation:

$$\mathbf{G} = -mg[0, 1] = -[0, 1078] \text{ N} .$$

- The contact force from floor to crate, which we write as the sum $\mathbf{F}_n + \mathbf{F}_s$ of a normal component and a tangential static-friction component.

Step 2. Amontons's law for static friction relates (1) the maximum magnitude that the tangential static-friction force $\mathbf{F}_s$ can have, and (2) the magnitude of the normal force $\mathbf{F}_n$ at the contact surface. The next step in the problem is understanding which of these two forces we're trying to find, and which is given. In the present case it's the maximum tangential static friction $\mathbf{F}_s$ that we're trying to find. So we must find the normal force $\mathbf{F}_n$ in some other way.

The normal force can be found by observing that the crate does not move in the normal direction, which is the z -direction. So its z -momentum is constant in time: $dP_z/dt = 0$ N. By the balance of z -momentum, the sum of the z -components of all surface and volume forces on the crate must therefore be zero:

$$F_{a,z} + F_{b,z} + G_z + F_n = 0 \text{ N} \quad \implies \quad F_n = -F_{a,z} - F_{b,z} - G_z = +878 \text{ N} .$$

We did this calculation easily, noticing that the 'normal' direction is simply the z -direction. Let's do the same calculation in a more strict manner, which would work even if the normal direction were, say, diagonal to the coordinates. The reasoning is that the momentum in the direction of the unit normal does not change; therefore the normal component of the sum of all forces – or equivalently the sum of the normal components of all forces – must be zero. Remember that the normal component of any force $\mathbf{F}$ is given by

$$(\mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n .$$

So in this case we want

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{F}_{a,n} + \mathbf{F}_{b,n} + \mathbf{G}_n + \mathbf{F}_n &= \mathbf{0} \text{ N} \\
 \implies \mathbf{F}_n &= -\mathbf{F}_{a,n} - \mathbf{F}_{b,n} - \mathbf{G}_n \\
 &= -(\mathbf{F}_a \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n - (\mathbf{F}_b \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n - (\mathbf{G} \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n \\
 &= -[0, 200] \text{ N} - [0, 0] \text{ N} - [0, -1078] \text{ N} \\
 &= [0, 878] \text{ N} .
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 (\mathbf{F}_a \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n &= \\
 \left(\begin{bmatrix} 350 \\ 200 \end{bmatrix} \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \right) \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N} &= \\
 200 \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N} &
 \end{aligned}$$

and so on for the others.

Essentially the same result as before, but this calculation would have also worked for an oblique surface and unit normal.

Step 3. Now that we have the normal component of the contact force from floor to crate, we can calculate the maximum value that static friction can have:

$$|\mathbf{F}_{s,\max}| = \mu_s |\mathbf{F}_n| = 0.62 \cdot 878 \text{ N} = 544 \text{ N} .$$

Step 4. Finally let's find the tangential component of the sum of all other forces, and compare its magnitude with the maximum value above.

We already found the sum of all other forces:

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{other}} = \mathbf{F}_a + \mathbf{F}_b + \mathbf{G} = [600, -878] \text{ N} .$$

The tangential component is therefore

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{other,t}} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{other}} - \mathbf{F}_{\text{other,n}} = [600, -878] \text{ N} - [0, -878] \text{ N} = [600, 0] \text{ N}$$

and its magnitude is 600 N, which is larger than 544 N:

$$600 \text{ N} = |\mathbf{F}_{\text{other,t}}| > \mu_s |\mathbf{F}_n| \approx 544 \text{ N} .$$

Which means that the two people do manage to set the crate into motion, if it is at rest.

2.

To determine the crate's horizontal acceleration dv_x/dt we can use the balance of x -momentum, together with Newton's constitutive relation between momentum and velocity $P_x = m v_x$. Since the crate's mass is constant, we have

$$\frac{dP_x}{dt} = \frac{dm v_x}{dt} = m \frac{dv_x}{dt} .$$

The momentum fluxes and supply on the crate's control volume are $\mathbf{F}_a$, $\mathbf{F}_b$, $\mathbf{G}$, together with the force at the contact surface with the floor, which we

decompose into a normal component $\mathbf{F}_n$ and a tangential kinetic-friction component $\mathbf{F}_k$.

Amontons's law for kinetic friction relates $\mathbf{F}_k$ and $\mathbf{F}_n$. The normal component can be found, as in the previous part of this exercise, by consideration of the z -balance of momentum, which leads to

$$\mathbf{F}_n = [0, 878] \text{ N}$$

since all quantities are exactly the same as before. Then Amontons's law gives

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{F}_k &= -\mu_k \frac{\mathbf{v}}{|\mathbf{v}|} |\mathbf{F}_n| \\ &= -0.45 \cdot \frac{[0.05, 0] \text{ m/s}}{0.05 \text{ m/s}} \cdot 878 \text{ N} \\ &= -[395, 0] \text{ N} .\end{aligned}$$

Now we have all forces. Collect all their x -components in the balance of x -momentum; since $\mathbf{G}$ and $\mathbf{F}_n$ are purely vertical, with zero x -component, let's directly omit them. We can then find the x -acceleration:

$$\begin{aligned}m \frac{dv_x}{dt} &= \frac{dP_x}{dt} = F_{a,x} + F_{b,x} + F_{k,x} \\ \Rightarrow 110 \text{ kg} \cdot \frac{dv_x}{dt} &= 350 \text{ N} + 250 \text{ N} - 395 \text{ N} \\ \Rightarrow \frac{dv_x}{dt} &\approx 1.9 \text{ m/s}^2 .\end{aligned}$$

Let's have a final overview of all physical laws and information we needed to solve this problem; note that even if the x -acceleration was found from the balance of x -momentum, we still needed the balance of z -momentum to find the normal force $\mathbf{F}_n$:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dP_z}{dt} &= F_{a,z} + F_{b,z} + F_{k,z} + F_{n,z} + G_z \\ \frac{dP_z}{dt} &= 0 \text{ N} , \quad v_z = 0 \text{ m/s} \\ \mathbf{G} &= -m g [0, 1] \\ \frac{dP_x}{dt} &= F_{a,x} + F_{b,x} + F_{k,x} + F_{n,x} + G_x \\ P_x &= m v_x \\ \mathbf{F}_k &= -\mu_k \frac{\mathbf{v}}{|\mathbf{v}|} |\mathbf{F}_n|\end{aligned}$$

10.13

Exercise p. 86

This physical situation has *two* contact surfaces of interest, which have *different* unit normal vectors. There is some symmetry though: the forces from the gripper's fingers have equal magnitude, as stated in the text, and intuitively opposite directions; and the static-friction factor is the same for both surfaces. Because of this the problem could be solved by imagining to have just one contact surface, and then dividing the magnitudes of the contact forces by two.

But let's try a more rigorous approach treating the two surfaces as distinct and explicitly writing the symmetries mathematically.

The unit normal vectors of surfaces a and b are obviously $[1, 0]$ and $[1, 0]$. Therefore 'normal component', for both, means horizontal x -component, and 'tangential component' means vertical z -component.

1.

Let's first reckon the momentum fluxes and supply involved in the problem:

- Momentum supply from gravity to the block, obeying the usual constitutive relation:

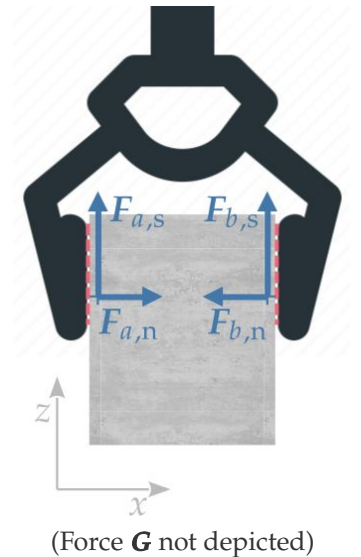
$$\mathbf{G} = -mg[0, 1] = -[0, 58.8] \text{ N}.$$

- Normal component of force exerted by the left finger; denote it $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$. It is purely horizontal.
- Tangential, static-friction component of force exerted by the left finger; denote it $\mathbf{F}_{a,s}$. It is purely vertical.
- Normal component of force exerted by the right finger; denote it $\mathbf{F}_{b,n}$. It is purely horizontal.
- Tangential, static-friction component of force exerted by the right finger; denote it $\mathbf{F}_{b,s}$. It is purely vertical.

Owing to of the symmetry of the problem we know that

$$\mathbf{F}_{a,n} = -\mathbf{F}_{b,n}, \quad \mathbf{F}_{a,s} = \mathbf{F}_{b,s}.$$

Amontons's law let us find the maximal value of $\mathbf{F}_{a,s}$ from $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$ or vice versa; and similarly for surface b . Which of these component do we need to find by other means? In this case the problem asks us to find the maximal



magnitudes of $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{b,n}$, which we can find from Amontons's law provided that we first find $\mathbf{F}_{a,s}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{b,s}$ by other means.

In the present task we know that gripper and block are moving together with a *constant* upward velocity $v_z = 0.10 \text{ m/s}$. By Newton's formula $P_z = m v_z$ this means that the *rate of change* of z-momentum is zero: $dP_z/dt = 0 \text{ N}$. We can use this fact together with the balance of z-momentum and with the condition of symmetry about the contact forces:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \text{ N} &= \frac{dP_z}{dt} = F_{a,s,z} + F_{b,s,z} + G_z, & F_{a,s,z} &= F_{b,s,z} \\ \implies & F_{a,s,z} = F_{b,s,z} = -G_z/2 = +29.4 \text{ N} \end{aligned}$$

In the balance of momentum we directly omitted the normal forces $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$, $\mathbf{F}_{b,n}$ because their z-components are zero. So we have found that

$$\mathbf{F}_{a,s} = \mathbf{F}_{b,s} = [0, 29.4] \text{ N}$$

they're directed upwards as expected.

Now that we have $\mathbf{F}_{a,s}$ we can find the maximal values of $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$ by means of Amontons's law:

$$|\mathbf{F}_{a,s}| < \mu_s |\mathbf{F}_{a,n}| \implies |\mathbf{F}_{a,n}| > \frac{|\mathbf{F}_{a,s}|}{\mu_s} = \frac{29.4 \text{ N}}{0.86} \approx 34 \text{ N}.$$

Obviously the same is true for $\mathbf{F}_{b,n}$ since it has the same magnitude:

$$|\mathbf{F}_{a,n}| > 34 \text{ N}, \quad |\mathbf{F}_{b,n}| > 34 \text{ N}.$$

2.

How is this case different from the previous one? The gripper and block are *accelerating* upwards, and this means that the *rate of change* of z-momentum is *non-zero*. We have instead

$$\frac{dP_z}{dt} = m \frac{dv_z}{dt} = 0.6 \text{ kg} \cdot 5.0 \text{ m/s}^2 = 30 \text{ N},$$

constant in time.

The reasoning and physical laws to find the gripper's normal forces $\mathbf{F}_{a,n}$ and $\mathbf{F}_{b,n}$ is exactly the same as before: first find the tangential, static-friction components from the balance of z-momentum, then find the minimum magnitudes of the normal components from Amontons's law. But in this

case, when we use the balance of z-momentum, we must keep account for the non-zero dP_z/dt .

So we have

$$\frac{dP_z}{dt} = F_{a,s,z} + F_{b,s,z} + G_z, \quad F_{a,s,z} = F_{b,s,z}$$

$$\Rightarrow F_{a,s,z} = F_{b,s,z} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{dP_z}{dt} - G_z \right) = \frac{1}{2} (30 + 58.8) \text{ N} = 44.4 \text{ N}.$$

From Amontons's law we therefore have, in the present case,

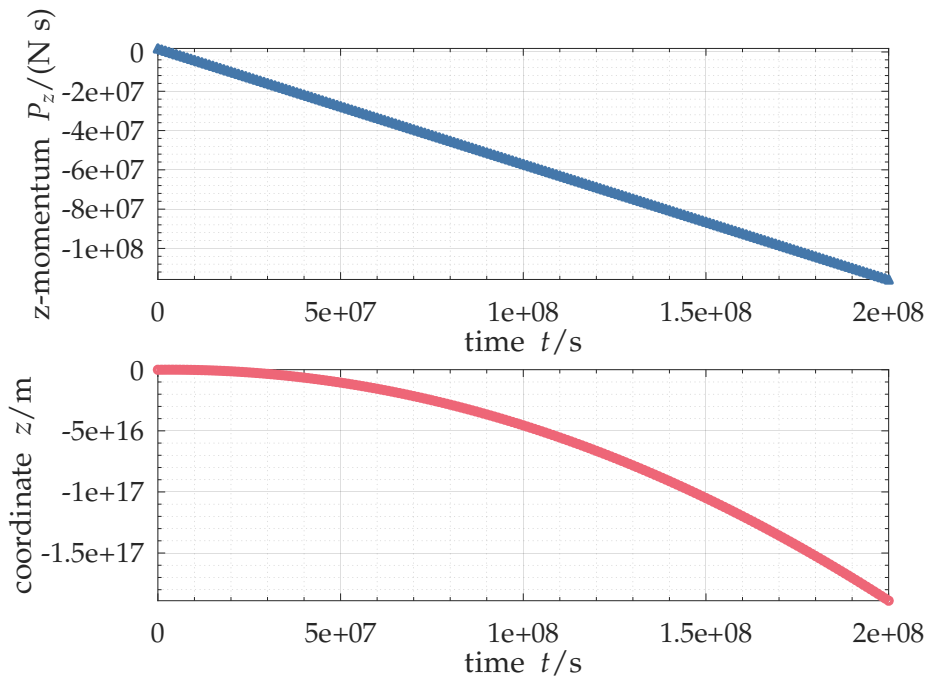
$$|\mathbf{F}_{a,n}| > \frac{|\mathbf{F}_{a,s}|}{\mu_s} = \frac{44.4 \text{ N}}{0.86} \approx 52 \text{ N}.$$

And analogously for side b .

10.14

Exercise p. 86

1. Here are the plots from the modified script with long simulation time:



The vertical momentum $P_z(t)$ decreases *linearly* with time: its graph is a line. The vertical position $z(t)$ instead decreases *quadratically* or parabolically with time: its graph is a parabola. This is indeed the behaviour we expect in a constant gravitational field (see chapter 10 of our lecture notes).

2. The improved constitutive relations is implemented by replacing the line

$v = P / m;$ (Octave)

$v = P / m$ (Python)

with

$v = P / \sqrt{m^2 + \text{norm}(P)^2 / c^2};$ (Octave)

$v = P / \sqrt{m^{**2} + \text{norm}(P)^{**2} / c^{**2}}$ (Python)

and adding

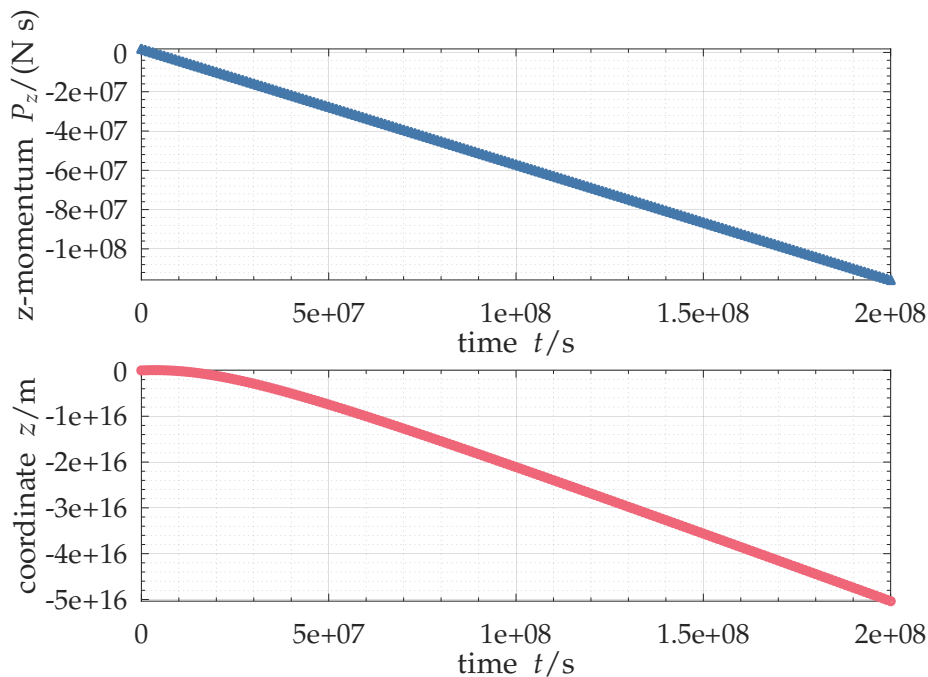
$c = 299792458;$ (Octave)

$c = 299792458$ (Python)

in the Constants block. Example script:

Octave [tennisball_rP_relativity.m](#)¹⁶,
 Python [tennisball_rP_relativity.py](#)¹⁷.

The plots from this modified script are these:



The vertical momentum $P_z(t)$ decreases *linearly* with time, as in the previous case. This happens because at every time step the momentum is increased by the amount $\mathbf{G}$, which is constant, just like before.

The vertical position $z(t)$ has a curved graph at first, but then it flattens out and becomes a line, so its dependence becomes *linear*. This is

different from the previous case. Because of this, the (negative) final vertical position is also less than in the previous case.

If the dependence of $z(t)$ on time is linear, that is, of the form $z(t) = At + B$, then its velocity is $dz(t)/dt = A$, a constant. This must be the speed of light: at some point the tennis ball approaches the speed of light, and it must stay at that value. In fact, the slope of $z(t)$ can be estimated from the graph above, and it is indeed around 300 000 000 m/s.

💡 10.15

Exercise p. 87

1. There is not upper limit to the number of control volumes we could use; but in the present case we need at least two, coinciding with the two tennis balls, because we want to track their motions.
2. A balance law always refer to a control volume. So in this case we need one balance of momentum for each volume. And one equation for updating the position for each control volume.
3. See for instance these scripts: Octave `tennisball_rP_2obj.m`¹⁸, Python `tennisball_rP_2obj.py`¹⁹.

💡 10.16

Exercise p. 88

1. The physical dimensions appearing in the equation can be written as follows:

$$\text{force} = \frac{k}{\text{length}^2} \cdot \text{length}$$

therefore k has dimension $\text{force} \cdot \text{length}$. Keep in mind that ‘force’ is the same as ‘momentum flux’.

2. When $\mathbf{F}_a$ is non-zero, the vector on the right side of the equation is $\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b$, so $\mathbf{F}_a$ must have its same direction. The orientation is also the same unless the multiplying coefficient is negative. But k and a norm $|\dots|$ are positive. So the influx $\mathbf{F}_a$ has the same direction and orientation as $\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b$. In other words, it points from b to a .
3. The magnitude of $\mathbf{F}_a$ is zero when $|\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b| > d$, otherwise it is $\frac{k}{|\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b|^2} |\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b| = \frac{k}{|\mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b|}$. This is a function that increases as the distance decreases. In fact it is infinite when the distance is zero. So the force that pushes a away from b (and vice versa) becomes stronger and stronger as the two objects are pressed against each other.

4. When the two tennis balls are in contact, their control volumes share a common part of their control surfaces. This is where the flux of momentum occur. We therefore have the principle of symmetry of flux: the **influx** of momentum into a is the opposite of the **influx** of momentum into b :

$$\mathbf{F}_b = -\mathbf{F}_a .$$

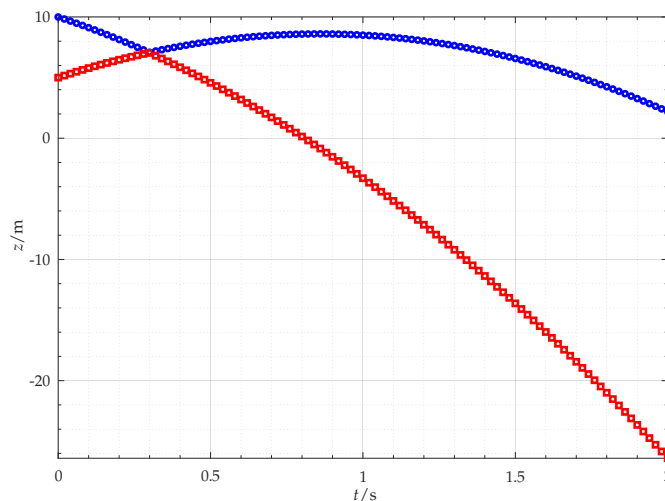
5. No, we don't know these fluxes beforehand, and we can calculate them at every time step from the positions $\mathbf{r}_a, \mathbf{r}_b$.

💡 10.17

Exercise p. 88

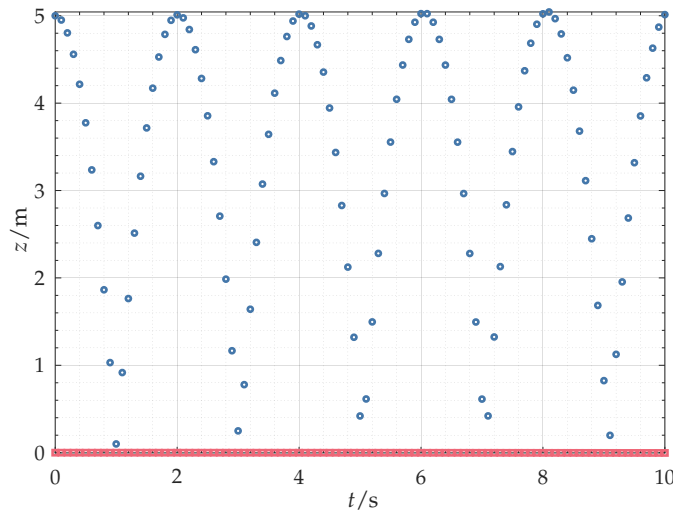
1. The constitutive relations allow us to calculate quantities, at the same time instant, necessary for using the balance laws to step forward in time. So the equation for $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ must be used before the time is updated.
2. See for instance this script: Octave `tennisball_rP_2obj_collision.m`²⁰, Python `tennisball_rP_2obj_collision.py`²¹.

Here is the plot we obtain from it:



3. See for instance this script: Octave `tennisball_rP_2obj_floor.m`²², Python `tennisball_rP_2obj_floor.py`²³.

Here is the plot we obtain from it:



💡 10.19

Exercise p. 90

✂ Coming soon

💡 10.20

Exercise p. 91

✂ Coming soon

💡 10.21

Exercise p. 91

✂ Coming soon

💡 10.22

Exercise p. 92

Let's analyse the problem, and then compare our analysis with the LLM's output.

The solid object is our control volume. Given that the question involves accelerations and probably forces, then the balance of momentum for the x - and z -components seems relevant. The question explicitly mentions one specific time instant t , therefore the differential expression is most convenient:

$$\frac{dP_x}{dt} = F_x + G_x, \quad \frac{dP_z}{dt} = F_z + G_z.$$

We need to connect momentum and its rate of change to velocity and acceleration. Newton's relation momentum and velocity can be used for

this, since we have a solid object made of matter. We can also take the derivative of this relation, to obtain an acceleration:

$$P_x = m v_x \implies \frac{dP_x}{dt} = m \frac{dv_x}{dt}, \quad P_z = m v_z \implies \frac{dP_z}{dt} = m \frac{dv_z}{dt}.$$

We also have the usual expression for the momentum supply:

$$G_x = 0 \text{ N}, \quad G_z = -mg = -9.8 \text{ N}.$$

The only additional information given in the question is that there is no friction between plane and object. Friction is the tangential component $\mathbf{F}_t$ of the surface force (momentum flux) $\mathbf{F} = [F_x, F_z]$ from the plane to the object. The question therefore says that this tangential component must be zero: $\mathbf{F}_t = \mathbf{0} \text{ N}$. Let's write this condition in terms of the x - and z -components of $\mathbf{F}$. To do so we need the unit normal vector $\mathbf{e}_n$ to the plane, directed towards the solid object. We can find vector considering that its components must be positive, because it points to the positive- x and $-z$ directions, they must be equal since it's inclined by $\pi/4$ rad, and their squares must sum up to 1:

$$\mathbf{e}_n = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The normal component of the force from the plane $\mathbf{F}$ is therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{F}_n &= (\mathbf{F}_n \cdot \mathbf{e}_n) \mathbf{e}_n \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (F_x \cdot 1 + F_z \cdot 1) \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} (F_x + F_z) \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned}$$

This results says that the x - and z -components of the normal component $\mathbf{F}_n$ are equal. This make sense because $\mathbf{F}_n$ must be inclined by $\pi/4$ rad. Note that we haven't said anything about the full force $\mathbf{F}$ yet.

The tangential component of $\mathbf{F}$ is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{F}_t &= \mathbf{F} - \mathbf{F}_n \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} F_x \\ F_z \end{bmatrix} - \frac{1}{2} (F_x + F_z) \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} (F_x - F_z) \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}, \end{aligned}$$

and this component must be zero; this means that

$$F_x - F_z = 0 \text{ N} \quad \implies \quad F_x = F_z .$$

This result also makes sense: it simply says that the components of the force $\mathbf{F}$ from the plane to the object must be equal; and this is indeed the condition that $\mathbf{F}$ be normal to the plane, without any tangential component.

Summarizing all physical information we have about the time instant t :

$\frac{dP_x}{dt} = F_x + G_x$	balance x -momentum
$\frac{dP_z}{dt} = F_z + G_z$	balance z -momentum
$\frac{dP_x}{dt} = m \frac{dv_x}{dt}$	from Newton's relation
$\frac{dP_z}{dt} = m \frac{dv_z}{dt}$	from Newton's relation
$G_x = 0 \text{ N}$	gravit. force
$G_z = -9.8 \text{ N}$	gravit. force
$F_x = F_z$	no friction

The equations above can be combined into these final three, writing explicitly the object's mass $m = 1 \text{ kg}$:

$$\begin{aligned} 1 \text{ kg} \cdot \frac{dv_x}{dt} &= F_x \\ 1 \text{ kg} \cdot \frac{dv_z}{dt} &= F_z - 9.8 \text{ N} \\ F_x &= F_z \end{aligned}$$

We have *three* equations in *four* unknowns: the two components of the acceleration $dv_x/dt, dv_z/dt$ and the two components of the force from the plane F_x, F_z . The problem is indeterminate.

Let's go back to the question in the prompt: 'is it possible to calculate the acceleration of the object at this time instant?' The answer is apparently *No*. The information given in the problem is not enough. To find numerical values we'd need to be given one component of the acceleration, or one component of the force.

For example it could be that at this time t the z -component of the force is zero. From the equations above this would mean that the z -component is also zero, the x -acceleration is zero, and the z -acceleration is -9.8 m/s^2 . This could indeed be the case if the object was falling onto the plane, and t

is the instant where the object has just begun to touch the surface, so that the force from the surface is still zero or extremely small. Or it could be the case if the object is bouncing off the plane, and t is the last instant of contact, when the force from the plane is going back to zero.

It could also be that the x - and z -components of the force are extremely large, say 100 N. In this case the x - and z -accelerations would also be positive and large, approximately $+100 \text{ m/s}^2$ and $+90 \text{ m/s}^2$. This could be the case if the object is in the middle of bouncing on the surface, when the surface exerts extremely high reaction forces (indeed objects compress to a small or high degree when bouncing).

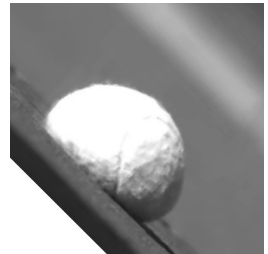
Let's now analyse some statements in the LLM's output. Again, we must not think of these statements as coming from some kind of reasoning: *they don't*. They're only produced by long-range correlations among words matched from some corpus of text.

One statement in particular is *false* in the present context:

Because the object is constrained to remain in contact with the plane. . .

nowhere in the prompt it was stated that the object is constrained to remain in contact with the plane. The prompt only stated that the object "is in contact with an inclined plane at this time instant". So the "because. . ." in the LLM's output sounds even funny. Subsequent statements in the output are likewise false, for instance "The normal component of the acceleration is zero".

The rest of the output is more or less self-consistent and consistent with the *false* statement above; it is therefore all false. The large language model probably extracted highly correlated text from a corpus of physics exercises similar to the present one. Many of those texts likely made the additional assumption of "constrained to remain in contact", and therefore this also entered the LLM's output by correlation.



Snapshot of a tennis ball bouncing on a surface

URLs for chapter 10

1. https://myanimelist.net/anime/30276/One_Punch_Man/
2. <https://onepunchman.fandom.com/wiki/Saitama>
3. <https://onepunchman.fandom.com/wiki/Boros>
4. <https://webbook.nist.gov/chemistry/fluid>
5. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.m
6. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.py
7. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.m
8. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.py
9. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/hooke_spring.m
10. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/hooke_spring.py
11. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.m
12. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP.py
13. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/hooke_spring.m
14. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/hooke_spring.py
15. [https://mathworld.wolfram.com/First-OrderOrdinaryDifferentialEquation.h
tml](https://mathworld.wolfram.com/First-OrderOrdinaryDifferentialEquation.html)
16. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_relativity.m
17. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_relativity.py
18. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj.m
19. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj.py
20. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj_collision.m
21. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj_collision.py
22. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj_floor.m
23. https://pglpm.github.io/7wonders/scripts/tennisball_rP_2obj_floor.py

Balance of energy

11.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

11.1

Solution p. 132

A skydiver of mass 70 kg jumps with zero initial velocity at an altitude of 3000 m. At 1000 m the skydiver has a fully vertical velocity of 55 m/s (around 200 km/h), ready to deploy the parachute. Assume that the internal energy of the skydiver is the same at 1000 m as at 3000 m.



1. How much is the time-integrated energy influx to the skydiver from the surrounding air?
2. Can you tell how much are the time-integrated heat flux and the mechanical work, separately, given the information in this problem?

11.2

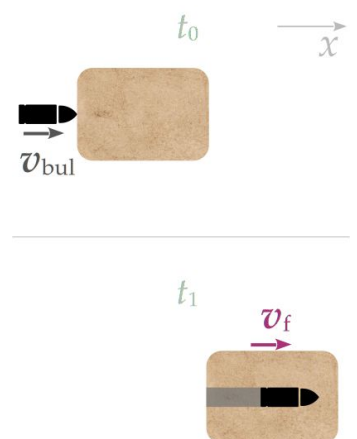
Solution p. 134

Consider again exercise 10.10:

At a time instant t_0 a bullet is in contact with a wooden block, as illustrated in the top margin figure. The bullet has mass 0.0080 kg and horizontal velocity $v_{\text{bul}} = 370$ m/s to the right. The wooden block has mass 0.2 kg and is at rest.

At a later time instant t_1 the bullet has entered the wooden block and got stuck in it, as illustrated in the bottom margin figure. Now bullet and block are moving together with the same common horizontal velocity v_f .

There are no surface forces (flux of momentum) exerted on bullet & block, and gravity can be neglected. Use just one coordinate x .



1. Do you have enough information for finding the common final velocity v_f of bullet & block by means of the balance of energy? If so, find it.

2. If you don't have enough information for using the balance of energy, then try to use the result $v_f = \pm 14 \text{ m/s}$ from solution 10.22 to make hypotheses about the missing information about energy.

11.3

Solution p. 136

Consider again exercise 10.11:

At some time instant a tennis ball is at a height of 10 m above ground, with a downward velocity of 1.0 m/s. At a later instant of time the ball is at a height of 8.0 m above ground. The tennis ball's mass is 0.060 kg, its motion is purely vertical, there are no obstacles in its course, and air can be neglected.

The original exercise asks how much is the velocity of the ball at the later instant of time, when it is 8.0 m above ground. Can you find this velocity using only the balance of energy? if so, find it.

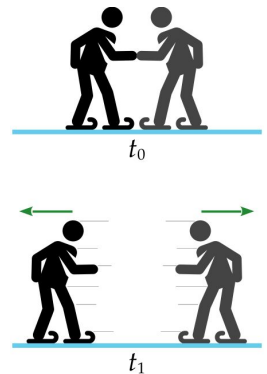
11.4

Solution p. 138

Two ice skaters are holding each other, completely still, at some time t_0 . Then they push each other and at a later time t_1 they're moving in opposite directions with purely horizontal velocities. Together they have burned 76 J of internal energy in total.

Assume there's no friction or heat flux between ice and the skaters, air is negligible, and the gravitational potential energy of each skater is constant. The skater on the left has mass-energy 70 kg, the one on the right 60 kg.

What are the velocities of the skaters at time t_1 ?



11.5

Solution p. 142

Give one or more examples of a phenomenon (identified by a control volume) that satisfies the following five conditions:

- At an initial time t_0 and at a final time t_1 , the momentum is zero.
- Gravity and other momentum supplies are absent or negligible.
- No external fluxes of momentum or of energy occur between times t_0 and t_1 .
- The internal energy at final time t_1 is lower than at the initial time t_0 .

- (e) The kinetic energy is zero at initial time t_0 is zero, and it is non-zero (and obviously positive) at final time t_1 .

11.6

Solution p. 143

A container is filled with an ideal gas. The ideal gas fills the whole container, leaving no empty space. The walls of the container are at rest.

Is it possible for the ideal gas to have a non-zero kinetic energy?

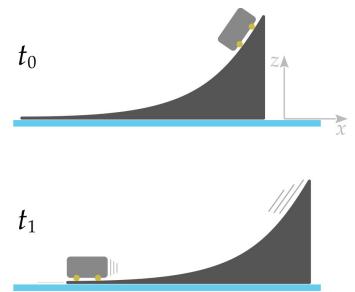
11.7

Solution p. 143

A rigid ramp of mass 20 kg and height 1 m is at rest on a static layer of ice. At the top of the ramp there's a small cart of mass 1 kg, equipped with small wheels and also at rest. The cart is released, and at a later time t_1 it is at the bottom of the ramp, moving in a horizontal direction.

There is no friction between the ramp and the layer of ice. Assume that there are no heat fluxes, air is negligible, and the internal energies of ramp and cart are constant. Consider the cart as a small object identified simply by its position $\mathbf{r}$.

What are the horizontal velocities (complete with correct sign) of cart and of ramp at time t_1 ?



Example solutions

**11.1**

Exercise p. 129

1. We can consider the skydiver as a control volume, and use the integral expression of the balance of energy: the integral expression seems more convenient because the problem involves two different times. Call t_0 when the skydiver jumps, and t_1 when the skydiver reaches 1000 m altitude:

$$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{A}(t) dt ,$$

where z is the upward vertical coordinate, and we use a one-dimensional coordinate system at rest with the ground.

We can also use the constitutive relations for the energy content and energy supply of matter:

$$E = U + \frac{1}{2} m \boldsymbol{v}^2 + m g z , \quad \mathcal{A} = 0 \text{ J/s} .$$

All conditions under which these relations are valid seem to be satisfied in this problem. These constitutive relations must each be used at the initial and at the final time.

Do we need the constitutive relation for the energy flux in matter (that is $\Phi = \dot{Q} + \boldsymbol{F} \cdot \boldsymbol{v}$)? The problem asks for the *energy influx*, and not for the heat influx or the mechanical power separately; so maybe we manage to do without this constitutive relation. Let's see.

Collecting the equations above and the information given in the problem, we obtain this system of equations, where $g = 9.8 \text{ J}/(\text{kg m})$:

$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{A}(t) dt$	energy balance
$E(t_0) = U(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_0)^2 + m g z(t_0)$	energy content for matter, initial time
$E(t_1) = U(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_1)^2 + m g z(t_1)$	energy content for matter, final time
$\mathcal{A} = 0 \text{ J/s}$	no energy supply in inertial system
$m = 70 \text{ kg}$	info
$z(t_0) = 3000 \text{ m}$	info
$v_z(t_0) = 0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$z(t_1) = 1000 \text{ m}$	info
$v_z(t_1) = -55 \text{ m/s}$	info
$U(t_0) = U(t_1)$	info

The system has ten equations in eleven unknowns:

$$E(t_1), E(t_0), \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt, \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{A}(t) dt, U(t_0), U(t_1), v_z(t_0), v_z(t_1), z(t_0), z(t_1), m$$

but maybe we still manage to find the unknown of interest, which is the time-integrated influx of energy: $\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$.

Indeed replacing into the first equation all the remaining ones, and then rearranging and simplifying, we find

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt &= \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_1)^2 + m g z(t_1) - \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_0)^2 - m g z(t_0) \\ &= 105\,875 \text{ J} + 686\,000 \text{ J} - 0 \text{ J} - 2\,058\,000 \text{ J} \approx -1\,300\,000 \text{ J} . \end{aligned}$$

This is a negative influx, which means that a net amount of positive energy flows from the skydiver to the surrounding air. This is the effect of friction, which does *negative* work on the skydiver, and heats both skydiver and air.

In the system of equations above, ten equations in eleven unknowns, there must be some quantities that depend on a free variable. Which ones are they? They are $E(t_1)$, $E(t_0)$, $U(t_0)$, $U(t_1)$. We don't know their values; but once one of them is specified, we can find the remaining three.

2. No, we cannot find the time-integrated heat flux and the mechanical work separately. In order to find them we would need to know either the constitutive relation for the surface force (momentum flux) between the skydiver and the air, or the heat flux.

11.2

Exercise p. 129

1.

Let's see if this problem, previously solved in 10.22 using the balance of momentum, can be solved using the balance of energy. In the previous solution we explored two approaches: first considering bullet & block as one control volume (a single object), and then as two control volumes. Let's explore only the first here.

We consider the bullet and the block together, as a single, deformable and possibly disconnected object; that's our control volume.

With one control volume, we need only one instance of the balance of energy. Its integral expressions seems most convenient. We omit the zero supply since the problem seems to be using inertial coordinates.

Regarding constitutive relations, we can use those for the content and flux of energy of matter because bullet & block are a bunch of matter. These constitutive relations must be used at the initial and at the final times. Also, since the bullet and block have initially different velocity and may have initially different internal energies, we need to use the principle of extensivity to find the initial total energy.

The text says that gravity can be neglected, so the gravitational potential energy is always zero. Note that if the problem had been two-dimensional and with gravity, then we could *not* have used the formula mgz for the potential energy of the block and for that of block and bullet together, because these are vertically extended objects without a single z coordinate.

The text gives information about velocities and masses, which can be useful for the kinetic energy. The text also says that there are no surface forces, besides those between bullet and block. This means that there is no flux of mechanical power to the bullet & block as a whole. Note that if there had been external surface forces, we could *not* have used the formula $\mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{v}$ for mechanical power directly, because bullet and block have different velocities, and the material within the block might have a yet different velocity during the perforation by the bullet.

The text does not give information about heat fluxes and internal energies.

Putting all physical laws and text information together we arrive at this system of equations: Together with the information given in the text, we then have the following set of equations, where $g = 9.8 \text{ J}/(\text{kg m})$:

$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$	energy balance
$E_{\text{bul}}(t_0) = U_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m_{\text{bul}} v_{\text{bul}}^2$	energy content for bullet, initial time
$E_{\text{blo}}(t_0) = U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m_{\text{blo}} v_{\text{blo}}^2$	energy content for block, initial time
$E(t_0) = E_{\text{bul}}(t_0) + E_{\text{blo}}(t_0)$	extensivity, initial energy
$E(t_1) = U(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} (m_{\text{bul}} + m_{\text{blo}}) v_f^2$	energy content for matter, final time
$\Phi(t) = \dot{Q}(t) + \underbrace{\text{mechanical power}}_{0 \text{ J/s}}$	energy flux for matter
$v_{\text{bul}} = 370 \text{ m/s}$	info
$v_{\text{blo}} = 0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$m_{\text{bul}} = 0.0080 \text{ kg}$	info
$m_{\text{blo}} = 0.2 \text{ kg}$	info

Substituting all equations into the balance of energy and rearranging, we arrive at the following expression for the final velocity of bullet & block:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} (m_{\text{bul}} + m_{\text{blo}}) v_f^2 &= U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + U_{\text{bul}}(t_0) - U(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} m_{\text{bul}} v_{\text{bul}}^2 + \frac{1}{2} m_{\text{blo}} v_{\text{blo}}^2 + \Delta Q \\ \Rightarrow (0.104 \text{ kg}) \cdot v_f^2 &= U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + U_{\text{bul}}(t_0) - U(t_1) + \Delta Q + 547.6 \text{ J} \end{aligned}$$

where the time-integrated heat flux is denoted by ΔQ .

Clearly we don't have enough information to solve the problem using the balance of energy. Additional information would be needed.

Now suppose that we had assumed, maybe from a wrong intuition, that the total internal energy does not change, so that $U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + U_{\text{bul}}(t_0) - U(t_1) = 0 \text{ J}$, and also that the heat flux is zero: $\Delta Q = 0 \text{ J}$. Then we would have arrived at the result $v_f = \pm 73 \text{ m/s}$. But the result obtained from the balance of momentum in the solution [10.22](#) was $v_f = \pm 14 \text{ m/s}$, and it was obtained without making any intuitive assumptions, so it's the correct result. This means that there actually is an increase in internal energy, or that some heat has been released.

2.

According to the solution obtained with the balance of momentum, the final kinetic energy of bullet & block is

$$\frac{1}{2} (m_{\text{bul}} + m_{\text{blo}}) v_f^2 \approx 20.384 \text{ J} .$$

Substituting this in the final equation obtained in our previous analysis we find

$$U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + U_{\text{bul}}(t_0) - U(t_1) + \Delta Q = 20.384 \text{ J} - 547.6 \text{ J} \approx -530 \text{ J} .$$

So possible hypotheses are:

- There was no heat flux, and the total internal energy increased by 530 J:

$$U(t_1) = [U_{\text{blo}}(t_0) + U_{\text{bul}}(t_0)] + 530 \text{ J} .$$

This scenario seems plausible; we expect the temperatures of both bullet and block to increased during the perforation.

- There was no change in internal energy, and an amount 530 J of heat was *released* (negative heat influx because of the minus sign):

$$\Delta Q = -530 \text{ J} .$$

This scenario also has some plausibility. If there is air, heat could have been released to it.

- There could also have been a partial increase in internal energy, and partial release of heat, for a total of 530 J.

💡 11.3

Exercise p. 130

In the previous solution 10.22 of this exercise we used the balance of momentum together with the kinetic relationship between position and velocity, effectively solving a differential equation. Let's see if the balance of energy can lead us to the solution, and if it can do so more easily.

We consider the tennis ball as our control volume. It makes sense to use the integral expression of the balance of energy, because we have two distinct times. In the balance let's directly omit the energy supply $\mathcal{A}$, which is zero in an inertial coordinate system. A tennisball is a bunch of matter, so we can use the constitutive relations for the content and energy of matter; we need to use them at time t_0 as well as at time t_1 .

What kind of information about energy does the text give us? Besides velocities and heights, which can be used for kinetic energy and gravitational potential energy, the text says that there are no obstacles and air can be neglected. Therefore the total surface force $\mathbf{F}$ is zero, and also the mechanical power $\mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{v}$ is zero. Since the tennis ball is falling in a vacuum, let's assume that there's no heat flux $\dot{Q}$ to or from the ball either; this assumption is not completely guaranteed, because the ball could emit electromagnetic radiation into a vacuum; but it seems reasonable.

Together with the information given in the text, we then have the following set of equations, where $g = 9.8 \text{ J}/(\text{kg m})$:

$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$	energy balance
$E(t_0) = U(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_0)^2 + m g z(t_0)$	energy content for matter, initial time
$E(t_1) = U(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_1)^2 + m g z(t_1)$	energy content for matter, final time
$\Phi(t) = \dot{Q}(t) + F_z(t) \cdot v_z(t)$	energy flux for matter
$F_z(t) = 0 \text{ N}$	info on momentum flux
$\dot{Q}(t) = 0 \text{ J/s}$	info on heat flux
$v_z(t_0) = -1.0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$z(t_0) = 10 \text{ m}$	info
$z(t_1) = 8.0 \text{ m}$	info
$m = 0.060 \text{ kg}$	info

This system can be solved by substitution: combining the equations for the energy flux, heat flux, momentum flux into the balance of energy we arrive at

$$\begin{aligned} E(t_1) &= E(t_0) \\ E(t_0) &= U(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_0)^2 + m g z(t_0) \\ E(t_1) &= U(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_1)^2 + m g z(t_1) \\ v_z(t_0) &= -1.0 \text{ m/s} \\ z(t_0) &= 10 \text{ m} \\ z(t_1) &= 8.0 \text{ m} \\ m &= 0.060 \text{ kg} \end{aligned}$$

Substituting again and rearranging the terms we finally get

$$\frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_1)^2 = U(t_0) - U(t_1) + m g z(t_0) - m g z(t_1) + \frac{1}{2} m v_z(t_0)^2$$
$$\implies (0.030 \text{ kg}) \cdot v_z(t_1)^2 = U(t_0) - U(t_1) + 1.176 \text{ J} + 0.03 \text{ J}$$

This could be solved for the final velocity $v_z(t_1)$ if we knew the difference between the initial and final internal energies of the tennis ball. *Intuitively* we expect this difference to be zero, so that

$$v_z(t_1) \approx \pm 6.3 \text{ m/s} \quad (\text{if the internal energy is the same at the two times}).$$

We see that the balance of energy led us to *part* of the solution without the need to solve differential equations. But pay attention to these uncertain elements of this solution:

- The balance of energy does not tell us the *sign* of the final velocity: it could be downward or upward. The latter case would indeed be possible if the ball had bounced on the floor between the initial and final time. *Intuitively* we choose the negative sign (downward velocity) – and we do that because in our mind we’re actually applying the *balance of momentum*, imagining the motion between the two times.
- Strictly speaking the text does not tell us anything about the internal energy of the ball. Some process could take place – think of the ball exploding – that decreases the internal energy and leads to a higher kinetic energy and velocity. From the text this doesn’t seem to be the case, but in a real-life physics inference we might be less certain.



11.4

Exercise p. 130

Let’s decide first how many control volumes to consider.

If we consider the skaters as two separate control volumes, then we need to use one balance of momentum for each and one balance of energy for each. Between the initial and final times there is obviously a flux of momentum, and possibly also of heat and of mechanical power, between the skaters. Therefore when we write the balances for each skater we need to explicitly take such fluxes of momentum and of energy into account. The text, however, does not give any information about these fluxes.

Therefore let’s first try to solve the problem considering the skaters as a *single control volume*, with one balance of momentum and one balance of energy. In this approach, the fluxes of momentum and energy between the skaters are *internal* to the control volume, and therefore they don’t appear in the balances of momentum and energy.

The next question is which balances we need to consider in order to solve the problem. Remember, however, that *all* balances apply and need to be satisfied for our control volume; in principle we could write all of them. Our question is not “which balances apply?” (answer: all of them!). Our question is “can we restrict our attention to one or few balances only, in order to find the information required in this specific problem?”.

A heuristic reasoning is this: the problem asks for *two* numerical quantities: the horizontal velocity of each skater. We may therefore expect that *two* balances might be enough. This is not guaranteed, maybe more are necessary; but it’s a starting point. Intuitive options to consider are:

- balances of x - and z -momentum;
- balances of x -momentum and energy;
- balances of z -momentum and energy.

Fix a spatially two-dimensional coordinate system (t, x, z) , with z vertical. The text seems to focus on horizontal motion only; there is no vertical motion. Therefore the balance of z -momentum might be unnecessary to solve our problem. Let’s therefore try to use the balance of x -momentum and that of energy.

Next let’s focus on the constitutive relations needed to solve the problem. They are the usual ones because we’re dealing with matter, there are no matter fluxes through the volume boundaries, and there are no electromagnetic fields:

- Newton’s relation for momentum $\mathbf{P} = m\mathbf{v}$, to be written for initial and final times. This relation may need to be used together with the principle of *extensivity*, because the skaters may not have the same velocity; that is, the velocity of matter is not the same throughout the control volume.
- Energy for matter $E = U + E_k + E_p$, to be written for initial and final times.
- Kinetic energy of matter $E_k = \frac{1}{2}m\mathbf{v}^2$, to be applied to each skater separately. Since the skaters may have different velocities, this relation may need to be used with the principle of extensivity of energy: we add up the kinetic energies of the two skaters.
- Energy flux for matter $\Phi = \dot{Q} + \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{v}$, which should be applied at all times between t_0 and t_1 .

The information given by the text can be summarized as follows:

- “together they have burned 76 J of internal energy in total”: this refers to the *difference* between the initial and final total energy: the final one is lower than the initial one by 76 J. The total internal energy is, by extensivity, the sum of those of each skater.
- No ice friction and negligible air means the total horizontal force F_x on the two skaters – viewed as one control volume – is zero.

Since the velocity of the skaters is purely horizontal, perpendicular to the normal force $\mathbf{F}_n$ on each skater, no friction also means that the total mechanical power $\mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{v} \equiv \mathbf{F}_n \cdot \mathbf{v}$ on the each skaters is zero at all times.

- No heat flux with the ice and negligible air means that the total heat flux $\dot{Q}$ is also zero at all times.
- Skaters have zero initial velocities.
- Potential energy of each skater, and therefore of the whole, is constant.
- Skaters’ masses.

The full set of equations describing this physical situation can be written as follows, denoting one skater a and the other b , and with $g = 9.8 \text{ m/s}^2$,

$m_a = 70 \text{ kg}$, $m_b = 60 \text{ kg}$:

$P_x(t_1) = P_x(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_x(t) dt$	x -momentum balance
$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$	energy balance
$P_{x,a}(t_0) = m_a v_{x,a}(t_0)$	x -momentum a , initial time
$P_{x,b}(t_0) = m_b v_{x,b}(t_0)$	x -momentum b , initial time
$P_x(t_0) = P_{x,a}(t_0) + P_{x,b}(t_0)$	extensivity for momentum, initial time
$E(t_0) = U(t_0) + E_k(t_0) + E_p(t_0)$	energy content for matter, initial time
$E_{k,a}(t_0) = \frac{1}{2} m_a \mathbf{v}_a(t_0)^2$	kinetic energy a , initial time
$E_{k,b}(t_0) = \frac{1}{2} m_b \mathbf{v}_b(t_0)^2$	kinetic energy b , initial time
$E_k(t_0) = E_{k,a}(t_0) + E_{k,b}(t_0)$	extensivity for kinetic energy, initial time
$P_{x,a}(t_1) = m_a v_{x,a}(t_1)$	x -momentum a , final time
$P_{x,b}(t_1) = m_b v_{x,b}(t_1)$	x -momentum b , final time
$P_x(t_1) = P_{x,a}(t_1) + P_{x,b}(t_1)$	extensivity for momentum, final time
$E(t_1) = U(t_1) + E_k(t_1) + E_p(t_1)$	energy content for matter, final time
$E_{k,a}(t_1) = \frac{1}{2} m_a \mathbf{v}_a(t_1)^2$	kinetic energy a , final time
$E_{k,b}(t_1) = \frac{1}{2} m_b \mathbf{v}_b(t_1)^2$	kinetic energy b , final time
$E_k(t_1) = E_{k,a}(t_1) + E_{k,b}(t_1)$	extensivity for kinetic energy, final time
$\Phi(t) = \dot{Q}(t) + F_z(t) \cdot v_z(t)$	energy flux for matter
$P_z(t) = 0 \text{ N s}$	info on z -momentum
$F_x(t) = 0 \text{ N}$	info on x -momentum flux
$v_{a,z}(t_0) = 0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$v_{b,z}(t_0) = 0 \text{ m/s}$	info
$U(t_1) = U(t_0) - 76 \text{ J}$	info on internal energy
$E_p(t_1) = E_p(t_0)$	info on grav. potential energy
$\dot{Q}(t) = 0 \text{ J/s}$	info on heat flux

This is just *one example* of how we could write the physical laws and information about this physical system. When we write a set of equations like the one above, we must decide how detailed or how summarizing we want to be. In the system above we could have been even more detailed, for

instance adding the balance of z -momentum and additional information on the surface & volume forces in the z -direction. Or we could have combined several equations beforehand instead.

The system can be solved by substitution. Combining all equations into the first two we get

$$\begin{aligned} \overbrace{m_a v_{a,z}(t_1) + m_b v_{b,z}(t_1)}^{P_x(t_1)} &= \overbrace{m_a \cdot (0 \text{ m/s}) + m_b \cdot (0 \text{ m/s})}^{P_x(t_0)} + \overbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_x(t) dt}^{0 \text{ N s}} \\ \overbrace{U(t_0) - 76 \text{ J}}^{U(t_1)} + \overbrace{\frac{1}{2} m_a v_{a,z}(t_1)^2 + \frac{1}{2} m_b v_{b,z}(t_1)^2 + E_p(t_0)}^{E(t_1)} &= \overbrace{\frac{1}{2} m_a \cdot (0 \text{ m/s})^2 + \frac{1}{2} m_b \cdot (0 \text{ m/s})^2 + E_p(t_0)}^{E(t_0)} + \overbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt}^{0 \text{ J s}} \end{aligned}$$

which simplifies to this:

$$\begin{aligned} &\begin{cases} m_a v_{a,z}(t_1) + m_b v_{b,z}(t_1) = 0 \text{ N s} \\ m_a v_{a,z}(t_1)^2 + m_b v_{b,z}(t_1)^2 = 76 \text{ J} \end{cases} \\ \Rightarrow &\begin{cases} v_{a,z}(t_1) = -\frac{m_b}{m_a} v_{b,z}(t_1) \\ m_a \left[-\frac{m_b}{m_a} v_{b,z}(t_1) \right]^2 + m_b v_{b,z}(t_1)^2 = 76 \text{ J} \end{cases} \\ \Rightarrow &\begin{cases} v_{a,z}(t_1) = -\frac{m_b}{m_a} v_{b,z}(t_1) \approx \mp 0.708 \text{ m/s} \\ v_{b,z}(t_1) = \pm \sqrt{\frac{76 \text{ J}}{m_b + m_b^2/m_a}} \approx \pm 0.826 \text{ m/s} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

The text says that skater a (mass 70 kg) is on the left. From this we can decide which sign to take, and finally arrive at

$$v_{a,z}(t_1) \approx -0.71 \text{ m/s}, \quad v_{b,z}(t_1) \approx 0.83 \text{ m/s}.$$



11.5

Exercise p. 130

One example is a bomb in empty space. At the initial time it consists of one piece, and after the explosions in consists of many pieces scattering in different directions.

- (a) The whole bomb has initially zero momentum. After the explosion, each individual fragment has non-zero momentum, but the sum of the momenta of all pieces is still zero.
- (b) We can take the bomb to be enough far away from stars or planets.
- (c) As the bomb breaks into different fragments during the explosion, there are fluxes of momentum and energy among the fragments. Such fluxes, however, are *internal*: they are not fluxes of momentum and energy coming from outside the bomb or its fragments.
- (d) During the explosion, internal energy – for instance of chemical origin – get converted into kinetic energy of the pieces that fly away.
- (e) It is obvious that the kinetic energy of the bomb, still whole, is initially zero. After the explosion every fragment has a non-zero velocity, and therefore a positive kinetic energy. The sum of these positive kinetic energies is non-zero.

Note in particular how the momentum is zero both before and after, but kinetic energy is not. This occurs because momentum is proportional to the velocity; velocities can have different directions and the vector sum can become zero. Kinetic energy is proportional to the *square* of the velocity instead, so it is always positive and is a scalar. The sum of these positive scalars is non-zero.

Another, simpler example: two astronauts in empty space initially holding each other, completely still, and then pushing each other away to opposite directions. Their internal energy is burned in their muscles to produce movement, and is transformed into kinetic energy.

💡 11.6

Exercise p. 131

✂ To be written

💡 11.7

Exercise p. 131

Intuitively we expect there to be a momentum flux (surface force) between the cart and the ramp, possibly together with an energy flux; and probably these fluxes change with time. If we consider cart & ramp as a single object – single control volume – then these complicated fluxes are internal and we don't need to keep them into account. Therefore let us try to analyse the problem using a single control volume.

The problem involves two different time instants, so the integral expression of the balance laws seem most convenient. But which balance laws

may be necessary to solve this problem? is the balance of momentum, or of energy, enough by itself? The problem asks for two numeric quantities: the x -velocities of cart and of ramp. The balance of energy provides one equation, so it maybe isn't enough by itself. Using the balance of x -momentum, which provides one more equation, related to the x -direction, so intuitively it may be necessary as well. This is just a heuristic reasoning: as we solve the problem we may realize that a different set of balances is needed.

$$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt , \quad P_x(t_1) = P_x(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_x(t) dt .$$

We directly omit the momentum supply $\mathbf{G}$ because its x -component is zero.

The balance of energy requires the total energy content in the control volume at the initial and final times. Cart and ramp have different velocities and positions, therefore we must use the principle of extensivity to find the total. The total will comprise internal, kinetic, and gravitational potential energies, as is usual for situations involving matter and no electromagnetic fields. The text says that the internal energy of cart & ramp is constant, so let's call it just U .

For the potential energy of the cart we can use the constitutive relation $m g z$, since the cart is viewed as a point; also at the final time this potential energy is zero because the z -coordinate of the cart is zero. We cannot use this constitutive relation for the ramp though, because the ramp has a large vertical extension. However, the ramp is only moving horizontally, not vertically, so its gravitational potential energy must be constant; let's call it $E_{p,r}$.

Similar reasoning applies to the total x -momentum content. Also in this case we have to use extensivity, together with Newton's formula for the momentum of matter.

What about the energy flux $\Phi(t)$ and the x -momentum flux $F_x(t)$? First let's see on which boundary surfaces of the control volume there are such fluxes.

For the surfaces in contact with the air, no fluxes occur, because the text says that air is negligible. Fluxes can therefore only occur between the ramp and the ice.

The momentum flux, or surface force, from ice to ramp must have a z -component: the gravitational force pushes cart & ramp downward, so there must be a surface force from the ice to the cart that prevents

the cart from sinking into the ice. The absence of friction between ice and ramp means that the surface force between them has no horizontal, x -component.

The energy flux, when matter is involved, comprises a heat flux $\dot{Q}(t)$ and mechanical power $\mathbf{F}(t) \cdot \mathbf{v}(t)$. The text says that the heat flux is zero. For the mechanical power between ice and ramp we must consider that the force from the ice to the ramp is purely vertical, and the velocity of the ramp purely horizontal; therefore their dot-product is always zero: $\mathbf{F}(t) \cdot \mathbf{v}(t) = 0 \text{ J/s}$.

We therefore find that there are actually no energy or x -momentum fluxes into our control volume.

The analysis above can therefore be summarized in the equations

$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi(t) dt$	energy balance
$P_x(t_1) = P_x(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_x(t) dt$	x -momentum balance
$E(t_0) = U + \underbrace{E_k(t_0)}_{0 \text{ J}} + m_c g z_c(t_0) + E_{p,r}$	initial total energy from extensivity
$E(t_1) = U + \frac{1}{2} m_c v_{c,x}(t_1)^2 + \frac{1}{2} m_r v_{r,x}(t_1)^2 + \underbrace{m_c g z_c(t_1) + E_{p,r}}_{0 \text{ J}}$	final total energy from extensivity
$P_x(t_0) = 0 \text{ N s}$	initial x -momentum from extensivity
$P_x(t_1) = m_c v_{c,x}(t_1) + m_r v_{r,x}(t_1)$	final x -momentum from extensivity
$F_x(t) = 0 \text{ N}$	x -momentum flux
$\Phi(t) = 0 \text{ J/s}$	energy flux

Replacing into the balances the remaining equations, and simplifying all terms that appear on the left and on the right, we get

$$m_c g z_c(t_0) = \frac{1}{2} m_c v_{c,x}(t_1)^2 + \frac{1}{2} m_r v_{r,x}(t_1)^2$$

$$0 \text{ N s} = m_c v_{c,x}(t_1) + m_r v_{r,x}(t_1)$$

where the unknowns are the final x -velocities $v_{c,x}(t_1)$, $v_{r,x}(t_1)$. This system can be solved with substitution, for instance writing $v_{r,x}(t_1)$ in terms of

$v_{c,x}(t_1)$ in the second equation, then replacing it in the first:

$$\begin{aligned} & \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2}m_c v_{c,x}(t_1)^2 + \frac{1}{2}m_r \left[-\frac{m_c}{m_r} v_{c,x}(t_1) \right]^2 = m_c g z_c(t_0) \\ v_{r,x}(t_1) = -\frac{m_c}{m_r} v_{c,x}(t_1) \end{cases} \\ \Rightarrow & \begin{cases} v_{c,x}(t_1) = \pm \sqrt{\frac{m_c g z_c(t_0)}{\frac{1}{2}m_c + \frac{1}{2}m_c^2/m_r}} = \pm 4.320 \text{ m/s} \\ v_{r,x}(t_1) = -\frac{m_c}{m_r} v_{c,x}(t_1) = \mp 0.2160 \text{ m/s} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

From the problem we know that the cart is moving to the left, therefore

$$v_{c,x}(t_1) \approx -4.3 \text{ m/s} , \quad v_{r,x}(t_1) \approx +0.22 \text{ m/s} .$$

Note that in this problem we have been lucky not to need the balance of z-momentum.

Balance of angular momentum

12.0

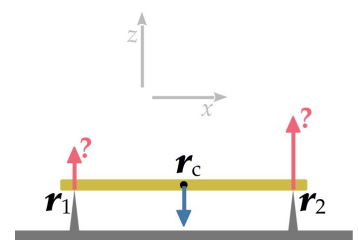
(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

12.1

Solution p. 150

See side figure. A rigid bar (in **yellow**) of mass 2.0 kg is horizontally supported on two points at equal distances of 0.1 m from its centre of mass-energy. With respect to a coordinate system (t, x, y, z) , the support points have position vectors $\mathbf{r}_1 = [-0.2, 0, 0.1]$ m and $\mathbf{r}_2 = [0.2, 0, 0.1]$ m; the centre of mass-energy (black dot) has position vector $\mathbf{r}_c = [0, 0, 0.1]$ m. The physical effects of air are negligible.

Considering the bar as a control volume, there are two influxes of momentum, or surface forces, $\mathbf{F}_1$ and $\mathbf{F}_2$ (**red upward arrows**) on very small surfaces at $\mathbf{r}_1$ and $\mathbf{r}_2$; these two forces are purely vertical. There is also a gravitational momentum supply, or volume force, $\mathbf{G}$ (**blue downward arrow**). The gravitational acceleration is $g = 9.8$ N/kg.



1. Find the gravitational force $\mathbf{G}$.
2. Try to find the forces $\mathbf{F}_1$ and $\mathbf{F}_2$ by using the balance of momentum. Can you determine all their components?
3. Try to find the forces $\mathbf{F}_1$ and $\mathbf{F}_2$ by using the balance of angular momentum besides the balance of momentum.

12.2

Solution p. 153

An engineer has measured the surface forces applied on a block of a very light material at the points

$$\mathbf{r}_a = [0.1, 0, 0.2] \text{ m} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{r}_b = [-0.1, 0, -0.2] \text{ m},$$

and found that these (tensile) forces are equal to

$$\mathbf{F}_a = [0, 0, 3] \text{ N} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{F}_b = [0, 0, -3] \text{ N}.$$

The engineer needs to simulate the motion of the block, using therefore the balances of momentum, of angular momentum, and possibly of energy, and the usual constitutive relations for matter. Since the material is very light, the engineer decides to model the material as if it had zero mass.

Is the engineer's decision reasonable? (*Hint: review the consequences of assuming zero mass for a piece of material, discussed in chapters 10 and 12 of our lecture notes.*)



12.3

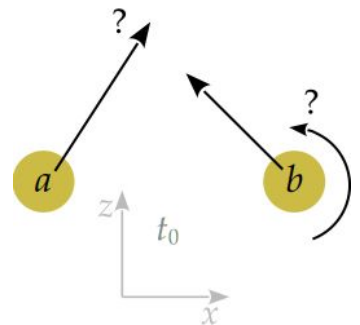
Solution p. 154

At some instant in time, two rigid disks denoted a and b of mass 0.10 kg each, and constant moment of inertia $\mathbf{I}_c = 0.0020 \text{ kg m}^2$ each, are in motion in a gravitational field with gravitational acceleration 9.8 N/kg . The mass-centres of both disks have z -coordinate 0.0 m . Disk b has mass-centre velocity $[-1.0, 1.0] \text{ m/s}$. Disk a is not spinning (that is, its angular velocity is 0 rad/s). Coordinates are (t, x, z) ; angular velocities represent rotations around the y -direction and can be treated as scalars; also the moment of inertia can be treated as a scalar.

Half a second later, both disks have mass-centres at z -coordinate 1.0 m and zero velocities, and neither disk is spinning (that is, both angular velocities are 0 rad/s). The internal energy of disk a has increased by 2.0 J , and that of disk b by 1.0 J .

There is no air and no momentum or heat fluxes from external agencies to the disks. We don't know the initial positions of the disks, nor their dimensions, nor whether the disks collided between the two time instants.

1. Suppose we want to find the initial mass-centre velocity (both components) of disk a , and the initial angular velocity of disk b . Write down your reasoning about the control volumes, balance laws, constitutive



In this figure, the relative radii and horizontal positions of the disks, as well as the velocity of disk a and the angular velocity of disk b , are purely hypothetical. Gravitational momentum supplies are not shown.

relations, and physical principles that you need to use to solve this problem. Motivate shortly why they are needed. (**The important part is the reasoning and explanation; the final values are irrelevant.**)

2. Find the numerical values of the initial mass-centre velocity of disk a and the initial angular velocity of disk b .

Example solutions



12.1

Exercise p. 147

1. To find the volume force $\mathbf{G}$ we use the constitutive relation for the gravitational force near the Earth's surface:

$$\mathbf{G} = -mg [0, 0, 1] \approx -[0, 0, 20] \text{ N}.$$

2. To find the vertical surface forces $\mathbf{F}_1$ and $\mathbf{F}_2$ we consider the given control volume; denote its net momentum content with $\mathbf{P}$ and its net momentum influx with $\mathbf{F}$. The physical laws and data that we know are the following:

- The balance of momentum; we can try to use its differential expression, since the situation is static.
- The principle of extensivity, from which we find the net momentum influx $\mathbf{F}$ from the momentum influxes at the two support points.
- The supply of momentum $\mathbf{G}$ found above.
- The information that $\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} = [0, 0, 0] \text{ N}$, since the bar is static.
- The information that $\mathbf{F}_1, \mathbf{F}_2$ are vertical.

All these together form this system of equations:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} &= \mathbf{F} + \mathbf{G} && \text{momentum balance} \\
 \mathbf{F} &= \mathbf{F}_1 + \mathbf{F}_2 && \text{extensivity of momentum flux} \\
 \mathbf{G} &= -mg [0, 0, 1] && \text{known: gravitational force} \\
 \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} &= [0, 0, 0] \text{ N} && \text{rest condition} \\
 \mathbf{F}_1 &= [0 \text{ N}, 0 \text{ N}, F_{1,z}] && \text{force is vertical} \\
 \mathbf{F}_2 &= [0 \text{ N}, 0 \text{ N}, F_{2,z}] && \text{force is vertical}
 \end{aligned} \tag{12.1}$$

with unknowns $F_{1,z}$ and $F_{2,z}$.

The solution of the system can be found by the method of substitution. We end up with

$$F_{1,z} + F_{2,z} = mg \approx 20 \text{ N}.$$

The equation above can tell us $F_{1,z}$ if we know $F_{2,z}$, or vice versa. But it cannot tell us *both*. It looks like the information given in the problem is not enough to find both forces.

One could say “the situation of the two forces is symmetrical, so we can intuitively assume that $F_{1,z}$ and $F_{2,z}$ should be equal”. But note that this is not a result of the balance of momentum. Which physical law would this “symmetry” be? Now we’ll find an answer to this question.

3. Consider the same control volume as before. Denote its net angular momentum with $\mathbf{L}$; its net influx of angular momentum, or surface torque, with $\mathbf{M}$; its net supply of angular momentum, or volume torque, with $\mathcal{T}$. The additional physical laws and data that we know are the following:

- The balance of angular momentum; we can try to use its differential expression, since the situation is static.
- The principle of extensivity, from which we find the net angular-momentum influx $\mathbf{M}$ from the angular-momentum influxes at the two support points.
- Since the surface at $\mathbf{r}_1$ is small, the angular-momentum influx $\mathbf{M}_1$ through it is given by the constitutive relation $\mathbf{M}_1 = \mathbf{r}_1 \times \mathbf{F}_1$;
- similarly for $\mathbf{r}_2$.
- The text says that the bar is rigid; for a rigid body, the gravitational angular-momentum supply $\mathcal{T}$ is given by the constitutive relation $\mathcal{T} = \mathbf{r}_c \times \mathbf{G}$, where $\mathbf{r}_c$ is the centre of mass.
- The information that $\frac{d\mathbf{L}}{dt} = [0, 0, 0]$ N m, since the bar is static.
- The values of $\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2, \mathbf{r}_c$.

All these together form this enlarged system of equations:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \frac{d\mathbf{L}}{dt} &= \mathbf{M} + \mathcal{T} && \text{ang.-momentum balance} \\
 \mathbf{M} &= \mathbf{M}_1 + \mathbf{M}_2 && \text{extensivity of ang.-momentum flux} \\
 \mathbf{M}_1 &= \mathbf{r}_1 \times \mathbf{F}_1 && \text{const. rel. for torque} \\
 \mathbf{M}_2 &= \mathbf{r}_2 \times \mathbf{F}_2 && \text{const. rel. for torque} \\
 \mathcal{T} &= \mathbf{r}_c \times \mathbf{G} && \text{const. rel. for grav. torque} \\
 \frac{d\mathbf{L}}{dt} &= [0, 0, 0] \text{ N m} && \text{rest condition} \\
 \mathbf{r}_1 &= [-0.2, 0, 0.1] \text{ m} && \text{given} \\
 \mathbf{r}_2 &= [0.2, 0, 0.1] \text{ m} && \text{given} \\
 \mathbf{r}_c &= [0, 0, 0.1] \text{ m} && \text{given} \\
 \mathbf{F}_1 &= [0 \text{ N}, 0 \text{ N}, F_{1,z}] && \text{force is vertical} \\
 \mathbf{F}_2 &= [0 \text{ N}, 0 \text{ N}, F_{2,z}] && \text{force is vertical} \\
 \mathbf{F}_2 &= [0 \text{ N}, 0 \text{ N}, F_{2,z}] && \text{force is vertical}
 \end{aligned} \tag{12.2}$$

with unknowns $F_{1,z}$ and $F_{2,z}$.

The system above can also be solved by substitution. We arrive at these intermediate steps:

$$\mathbf{M}_1 + \mathbf{M}_2 = -\mathcal{T} \quad \implies \quad \mathbf{r}_1 \times \mathbf{F}_1 + \mathbf{r}_2 \times \mathbf{F}_2 = -\mathbf{r}_c \times \mathbf{G},$$

and the vector products in the last equation are easily calculated:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{r}_1 \times \mathbf{F}_1 &= \begin{bmatrix} -0.2 \\ 0 \\ 0.1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m} \times \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \\ F_{1,z} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N m} \\ 0.2 \text{ m } F_{1,z} \\ 0 \text{ N m} \end{bmatrix} \\
 \mathbf{r}_2 \times \mathbf{F}_2 &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.2 \\ 0 \\ 0.1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m} \times \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \\ F_{2,z} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N m} \\ -0.2 \text{ m } F_{2,z} \\ 0 \text{ N m} \end{bmatrix} \\
 \mathbf{r}_c \times \mathbf{G} &= \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0.1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m} \times \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N} \\ 0 \text{ N} \\ -m g \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m}
 \end{aligned}$$

We finally arrive at

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N m} \\ 0.2 \text{ m } F_{1,z} \\ 0 \text{ N m} \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 \text{ N m} \\ -0.2 \text{ m } F_{2,z} \\ 0 \text{ N m} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m}.$$

This corresponds to three equations. The first (x -component) and last (z -component) are identities $0 = 0$. The second (y -component) can be used together with the equation we found from the momentum balance:

$$\begin{aligned} 0.2 \text{ m } F_{1,z} - 0.2 \text{ m } F_{2,z} &= 0 \text{ N m} & \implies & F_{1,z} = F_{2,z} \\ F_{1,z} + F_{2,z} &= mg \approx 20 \text{ N} & & F_{1,z} + F_{2,z} \approx 20 \text{ N} \\ & \implies & & F_{1,z} \approx 10 \text{ N} \\ & & & F_{2,z} \approx 10 \text{ N} \end{aligned}$$

Our intuition that $\mathbf{F}_1$ and $\mathbf{F}_2$ should be equal is therefore a consequence of the balance of angular momentum.

🔗 12.2

Exercise p. 148

As we discussed in chapters 10 and 12 of the lecture notes, assuming that an object has zero mass has important consequences for its momentum, angular momentum, and for the forces and torques applied to it. If two surface forces $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ are applied to it at points $\mathbf{r}_a$ and $\mathbf{r}_b$, then there are two important consequences:

C1 The surface forces $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ must have equal magnitudes and directions, and opposite orientations, that is,

$$\mathbf{F}_a = -\mathbf{F}_b .$$

C2 The surface forces $\mathbf{F}_a$ and $\mathbf{F}_b$ must each have the same direction as the line connecting their surfaces of application:

$$\mathbf{F}_a , \mathbf{F}_b , \mathbf{r}_a - \mathbf{r}_b \text{ are parallel}$$

We see from the engineer's measurements, illustrated in the figure at the margin of the problem, that condition C2 is *not* satisfied in this case. Therefore, assuming zero mass would break the balance of angular momentum.

Let's see this explicitly with the values measured by the engineer.

The total torque on the light object is

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{M} &= \mathbf{r}_a \times \mathbf{F}_a + \mathbf{r}_b \times \mathbf{F}_b \\
 &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.1 \\ 0 \\ 0.2 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m} \times \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N} + \begin{bmatrix} -0.1 \\ 0 \\ -0.2 \end{bmatrix} \text{ m} \times \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -3 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N} \\
 &= \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -0.3 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -0.3 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m} \\
 &= \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -0.6 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m} .
 \end{aligned}$$

But if the object has no mass, its momentum $\mathbf{P}$ and angular momentum $\mathbf{L}$ are always zero; and their time derivatives are also always zero. The volume forces $\mathbf{G}$ and torques $\mathcal{T}$ are zero as well. So the balance of angular momentum would become

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m} = \frac{d\mathbf{L}}{dt} = \mathbf{M} + \mathcal{T} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -0.6 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ N m} ,$$

a contradiction!

12.3

Exercise p. 148

1.

Let's see which information the text of the problem gives us, and then reason about what kind of choices of control volumes and balance laws seem most convenient.

Text information. Given:

- Two times t_0 and t_1 , known time-difference $t_1 - t_0 = 0.50 \text{ s}$.
- Disks are rigid.
- Mass each disk: $m = 0.10 \text{ kg}$.
- Moment of inertia each disk: $I_c = 0.0020 \text{ kg m}^2$.
- Initial mass-centre velocity disk b : $\mathbf{v}_b(t_0) = [-1, 1] \text{ m/s}$.
- Initial angular velocity disk a : $\omega_a(t_0) = 0.0 \text{ rad/s}$.
- Initial mass-centre z -coord. disk a : $z_a = 0.0 \text{ m}$.
- Initial mass-centre z -coord. disk b : $z_b = 0.0 \text{ m}$.

- Final mass-centre velocity disk a : $\mathbf{v}_a(t_1) = [0, 0]$ m/s.
- Final mass-centre velocity disk b : $\mathbf{v}_b(t_1) = [0, 0]$ m/s.
- Final angular velocity disk a : $\omega_a(t_1) = 0$ rad/s.
- Final angular velocity disk b : $\omega_b(t_1) = 0$ rad/s.
- Final mass-centre z -coord. disk a : $z_a = 1.0$ m.
- Final mass-centre z -coord. disk b : $z_b = 1.0$ m.
- Difference final-initial internal energy disk a : $U_a(t_1) - U_a(t_0) = 2.0$ J.
- Difference final-initial internal energy disk b : $U_b(t_1) - U_b(t_0) = 1.0$ J.
- No momentum or heat fluxes from environment to disks.

Required: $v_{a,x}(t_0)$, $v_{a,z}(t_0)$, $\omega_b(t_0)$.

Choice of control volumes. Two possible choices seem obvious at first sight: either consider each disk as a separate control volume, or consider both disks together as one control volume.

With the first choice – two control volumes – when we write the balance laws we would need to explicitly take into account any fluxes of momentum (surface forces), of energy, and of angular momentum (surface torques) between the two control volumes. The text of the problem, however, gives no information whatsoever about them. It might be possible to deal with them using the principle of symmetry of fluxes; but this would effectively correspond to viewing the two disks as one control volume only. Compare the solution on 105 to exercise 10.9, where we had similar choices of control volumes and we tried both of them.

With the second choice – a single control volume – when we write the balance laws we don't need to explicitly take into account the fluxes of momentum, energy, angular momentum between the disks, because such fluxes are *internal* to this control volume. Given that the text does not ask about these fluxes, it's convenient to treat them as internal. Let's therefore proceed by considering both disks together as one control volume.

Example of short motivation: We consider both disks together as one control volume, so that the interactions between the disks become internal and can be avoided.

Choice of balance laws. The text asks to find three real-valued quantities: the two components of the initial mass-centre velocity of disk a , and the initial angular velocity of disk b . Heuristically we therefore expect *three* balance laws to be necessary for finding the information required by the

problem (although, of course, *all* balance laws apply to the physics of this problem). The obvious list to choose from, in this 2D problem, is:

- balance of x -momentum,
- balance of z -momentum,
- balance of energy,
- balance of y -angular-momentum, which represents rotations in the zx plane.

There is no mention of electromagnetism, and with our choice of control volume the amount of matter in it is constant, so the balances of magnetic flux, charge, matter seem unnecessary.

The text gives information about internal energies; therefore the balance of energy seems relevant. In fact the energy of matter involves velocities (kinetic energy) and angular velocities (rotational kinetic energy), so it can give us information about these kind of quantities.

Velocities are also involved in the momentum (Newton's relation) and angular momentum (velocity of mass-centre) of matter, so the remaining two balances to use might be some combination of their balances. Which? The angular momentum of matter typically requires the *position* of the mass-centre – think of the constitutive relation $\mathbf{L} = \mathbf{r}_c \times m\mathbf{v}_c + \mathbf{I}_c \boldsymbol{\omega}$ for a rigid body – and the *position* of the surfaces where forces occur – think of the constitutive relation $\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}$. But the problem does not give full information about positions; only the z -coordinates. Therefore using the balance of angular momentum might lead to difficulties. So let's try using the balances of x - and z -momentum instead.

These balances are conveniently expressed in their integral form, since two time instants are involved.

Example of short motivation: The problem has three unknowns, so three balances seem necessary. It also involves internal energies, thus the balance of energy seems relevant. It also involves velocities but does *not* give explicit *positions*, thus two balances of momentum seem also appropriate. Integral expression is convenient because we have two time instants.

Constitutive relations The problem involves matter and rigid bodies in everyday conditions, and no electromagnetic fields. Therefore the constitutive relations that seem relevant are:

- Newton's relation for momentum content: $\mathbf{P} = m\mathbf{v}_c$. It has to be used for each disk at the initial and final time instants.

- Gravitational momentum supply near Earth's surface: $\mathbf{G} = -mg[0, 1]$. It has to be used at the initial and final time instants.
- Constitutive relation for the total energy of a rigid body: $E = U + \frac{1}{2}m\mathbf{v}_c^2 + mgz_c + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{I}_c\omega^2$. It has to be used for each disk at the initial and final time instants.
- Constitutive relation for total-energy flux: it says that the total-energy flux consists of heat flux and mechanical power, and both are zero according to the text. So the energy flux into the one control volume is zero.

Example of short motivation: This problem involves matter in everyday conditions and rigid bodies, so the usual constitutive relations for the momentum and total-energy content of a rigid body, momentum supply from gravity, and energy flux for matter.

Further principles Some of the constitutive relations above cannot be used directly on the whole control volume, because their conditions of validity are not satisfied. For example the relation $\mathbf{P} = m\mathbf{v}_c$ can only be used for *one* rigid body, but the two disks taken together are not a rigid body. Similarly for the energy content. We must therefore use the *extensivity* of momentum and energy to find the total. No use of flux symmetry seems necessary in this problem.

Example of short motivation: Using extensivity of momentum content and of energy content to find the total momenta and energies.

2.

Let's collect together all equations from the previous physical analysis, remembering that constitutive equations usually have to be used for each

time instant. Let's directly use the principle of extensivity for the totals:

$$P_x(t_1) = P_x(t_0) + \underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_x dt}_{0 \text{ N s}} + \underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} G_x dt}_{0 \text{ N s}} \quad x\text{-momentum balance}$$

$$P_z(t_1) = P_z(t_0) + \underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} F_z dt}_{0 \text{ N s}} - \underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} (mg + mg) dt}_{=2mg(t_1-t_0)=0.98 \text{ N s}} \quad z\text{-momentum balance}$$

$$E(t_1) = E(t_0) + \underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \Phi dt}_{0 \text{ J}} \quad \text{total-energy balance}$$

$$P_x(t_0) = m v_{a,x}(t_0) + \underbrace{m v_{b,x}(t_0)}_{-0.10 \text{ N s}} \quad x\text{-momentum content, extensivity}$$

$$P_x(t_1) = m v_{a,x}(t_1) + m v_{b,x}(t_1) = 0 \text{ N s} \quad x\text{-momentum content, extensivity}$$

$$P_z(t_0) = m v_{a,z}(t_0) + \underbrace{m v_{b,z}(t_0)}_{+0.10 \text{ N s}} \quad z\text{-momentum content, extensivity}$$

$$P_z(t_1) = m v_{a,z}(t_1) + m v_{b,z}(t_1) = 0 \text{ N s} \quad z\text{-momentum content, extensivity}$$

$$E(t_0) = U_a(t_0) + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} m [v_{a,x}(t_0)^2 + v_{a,z}(t_0)^2]}_{0 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{mgz_a(t_0)}_{0 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \mathbf{I}_c \omega_a(t_0)^2}_{0 \text{ J}} + \quad \text{energy content, extensivity}$$

$$U_b(t_0) + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} m [v_{b,x}(t_0)^2 + v_{b,z}(t_0)^2]}_{2 m^2/s^2} + \underbrace{mgz_b(t_0)}_{0 \text{ J}} + \frac{1}{2} \mathbf{I}_c \omega_b(t_0)^2$$

$$E(t_1) = U_a(t_1) + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} m [v_{a,x}(t_1)^2 + v_{a,z}(t_1)^2]}_{0 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{mgz_a(t_1)}_{0.98 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \mathbf{I}_c \omega_a(t_1)^2}_{0 \text{ J}} + \quad \text{energy content, extensivity}$$

$$U_b(t_1) + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} m [v_{b,x}(t_1)^2 + v_{b,z}(t_1)^2]}_{0 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{mgz_b(t_1)}_{0.98 \text{ J}} + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \mathbf{I}_c \omega_b(t_1)^2}_{0 \text{ J}}$$

where m , g , $\mathbf{I}_c$ are known.

Substituting the last equations into the first three, we get

$$0 \text{ N s} = m v_{a,x}(t_0) - 0.10 \text{ N s}$$

$$0 \text{ N s} = m v_{a,z}(t_0) + 0.10 \text{ N s} - 0.98 \text{ N s}$$

$$U_a(t_1) + 0.98 \text{ J} + U_b(t_1) + 0.98 \text{ J} =$$

$$U_a(t_0) + \frac{1}{2} m [v_{a,x}(t_0)^2 + v_{a,z}(t_0)^2] + U_b(t_0) + 0.10 \text{ J} + \frac{1}{2} \mathbf{I}_c \omega_b(t_0)^2$$

where $m = 0.10 \text{ kg}$, $\mathbf{I}_c = 0.0020 \text{ kg m}^2$, and $U_a(t_1) + U_b(t_1) - U_a(t_0) - U_b(t_0) = 3 \text{ J}$ have known values. The solution is

$$v_{a,x}(t_0) \approx 1.0 \text{ m/s}, \quad v_{a,z}(t_0) \approx 8.8 \text{ m/s}, \quad \omega_b(t_0) \approx \pm 31 \text{ rad/s};$$

the information in the problem doesn't allow us to determine whether disk b was initially spinning clockwise or anti-clockwise.

Momentum and energy: remarks

13.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

Example solutions

Balance of entropy

14.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

Example solutions

Constitutive relations

 15.0

(Do the **exercises** in the main text.)

Example solutions

Bibliography

Believe nothing, O monks, merely because you have been told it, or because it is traditional, or because you yourselves have imagined it. Do not believe what your teacher tells you merely out of respect for the teacher.

(Attributed to Gautama Buddha)

(“de X” is listed under D, “van X” under V, and so on, regardless of national conventions.)

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